

(= גִּינְזָק) or (= שְׁלִגִּינְזָק) "in/at/by a/the pool/Pool of (the) Ginzak" — The Jewish community of גִּינְזָק (Ginzak, also spelled as גִּינְזָק, גִּנְזָקִיָּה וּגְנִזְכָּיָה, Ganzaca) in Medes is mentioned in the Talmudim and Midrashim. E.g., "Rabbi Akiba preached the story of the generation of the flood in גִּינְזָק (Ginzak)" (Gen. Rabbah 33:5). Ginzak is identified with the area of the biblical Gozan River.

For Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said, "(Scripture says, 'And the King of Assyria carried Israel away) and settled them in Halah and in Habor on נְהַר גּוֹזָן (the Gozan River) and in the towns of Medes' (2 Kgs 18:11). Halah is Halazon, and Habor is Hadiab, נְהַר גּוֹזָן (Gozan River), this is גִּינְזָק (Ganzaq), and the towns of Medes are Hamadan and its vicinity" (b. Yev. 16b-17a; b. Qid. 72b).¹³

It is possible that natives of Ginzak owned or built the Pool of Ginzak; or that a township with a similar name existed in Palestine.

(= גִּינְזָק) or (= שְׁלִגִּינְזָק) "in/at/by (the) Pool of (the) Treasury" (cf. Allegro¹²) — גִּינְזָק is a *plene* spelling and a variant of גִּנְזָק which occurs once in the Masoretic Text. It is from the root גנז, "to hide" (related to כָּנַס and כָּנַשׁ [A], "to gather," *gimmel-kaf* and *zayin-samekh-shin* interchanges) plus the suffix *-akh* that is common in Persian;¹⁴ cf. גִּבְנוֹי הַמֶּלֶךְ, "treasuries of the king" (Esth. 3:9).

וַיִּתֵּן דָּוִיד לְשִׁלְמוֹה בְּנוֹ אֶת תְּכֵנִית הָאוֹלָם וְאֶת בְּתָיו וּגְנִזְכָּיו וְעֲלִיתָיו וְחֲדָרָיו הַפְּנִימִיִּם
וּבֵית הַכֹּפֶרֶת

And David gave for his son Solomon the plan (or pattern) of the vestibule (of the temple), and its houses, and its treasuries, and its upper rooms, and its inner chambers, and of the room of the ark-cover (1 Chron. 28:11).

(= זֶרֶד) "in/at/by a/the pool of (the) Valley of Zered" (cf. Wolters; the *waw* is a short-headed *reš* or short-legged final *nun* in middle position).

(= זֶרֶד) "in/at/by a/the pool of the Garden of Zered" (the *waw* is a short-headed *reš* or short-legged final *nun* in middle position). גֵּן (masc.) and גִּנְהוּגָנָה (fem.), "garden," could mean "burial garden"; cf. גִּנְהוּגָנָה, "in front of (the burial) Garden of Zadok" (see #52, 10:8). Cf. נַחַל זֶרֶד, Wadi of Zered (Num. 21:12; Deut. 2:13-14), which runs into the Dead Sea at the border of Moab and Edom. Wadi Zered has been identified

Yoma 3[2]:6), this item mentions אֶבֶן שְׁחֹרָיָא, "a black stone." The Samaritan temple was converted into a pagan shrine by Antiochus IV Epiphanes which was destroyed by the Hashmonean John Hyrcanus I in 129 BCE. Probably after that, the Jerusalem priesthood controlled the ruin and prevented the Samaritans from rebuilding it. Therefore, it is logical that the priests controlling Mount Gerizim used the area as a hiding place for the deposits listed in items #47 and #57.

13 See also, A. Oppenheimer, *Babylonia Judaica in the Talmudic Period* (1983), 120-26.

14 Cf. SB, 152a.

as Wadi el-Hasa.¹⁵

בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֵּיא וָד or בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֵּיא וָד, "in/at/by a/the pool of (the) Valley of Violence"; it could be an unattested toponym. The adjectives וָד (pl. וָדִים, adj., masc.) and וָדוֹן (pl. וָדוֹנִים, masc.), "arrogant, insolent," as well as the noun וָדוֹן (masc.), "insolence," are derived from the root וָד - וָדַד, "to boil up, to act rebelliously." Cf. וָד יִהְיֶה לְךָ שְׁמוֹ עוֹשֶׂה בְּעֶבְרַת וָדוֹן, "The proud, haughty person, 'scoffer' his name, acts with arrogant pride" (Prov. 21:24); כָּרוּ לִי וָדִים שִׁיחוֹת, "The sinners have dug pits for me" (Ps. 119:85); הַמַּיִם הַזֵּדִדוֹנִים, "the raging waters" (Ps. 124:5).

יָד בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֵּיא וָד, "in/at/by a/the pool of (the) Valley of Monument." יָד, "hand, monument"; cf. תַּחַת יָד אַבְשָׁלוֹם, "under the Monument of Absalom" (see 10:12, #48).

וָד בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גוֹי וָד or בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גוֹי וָד, "in/at/by a/the Pool of (the) Pure Nation"; cf. וְגוֹי קָדוֹשׁ, "and holy nation" (Exod. 19:6); אֲיֵי הַגּוֹיִם, "islands of the nations" (Gen. 10:5; Zeph. 2:11). This suggestion resembles the alternate וְהוּא הָעַם הַטָּהוֹר הוּא, "In the grave of the sons of the people, it is pure" (see #54, 11:9).

וָד בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֶּוֶן וָד or בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֶּוֶן וָד, "in/at/by a/the Pool of (the) Pure Colors"; cf. גֶּוֶן or גֶּוֶן (masc., TH, JA) means "surface, color"; e.g., מַה גֶּוֶן וְגֶוֶן, "what color is your cloak" (b. 'Eruv. 52b).

וָד בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֶּוֶן וָד, "in/at/by (the) Pool of Snow (pl.), (it is) pure." In this and next suggestions יָם, "pool of," is in the construct state; and וָד refers to יָם, i.e., the pool is pure.

וָד בְּיַמְבֵּימָּהּ שֶׁל גֶּוֶן וָד, "in/at/by (the) Pool of Snow (pl.) and (it is) pure," where וָד is a shortened plural form of שְׁלֵגִים (for similar cases, see #13, 3:9). שְׁלֵג (masc., pl. שְׁלֵגִים; e.g., t. Nid. 17a) means "snow," its secondary meaning is "white" (e.g., Exod. 4:6). E.g., מֵי שְׁלֵג and מֵי שְׁלֵג (Job 24:19), as well as מֵי שְׁלֵגִים (Sifri, Deut. 39), literally "water of snow," means "melted snow." אֲם הִתְרַחֲצֵי בְּמֹ (כּ, בְּמֵי, ק) שְׁלֵג וְהִזְכֹּתִי בְּבֹר כַּפֵּי, "If I wash myself with melted snow, and cleanse my hands with soap" (Job 9:30), where רַחֵץ and זָכָה are used parallel. וְהוּא יָרַד וְהָכָה אֶת הָאָרֶץ בְּתוֹךְ, "And (Benaniah) went down and killed the lion in the middle the pit on the day of snow" (1 Chron. 11:22; cf. 2 Sam. 23:20).¹⁶

(10:8) בְּצִדּוֹ הַמַּעְרָבִי — ALLEGRO^{PT}: "in the crevice of its interior (?)" (i.e., חוֹל (בְּצִרְיָה מַעְתוֹ). as in 8:7 (?); מַעְתוֹ, cf. מַעְתִּי which is parallel to חוֹל,

15 BDB 279b; SB, 213a; *Carta's Atlas of the Bible*, 124a.

16 The Aramaic cognate of שְׁלֵג is תַּלְגָּא - תַּלְגָּא (šīn-taw interchange). E.g., וְאִמּוֹרָאֵי קָרוּ, "and the Amorites called it (i.e., Mount Hermon) Snow Mountain, because it does not cease from it snow neither in the summer nor in the winter" (PsJ. Deut. 3:8), where תַּלְגָּא is in Hebrew הַר הַשְּׁלֵג, Snow Mountain.

“sand” (Isa. 48:19); here “silt” (?). Or it may be a feminine form of *מעה*, “bowels, inward parts,” i.e. “interior” of the cistern. ALLEGRO: *בצדו המערבי*, “in its western side.” The scribe omitted a bar on the top of the *bet*; and squeezed the letters at the end of the line together, which resulted in a *taw* shape before the last letter. Alternately, *בצריח המערבי* for *בצריח המערבי*, but based on the context it is unacceptable.¹⁷ MILIK: *בצדו המערבי*, “on the west side.” The cursive *bet* is joined with the preceding *reš*.¹⁸ WOLTERS: *בצדו* — *המעת* ו-*המעת*, “in its side: the *ma’a* coins and.” The reading here is *מעת* and in the next line *מעות*, the plural of *מעה* (MH), “(small silver) coin,” rather than Milik’s *מערבי* and *בעות*, respectively.¹⁹ VERMES follows Wolters, WISE concurs with Allegro’s alternate reading, and the other scholars agree with Allegro and Milik.²⁰

It is difficult to read both words. The letters are: *bet/kaf*, *šade*, *dalet/reš*, *waw/zayin/yod*, *he/het/taw*, *mem*, *‘ayin*, and a ligature. The ligature consists of two letters, *he/het/taw* plus *waw/yod/zayin*/short-legged final *nun*; or three letters, *dalet/waw/reš*, *waw/zayin/yod/nun*, plus *waw/zayin/yod*/cursive *‘alef*/short-legged final *nun*. In addition, the fifth letter, *he/het/taw*, may be the last letter of the first word, or the first letter of the second word. In the latter case it is the definite article *he*.

בצדו המערבי, “in/at/by its (masc.) western side” (Allegro, Milik) — *צד* occurs in additional two places in the Scroll, and always precedes *המערבי*, “the western”; *בצדו המערב*, “in/at/by the western side” (6:11-12), and *בצדו המערב*, “from/to/on the western side” (10:12-13).

On the other hand, there many additional possibilities. The first word can be read as: (1) *בצדו*, “in its (masc.) side” (*צד*, masc., “side”; cf. Gen. 6:16). (2) *בצדו* = *בצדיו*, “in its (masc.) sides” (cf. Exod. 30:4). The spelling is like *משולו* = *משוליו*, “from its (masc.) bottom” (see #38, 9:1), *תחתו* = *תחתיו*, “under it (masc.)” (see #25, 6:5). (3) *בצדו*, “in/at/by (the) ruin,” where *צדו* (masc.), “ruin” (e.g., Lev. Rabbah 33), seems to be an Aramaic loan word; e.g., the Targum of *לשמה* is *לצדו*, “for ruin” (Isa. 13:9); cf. *בחרובוֹהַבְּחִרְיָבָה*, “in/at/by a/the ruin,” etc. (1:1). *צדו* is from the root *צרה*, “to demolish”; e.g., *שִׁצְדוּ אֶת הָעוֹלָם*, “because they destroy the world” (Gen. Rabbah 26). (4) *בצדיו*, “in (the) sides of.” (5) *בצורי* = *בצורי*, “in (the) rocks of”; e.g., *בוא בצור וְהִטַּמְן בְּעֶפֶר*, “Go into the rock, and hide in the dust” (Isa. 2:10); *צור* (masc.) is related to *צר* (masc.), “stone, flint” (e.g., Exod. 4:25). (6) *בצרי*, “in (the) narrow spaces of”; *צר*, masc., adj., “narrow space” (also “distress”), opposite of *רחב*, “wide (space)”; cf. *מרחב* (9:12);

¹⁷ Allegro, 51, 162 nn. 241-42; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

¹⁸ Milik, 295-96; Milik^E, 141.

¹⁹ “Vocabulary,” 492 #47; “Analysis,” 251; Wolters, 50-51.

²⁰ Vermes, 377; Wise, 196; Lurie, 114-15; 13. Pixner, 354; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 230-31.

בְּמָקוֹם צָר, "in a narrow space" (Num. 22:26); אָצַר הָרַחֲבֶתָּ לִי, "when (I was) in distress, You gave me room" (Ps. 4:2). (7) בְּצִרְיָה (cf. Allegro^{pr}), "in (the) underground chamber of," or "in (the) tower of"; this may be an additional occurrence of צִרְיָה in the Scroll (see #8, 2:5).

The second word, without the possible definite article, can be read, vocalized, and translated as: (1) מַעְרָבִי, "western" (Allegro, Milik). (2) מַעְרִי, Maadai (a personal name, Ezra 14:30).²¹ (3) מַעְרָא = מַעְרָה, "cave." (4) מַעוּוֹ, "its (masc.) shelter." (5) מַעוּוֹי = מַעוּוֹי, "its (masc.) shelters"; מַעוּ, masc., "shelter," cf. מְנוֹס = מְנוֹס, 1:13). (6) מַעוּנִי = מַעוּנִים = מַעֲנִים (pl. of מַעוּ; regarding the defective plural -י ending, see #13, 3:9). (7) מַעוּנֹ, "its (masc.) dwelling" (cf. מַעוּנֹ, "His Temple," 2 Chron. 36:15). (8) מַעוּנֹ = מַעוּנִי, "its (masc.) dwellings." (9) מַעוּנִי, "of Maon, Maonite," or "of the dwelling place." (10) מַעוּנִי = מַעוּנִים, "dwellings" (pl. of מַעוּ, masc., "dwelling place, shelter, fort"; cf. 1 Sam. 2:29). (11) מַעוּנִי = מַעוּנִים, Meunim, Maonites, a tribe living in מַעוֹן, Maon, in Edom; (e.g., 1 Chron. 4:41; cf. Judg. 10:12); or people from מַדְרַם מַעוֹן, Wilderness of Maon in Judah (cf. 1 Sam. 23:24-25), or from the settlement Maon in the Mountain of Judah (Josh 15:55).²² (12) מַעוּנָא = מַעוּנָה (fem. form of מַעוֹן, e.g., Deut. 33:27). (13) מַעֲיִנֹ, "its (masc.) well" (cf. Hos. 13:5). (14) מַעֲיִנֹ = מַעֲיִנִי, "its (masc.) wells." (15) מַעֲיִנִי = מַעֲיִנִים, "wells."²³

Based on the above discussion, the following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this problematic phrase. In some cases the definite article -הּ may be superfluous.

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּוֹת הַמַּעוּוֹי, "in/at/by the sides of its shelter/shelters."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּוֹת הַמַּעוּוֹי, "in/at/by the ruin of its shelter/shelters."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּוֹי, "in/at/by the ruin of the shelters."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּנִי, "in/at/by (the) sides of the shelters," or "in/at/by the sheltering sides."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּוֹת הַמַּעוּנִי, "in/at/by the narrow spaces of its shelter/shelters."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּוֹת הַמַּעוּנִי, "among the rocks of its shelter/shelters."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּנִי, "in/at/by the narrow spaces of the shelters," or "in/at/by the sheltering narrow spaces."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּנִי, "among the rocks of the shelters," or "among the sheltering rocks"; cf. לְצוּר מַעוּז לְבֵית מְצוּדוֹת, "for a rock of refuge, for a house of fortress" (Ps. 31:3).

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּנֹת הַמַּעוּנִי, "in/at/by the narrow spaces of its refuge(s)."

בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעוּנֹת הַמַּעוּנִי, "among the rocks of its refuge(s)."

21 The name מַעְרִי is related to מַעְרִיָּה, Maadiah - מוֹעֲדִיָּה, Moadiah, one of the heads of the priestly families that returned to Palestine with Zerubbabel (Neh. 12:5,17).

22 Regarding the Meunites, see I. Eph'al, "Meunites," *EJ* 11, 1452.

23 מַעֲנִי (masc.) "well" (e.g., Lev. 11:36), has two plural forms, מַעֲנִים (e.g., Ps. 104:10), and מַעֲנִיּוֹת (e.g., Isa. 41:18).

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנִי, “by the narrow spaces of the refuges,” or “the sheltering narrow spaces.”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנִי, “among the rocks of the refuges,” or “among the sheltering rocks.”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנִי, “in/at/by Zure Meunim” (an assumed toponym).²⁴

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנָה, “in/at/by the narrow spaces of the refuge.”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנָה, “among the rocks of the shelter,” or “at Zure Meonah.”

בְּצָדֵי הַמְּעִינֹה/הַמְּעִינִים, “in/at/by the sides of its well/wells.”

בְּצָדֵי הַמְּעִינִים, “in/at/by (the) sides of the wells.”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעִינֹה/הַמְּעִינִים, “in/at/by a/the narrow spaces of its well(s).”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעִינֹה/הַמְּעִינִים, “among the rocks of its well(s).”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעִינִים, “in/at/by a/the narrow spaces of the wells.”

בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעִינִים, “among the rocks of the wells.”

בְּצִדֵּי הַמְּעָרָה, “in/at/by the ruin of the cave.”

בְּצָדֵי הַמְּעָרָה, “in/at/by the sides of the cave.”

בְּצָרִית מַעְדֵּי, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of Maadai,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of Maadai.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנוֹ/מְעוֹנִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of its fort/forts,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of its fort/forts.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of the forts,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of the forts.”

בְּצָרִית מְעִינֹה/מְעִינִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of its well/wells,” or “in a/the tower of its well/wells.”

בְּצָרִית מְעִינִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of the wells,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of the wells.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנוֹ/מְעוֹנִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of its palace/palaces,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of its palace/palaces.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of (the) palaces,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of (the) palaces.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנִים, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of Meunim,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of Meunim.”

בְּצָרִית מְעוֹנָה, “in/at/by an/the underground chamber of (the) palace,” or “in/at/by a/the tower of (the) palace.”

(10:9) אָבֶן שְׁחוּרֶיָּא — אָבֶן (fem.) is modified by next feminine adjective. In the Masoretic Text often אָבֶן (sg.) is used collectively instead of the plural אֲבָנִים.²⁵ אָבֶן occurs in additional three times in the Scroll (8:5, 5:1

24 E.g., בְּצָרֵי הַמְּעוֹנִי is also a biblical personal name, וְבֵן שָׁמַי מְעוֹן וּמְעוֹן אָבִי בֵּית צוּר, “And Shammai’s son was Maon; and Maon was the father of Beth-zur” (1 Chron. 2:45). Interestingly, in this verse Zur and Maon are connected.

25 E.g., לָחַת אָבֶן (Exod. 31:18) vs. לָחַת אֲבָנִים (Exod. 34:1); לָחַת הָאָבֶן (Exod. 24:15) vs. לָחַת הָאֲבָנִים (Deut. 9:9) and לָחַת הָאֲבָנִים (1 Kgs 8:9), “(the) stone tables.” Likewise, occasionally the Targumim use אֲבָנָא (sg.) instead of אֲבָנֵיָא or אֲבָנִין (pl.). E.g., וַיִּדְגְּמוּ אֹתוֹ

[restored], 12:2).

The three drawings are almost the same, yet it is difficult to read the second word. It consists of the letters *šin*, *he/het/taw*, *waw/zayin/yod*/ final *nun*, *dalet/reš*, *waw/zayin/yod*/final *nun*, and *gimmel*. The *gimmel* is a scribal error for an *'alef* or a *taw*; cf. *גמות* for *אמות* (10:6,13); *השניג* for *השניא* or *השנית* (see #39, 9:4); *חפוריג* for *חפורות* or *חפוריא*, or *חפירות* for *חפירות* or *חפיריא* (see #38, 9:2). In addition, the third letter, a *waw*, may be a short headed *reš*; cf. *הדרומית* for *הדרומית* (11:2; see #37, 8:14).

A similar phrase appears again in line 12:2, but there the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: האבן השחוחא, האבן השחוחא, or האבן השחיתא. MILIK^{dr}: האבן השחורא. ALLEGRO^{dr}: האבן השחוריא. Where Milik's drawing shows a *reš*, Baker's has a *he/het/taw*, while Allegro's has a *reš* plus a *yod*. Apparently, in Allegro's drawing the *reš* is the right leg and top, while the *yod* is its left leg of Baker's *he/het/taw*. Since Milik's drawing is a corrected version of Baker's, one wonders what happened with the left leg of the *he/het/taw*, especially since it appears as a *yod* on Allegro's drawing.

These two phrases, noted below as (a) and (b), have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: (a) אבן שהורגא, "a Stone-which-slays"; presumably אבן is collective here; may be mineral bearing ore (cf. Deut. 8:9; Job 28:2), or stones for judicial execution. (b) "the Black Stone." ALLEGRO^{pr}: (a) "the Black Stone"; שחורית, cf. 12:2. ALLEGRO: (a) אבן שחורית, "a plug-stone"; alternately, אבן שחוריא, "the blocking stone"; alternately, האבן השחורא, "the black stone." ALLEGRO^{rev}: (a) "a sealing stone"; (b) "the black stone."²⁶ MILIK: (a) אבן שהודוגא (dots above the *zayin* and *dalet*), "a stone joined"; הודוגא (= הודוגה) is a *Hitpa'el* past third person feminine form of *ווג*, "to join, couple, match." (b) האבן השחורא, "the black rock."²⁷ BENDAVID: (a) שהודוגא is a hybrid of Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew; Mishnaic uses *שנודוגה* (*Nitpa'el*).²⁸ LURIE: (a) אבן שחורות, "black stones"; (b) האבן השחורה, rendered as האבן השחורה, "the black stone."²⁹ BEYER: (a) אבן שחורא, "black stone"; (b) האבן השחורא, "the black stone."³⁰ The others follow Milik in both cases.³¹

אבן is rendered as ורגמו יתיה אבנא (TO), and ואטלו יתיה אבנין (PsJ), "and they stoned him (with) stones" (Lev. 24:23).

26 Allegro, 51, 55, 162 n. 243, 168 n. 294; Allegro^{rev}, 25, 26.

27 Milik, 295, 298, 247 C-88-89; Milik^E, 141, 142.

28 Bendavid 1, 99. The root *ווג* (MH) has both *Hitpa'el* and *Nitpa'el* forms. E.g., "(the chief butler and the chief baker) intended להודוג (= להנדה, to marry) the king's (i.e., Pharaoh's) daughter" (Gen. Rabbah 88); and "It is like a prince whose pedagogue שנודוג (= שנהדוג, that joined) to kill him" (Gen. Rabbah 42)

29 Lurie, 114-15 and n. 4, 122-23 and n. 6.

30 Beyer, 230, 232.

31 Pixner, 354, 357; "Vocabulary," 486 #6, 492 #47; "Analysis," 251, 252; Wolters, 50-51, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377.

The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for both cases according to the three drawings.

אָבן שְׁחורִיָּא for אבן שחוריג (cf. Allegro's alt. reading), "black stone"; *gimmel* instead of an 'alef. This is like Allegro's drawing of the second case, הָאָבן הַשְּׁחורִיָּא, "the black stone." Milik's drawing of the second case has הָאָבן הַשְּׁחורִיָּא, "the black stone." שְׁחורִיָּא (fem.) is a variant of שְׁחורִיָּא (fem.), "black"; cf. צופִיָּא (fem.), which is the same as צופִיָּה (fem., BH; see #25, 6:2).

אָבן שְׁחורִית for אבן שחוריג, "black stone" (cf. Allegro³²); *gimmel* instead of a *taw*; an -ית (fem.) suffixed adjective; cf. וְאָבֶן מְשֻׁכֵּית, "and figured stone" (Lev. 26:1); אָבֶן גְּזִית, "hewn stones" (1 Kgs 5:31; Ezek. 40:42; 1 Chron. 22:2).³²

אָבֶן שְׁחורִית for אבן שחוריג, "black stones" (cf. Lurie), where אבן is a singular collective noun, while the adjective is plural.

אָבֶן שְׁחורִית for אבן שחוריג (= אָבֶן שְׁחורִית), "stone of blackness/youth"; the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *mobile šewa* or *ḥataf pataḥ*, cf. שִׁיבְצָפוֹן (9:14), שִׁיבִית (10:5). Cf. וְהַשְּׁחֹרִית, "and the blackness," i.e., "and the youth" (Eccl. 11:10), from שְׁחֹר, "black, blackness";³³ the opposite of לְבָנוֹת, "white, whiteness," from לָבָן, "white" (e.g., Lev. Rabbah 14).

אָבֶן שְׁחֹרִית for אבן שחוריג, "black stone," or "stone of blackness/youth" (the *waw* instead is a small-headed *reš*, plus defective spelling).³⁴

אָבֶן שְׁחֹרִית for אבן שחוריג, "freedom stone" (the *waw* instead is a small-headed *reš*, plus defective spelling), where שְׁחֹרִית is an assumed feminine -ית form similar of the masculine שְׁחֹרֵר (from שחרר, "to set free," *šaf'el* of the root חרר, "to free"); cf. שְׁטַר שְׁחֹרֵר and גִּט שְׁחֹרֵר, "writ of emancipation" (m. Git. 1:6 and 9:3, respectively), also, שְׁטַר שְׁחֹרֵרָה, "her writ of emancipation" (PsJ Lev. 19:20).

אָבֶן שְׁחֹרִית for אבן שחוריג, "morning stone"; the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa* or *ḥataf*, cf. פֶּת שְׁחֹרִית, "morning bread" (e.g., b. B.M. 107b). שְׁחֹרִית is from שָׁחַר, "morning" (e.g., Gen. 14:15), itself from the root שחר, "to be early."

32 Both מְשֻׁכֵּית and גְּזִית are problematic words. שְׁחֹרִית is like the adjectives אֶדְמוֹנִי, "red, ruddy" (masc., from אָדָם, "red"; e.g., 1 Sam. 16:12; 17:42); אֶדְמוֹמִית, "reddish" (fem.; e.g., b. Hul. 112a); לְבָנוֹנִית, "white, whitish" (fem., from לָבָן, "white"; e.g., m. Neg. 4:4); שְׁחֹמֶמֶתִית, "brownish, dark" (fem., from שָׁחָם, "dark, brown"; e.g., m. B.B. 5:6).

33 The Targum of וְהַשְּׁחֹרִית is וְהַיָּמִים אֲדֻמִּים, "the days of blackness," i.e., youth. שְׁחֹרִית means "youth," since the man's is שְׁחֹר, "black," in his youth (Rashi, Ibn-Ezra); the days of the youth, are like שָׁחַר, when the day beaks (Ibn-Ezra, *Mešudat Zion*).

34 E.g., "If it is so, may Hannah return לְשְׁחֹרִיתָהּ (to her blackness). And Hannah returned לְשְׁחֹרִיתָהּ (to her blackness)" (b. Ta'an. 23b). שְׁחֹרִית is a cognate of שְׁחֹרִיתָא (TA); e.g., מִשּׁוּם שְׁחֹרִיתָא, "because of the blackness" (b. B.Q. 20b).

The following possible readings of the second case (12:2) are based on the drawings of Baker.

אָבֶן הַשְּׁחוּתָא (fem.), "the collapsed stone/monument." The root שחח means "to bend." One can assume that the *Qal* passive participle forms are שְׁחוּחַ, שְׁחוּחִים, and שְׁחוּחוֹת.

הָאָבֶן הַשְּׁחִיתָא (fem.) or הָאָבֶן הַשְּׁחִיתָא (fem.), "the destroyed stone/monument." שחת means "to ruin." Although the *Qal* form is unattested, one can assume that it existed, and the passive participle forms were שְׁחוּחַ, שְׁחוּחִים, and שְׁחוּחוֹת. Moreover, שְׁחִיתָא occurs in Ben-Sira (28:7). For the last two suggestion, compare אָבֶן תְּלוּשָׁה, "detached (grave) stone," and אָבֶן קְבוּעָה, "fastened (grave) stone" (y. Sheq. 1:1 [3b]; y. Ma'as. Sh. 5:1 [20b]; see #41, 9:10).³⁵ Regarding the *Pe'ulah* - *Pe'ilah* formations, see #1, 11.

הָאָבֶן הַשְּׁחוּתָא (fem.) or הָאָבֶן הַשְּׁחִיתָא (fem.), "below the stone of the pit/cistern" — שְׁחוּתָא/הַשְּׁחִיתָא may be a variants of שְׁחוּת, שְׁחִית, שְׁחַת, שְׁחוּחַ, שְׁחִיח, and even שִׁית, "(deep) pit, cistern" (see #13, 3:8). Thus, תַּחַת הָאָבֶן הַשְּׁחוּתָא/הַשְּׁחִיתָא could mean, "below the stone of the pit/cistern," perhaps this stone covered the pit/cistern; cf. תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא הַגְּדוֹלָא, "below the large stone block" (see #52, 11:6-7).

(10:9) אָמוֹת שְׁתֵּין — ALLEGRO³⁶: "in two 'y' (i.e., בְּעֵית שְׁתֵּין); cf. 9:2 (i.e., שְׁבַע עַת). ALLEGRO: אָמוֹת שְׁתֵּין, "two cubits." The *mem* has been split into a *bet* and an 'ayin "by a strange aberration on the part of the scribe" (i.e., אֲבָעוֹת שְׁתֵּין).³⁶ MILIK: בְּעוֹת שְׁתֵּין, "with two clamps."³⁷ WOLTERS: מַעוֹת שְׁתֵּין, "two small coins."³⁸ LURIE, BEYER, and WISE follow Allegro; PIXNER and GARCIA MARTINEZ agree with Milik; VERMES concurs with Wolters.³⁹

The scribe mistakenly engraved a *mem* or *bet* plus a superfluous 'ayin, i.e., אָמוֹת or אֲבָעוֹת for אָמוֹת (cf. Allegro), which seems to be the proper reading. Regarding אָמוֹת, see #1, 1:2-3.

Although it is unlikely, the word in question can be read as אֲבָעִית; e.g., שְׁלֹשׁ אֲבָעִית בְּיוֹם, "there are three assigned times during the day (for the poor to collect *pe'ah*)" (m. Pe'ah 4:5). The plural אֲבָעִית (perhaps the singular is אֲבָעִיָּה) is derived from the Hebrew - Aramaic root בָּעָא - בָּעָה, "to ask" (see Kehati on this Mishnah).

35 אָבֶן תְּקוּמָה, "erected stone, preserved stone" (b. Shab. 66a) is a similar, but different formation.

36 Allegro, 51, 162 n. 244.

37 Milik, 275-76, 247 C-88-89; Milik^E, 141.

38 Wolters, 50-51.

39 Lurie, 114; Beyer, 230-31; Wise, 196; Pixner, 354; Garcia Martinez, 463 Vermes, 377.

(10:10) הוּ הַפֶּתַח, “it (masc.) is the entrance” — ALLEGRO, WOLTERS, and BEYER: הַי הַפֶּתַח.⁴⁰ MILIK and LURIE: הוּ הַפֶּתַח.⁴¹

The reading is הוּ = הוּא (masc.), rather than הִי = הִיא (fem.), since it is in apposition of the masculine הַפֶּתַח (see #25, 6:2-3). The spelling of הוּ (also in line 11:7 and as alternates in lines 10:15 and 11:9), is not a scribal error; it is like the spelling of יְהוּ (= יְהוּא), Jehu (10:15). Cf. אֶף הוּא = אֶפֶהוּ, “also he” (1QH, 10:3, 12:31), אִי זֶה הוּא = אִיזְהוּ, “what/where is it (masc.)” (m. ¹Avot 4:1).

Thorion points out that in the Masoretic Text when a vocal followed by an ²alef in the middle or at end of a word, the ²alef has no consonantal value, therefore, often disappears. Such is the spelling of הוּ (this item), גִּי (this item, 4:13, 8:4), and רוּשׁ (5:1). Also, in this item is spelled defectively.⁴² It should be noted that in the Dead Sea Scrolls, often the spellings of הוּא and הִיא are הוּאָה and הִיאָה, respectively.⁴³

Finally, הַפֶּתַח שְׁתֵּינִי הוּ אֶבֶן שְׁחֹרֵיָא אֲמוֹת שְׁתֵּינִי הוּ הַפֶּתַח can be interpreted as: (1) “(there is) a black stone, (at a distance of) two cubits it is the entrance,” i.e., two cubits from the black stone is the entrance located; and (2) “(at a distance of) two cubits there is a black stone, it is the entrance”; i.e., the black stone itself is located two cubits away, and there is located the entrance.

(10:10-11) זָהָב שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת וְזָהָב, “three hundred talents of gold” — This phrase has an unusual word order; one would expect זָהָב שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת; cf. זָהָב שְׁתֵּינִי, “two talents of gold” (7:16); כֶּסֶף שְׁשִׁין וּשְׁבַעִין, “sixty two talents of silver” (10:6-7); וְכֶסֶף שְׁבַעִין, “and seventy talents of silver” (2:6).

On the other hand, it is also possible to read and translate these cases as, זָהָב שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת וְזָהָב, “three hundred gold (pieces/shekels) in (an unspecified number of) pitchers,” or “(an unspecified amount of) gold in three hundred pitchers”; זָהָב שְׁתֵּינִי, “two gold (pieces/shekels) in pitchers,” or “(an unspecified amount of) gold in two pitchers” (see #32, 7:16); כֶּסֶף שְׁשִׁין וּשְׁבַעִין, “sixty two silver (pieces/shekels) in (an unspecified number of) pitchers,” or “(an unspecified amount of) silver in sixty two pitchers” (see #46, 10:6-7); וְכֶסֶף שְׁבַעִין, “and seventy silver (pieces/shekels) in (an unspecified number of) pitchers,” or “(an unspecified amount of) silver in

40 Allegro, 51; Wolters, 50; Beyer, 230. Allegro^{PF}: הִי which may be the same as הִיא, or better, it is like אִי(ה), “where” (BH) with the reduced meaning “at.” Allegro^{PF}: “Here is” (i.e., הִי = הִיא).

41 Milik, 295; Lurie, 114.

42 Thorion, 164 #1, 168 #6.2.

43 See S. Morag, “הכינויים העצמאיים לנסתר ולנסתרת במגילות ים המלח” in *EI* 3 (1954), 166-69. According to E. Qimron, in the the Dead Sea Scrolls הוּאָה occurs 45, while הוּא 65 times; הִיאָה 19, while הִיא 21 times; and הוּ twice in אֶפֶהוּ (= אֶף הוּא). Qimron does not list the הוּ cases that are the Copper Scroll (*The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1986], 57-58).

seventy pitchers" (see #8, 2:6). Often זָהָב and כֶּסֶף with number mean "golden shekel," or "silver shekel," respectively (see #1, 1:4; #59, 12:9; also Appendix A; Appendix B).

(10:11) וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין וְכּוּפְרִין וְכִפְרִין (= כְּפֹרִים) עֲסָרָה וְעֶסְרִין "and ten/twenty sprinkling vessels" — Regarding the end of the last word, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: *yod* and a fragment of a final *nun* (i.e., עֶסְרִין, "twenty"). However, the *yod* may simply be a part of the right upper corner, while the fragment of the final *nun* a part of the left leg of a *he* (i.e., עֲסָרָה, "ten"). MILIK^{dr}: a *yod* followed by a final *nun* most of it made of a dotted line (i.e., עֶסְרִין). ALLEGRO^{dr}: a clear *he*, although its left leg of is on the cut where the Scroll was sawed into segments at the time of its opening (i.e., עֲסָרָה; see "The Drawings" in the Discussion).

This phrase has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: "and ten 'atonement vessels (monies)'" (i.e., וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין עֲסָרָה). וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין are "atonement monies, or vessels"; cf. Exod. 30:12. ALLEGRO^{pr}: "and twenty 'atonement vessels'" (i.e., וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין עֶסְרִין). ALLEGRO: וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין עֲסָרָה, "and ten serving vessels"; וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין are "vessels of the *kephor* type," cf. Ezra 1:10, etc.⁴⁴ MILIK: וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין עֶסְרִין, "and twenty vases coated with pitch" (כּוּפְרִין).⁴⁵ LURIE follows Allegro. The priests in the Temple washed their hands in the כּוּפֹר vessel (cf. b. Zev. 25a).⁴⁶ WOLTERS: וְכִלִּין כּוּפְרִין עֶסְרִין, "and twenty expiatory vessels." The interpretation of Milik and Pixner "seems bizarre as a description of buried treasure"; while that of Allegro and Lurie "involves changing the text." כּוּפֹר, "ransom," is related to כִּפֵּר, "to atone." The Scroll often refers to "matters consecrated to the priesthood and the cult," and probably כִּלִּין כּוּפְרִין means "expiatory vessels," used by the High Priest on יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים, the Day of Atonement.⁴⁷ Regarding Wolters interpretation, cf. Allegro^{pr}. WISE: "and twenty vessels containing Temple penalty fees."⁴⁸ PIXNER, VERMES, and BEYER agree with Milik, while GARCIA MARTINEZ follows Wolters.⁴⁹

The word before the last can be read as כּוּפְרִין (with a *waw*) or כִּיפְרִין (with a *yod*). כּוּפְרִין may be a variant of כְּפֹרִין, or כּוּפְרִין וְכִיפְרִין for כְּפֹרִין, like הַבָּאוֹת for הַבָּאוֹת. The *waw/yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*' (see #1, 1:2), while the *pe* is defective. כְּפֹרִים is the plural of כְּפֹר (masc.), a certain type of service "bowl." It occurs in Ezra and in the Chronicles. E.g.,

כְּפֹרִי זָהָב שְׁלֹשִׁים כְּפֹרִי כֶסֶף מִשְׁנֵים אֲרָבַע מֵאוֹת וְעֶשְׂרֵה בָּלִים אַחֲרֵים אֵלָּה:

44 Allegro, 51, 162 n. 247; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

45 Milik, 295-96, 252 C-137; Milik^E, 141.

46 Lurie, 115 and n. 6.

47 "Notes," 596; "Analysis," 251; Wolters, 50-51.

48 Wise, 196.

49 Pixner, 354; Vermes, 377; Beyer, 230-31; Garcia Martinez, 463.

Thirty gold bowls, four hundred and ten silver bowls of second sort, one thousand other vessels (Ezra 1:10).

In addition, the Mishnah mentions כְּפוֹרֶת vessel, which seems to be the feminine formation of כָּפוֹר. Therefore, the suggested vocalization is כְּפוֹרֶת, rather than כְּפוֹרֶת. E.g.,

There were thirteen chests in the Temple, and it was written on them ... (on the seventh), “זָהָב לְכְפוֹרֶת” (gold for the *keforet* [vessel])” (m. Sheq. 6:5).

Rashi says that כָּפַר (H, A) means “to wipe away, remove,” therefore, Scripture calls the מְזֻרְקִים, “sprinkling basins” of the Temple זָהָב כְּפוֹרֵי, “golden wipers” (Ezra 1:10; 1 Chron. 28:17), because the priest wipes off his hands with them בְּשֵׁפֶת הַמְזֻרֵק, “at the edge of the sprinkling basin” (b. Zev. 93b; Rashi on Gen. 32:21).⁵⁰ Thus, the כּוֹפְרִין vessels are like the מְזֻרְקוֹת mentioned in the Scroll (3:3). However, there are additional possibilities.

כִּיפְרִין = כְּפוּרִים, plural of כָּפוֹר (masc., from the root כָּפַר, “to redeem,” BH) means “redemption, atonement,” and it may refer to certain vessels used by the priest on יוֹם הַכְּפוּרִים, “the Day of Atonement” (e.g., Sifre 24; also cf. Lev. 23:27, 25:9). The *yod* may indicate a Tiberian short *hiriq*, while the *pe* is defective.

כִּיפְרִין = כְּפִירִים, plural of כָּפִיר (masc.), “young lion” (e.g., Ezek. 19:3; Jer. 2:15). The *yod* may indicate a Tiberian *šewa*, while the *pe* is defective. In addition, כְּפִירִים, Kephirim (plural formation), is a town in Benjamin (Neh. 6:2), otherwise known as כְּפִירָה, Chephirah (Josh. 9:17; 18:26; Ezra 2:25; Neh. 7:29).

Based on the above, the following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the phrase in question. Regarding the last number, both possibilities, עֶסְרִי (masc.), “ten,” and עֶסְרִין, “twenty,” are acceptable.

וְכָלִים כְּפוּרִים עֲשָׂהוּ עֲשָׂרִים = וְכָלִין כּוֹפְרִין כּוֹפְרִין כִּיפְרִין עֲשָׂהוּ עֶסְרִין, “and ten/twenty sprinkling vessels.”

וְכָלִים כְּפוּרִים עֲשָׂהוּ עֲשָׂרִים = וְכָלִין כִּיפְרִין עֲשָׂהוּ עֶסְרִין, “and ten/twenty vessels for redemption,” or “and ten/twenty vessels for the Day of Atonement” (cf. Allegro¹⁹⁷¹, Wolters).

וְכָלִים כְּפִירִים עֲשָׂהוּ עֲשָׂרִים = וְכָלִין כִּיפְרִין עֲשָׂהוּ עֶסְרִין, “and ten/twenty young lion vessels,” perhaps vessels shaped like or having designs of lions; or “and ten/twenty vessels of Kephirim,” i.e., vessels made in or donated by the natives of Kephirim.

50 See also Rashi on b. Zev. 93b; Ramban on Gen. 32:21; Rashi, Ibn-Ezra and *Mešudat Zion* on Ezra 1:10; Rashi, Radak, and *Mešudat Zion* on 1 Chron. 28:17; Bertinoro, *Tosephot Yom-Tov*, *Tif'eret Israel*, and Ribeban on m. Sheq. 6:5; *Qorban Ha'Edah* and Ribeban on y. Sheq. 6:4 (25a). Jastrow (657b-58a) suggests that כָּפוֹר is a “plated vessel,” related to כְּפוֹרֶת, “plating for the Temple roof.”

ITEM 48

10:12 תחת יד אבשלום מן הצד
10:13 המערבי חפור אמות שתין עשרה
10:14 ככ 80

10:12 Below the Monument of Absalom, on the western
10:13 side, are buried twelve cubits (deep)
10:14 80 s(silver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(10:12) תַּחַת יַד אֲבִשְׁלֹם, “Below the Monument of Absalom” — Although this is the reading of the scholars, Lurie accepts it merely because he cannot offer a better one. He claims the last letter of תַּחַת looks like a *het*, the *yod* of יד like a *zayin*, the *dalet* like a *reš*.¹ This raises a question about Lurie’s approach toward the text, since often *he/het/taw*, *waw/zayin/yod/final nun*, *dalet/reš*, cannot be distinguished in the Scroll. Regarding תַּחַת, see #25, 6:5; #49, 10:15.

As the scholars point out, what is called today “Monument of Absalom” is not identical with the one mentioned in the Bible.²

And אֲשֶׁר בָּעֵמֶק הַמֶּלֶךְ (Absalom) ... erected a pillar in his lifetime עֲבוֹר הַזִּכִּיר (which is in the Valley of the King), for he said, “I have no son שְׁמִי (to keep my name in remembrance) ... And he called the pillar after his name; and he called it יַד אֲבִשְׁלֹם (the Monument of Absalom), (and so it is called) to this day (2 Sam. 18:18).

Targum Jonathan renders יַד אֲבִשְׁלֹם as אֶתְרָא דְאֲבִשְׁלֹם, “the Place of Absalom.”³ Accordingly, יַד אֲבִשְׁלֹם, literally “Hand of Absalom,” can be

¹ See next footnote.

² Allegro^{PF}; Allegro, 51, 163 n. 249; Allegro^{rev}, 25; Milik, 295-96, 274 D-68; Milik^E, 142, 150; Lurie, 115-16 and nn. 1-2; Pixner, 354 and n. 42; Wolters, 50-51; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 230-31; Vermes, 277; Wise, 197.

³ In this verse Radak, *Mešudat Zion*, and Malbim follow the Targum. There are several cases in the Masoretic Text where יָד means “place.” E.g., וְיָד תְּהִיָּה לָךְ מַחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה, “and you shall have a *yad* outside the camp” (Deut. 23:13). Sifri says, “יָד means place.” וְיָד is rendered by the Targumim as וְאֶתְרָא מְתַקֵּן (TO) and וְאֶתְרָא מְזֻמָּן (PsJ, TN), “and a prepared place” (Rashi, Rashbam, Sa’adiah Ga’on, Ibn-Ezra, Malbim, all follow the Targumim). Also, אִישׁ עַל יָדוֹ לְדָגְלָהֶם, “each on his *yad* according to their divisions,” where עַל יָדוֹ (literally “on/at his hand”) is rendered by Onkelos as עַל אֶתְרָה, “on/at his place” (Num.

rendered either as “Monument of Absalom,” or “Place of Absalom.”

ידה (from יד, “hand”) means “to throw stones”; cf. וַיִּדְּוּ אֶבֶן בִּי, “and they cast stone upon me” (Lam. 3:53). Originally monuments were made of piles of stones thrown by hand (cf. Gen. 31:46; see #20, 4:13), while later single stones were used. Such heap is called in Arabic *rujm*, a synonym of יד, “monument.” The roots ידה, רגם, and ירה have identical meanings.⁴ This observation is significant, since רגם, “monument,” appears twice in the Scroll (see #23, 5:9).

Both אבשלום, Absalom, and its variant אבישלום, Abisalom (1 Kgs 15:2, 10) mean “Father of Peace.” This name is also found in the Dead Sea Scrolls, “its פֶּשֶׁר (interpretation) is upon the House of Absalom and men of their advice” (1Qp Hab. 5:9-10).⁵

Finally, one can associate some of the names mentioned in the Scroll with the family and/or immediate circle of King David. E.g., אֲשֻׁתֹּאשִׁיחַ שְׁלֹמוֹ, “Pool of Solomon” (5:6), and תְּרִיץ חֲרוּצַ שְׁלֹמוֹ, “Trench of Solomon” (5:8-9), vs. Solomon son of David; יד אבשלום, “Monument of Absalom” (this item) vs. Absalom son of David; בֵּית תָּמָר, Beth Tamar (9:14-15), vs. Tamar daughter of David, and Tamar grand daughter of David; קֶבֶר צָדוֹק, “Grave of Zadok” (11:3), and גִּבְתַּת צָדוֹק, “(Grave) Garden of Zadok” (11:6), vs. Zadok the priest of David (2 Sam. 16:27); בֵּית הַקֹּצ, “House of Hakkoz” (7:9, alt. reading), vs. בְּנֵי הַקֹּץ, “sons of Hakkoz,” one of the 24 priestly watches established by King David. In the context of this discussion, it should be born in mind that these names were common during the Second Temple era.⁶

(10:12) מִן הַצֵּד הַמַּעֲרָבִי, “from the western side,” could also mean “to/on the western side” (see #10, 2:10). צד occurs in additional two places in the

2:17). Likewise, Rashi explains that it means עַל מְקוֹמוֹ, “at his place,” and adds that “hand” does not depart from its original meaning, since רוּחַ שֶׁל צִדּוֹ הוּא עַל יְדוֹ כְּמוֹכָה לוֹ, “the direction at one’s side is at his hand (i.e.) next to him,” in Old-French אינשון אישא, *en son aise*, “adjacent to him” (see Herczeg, *Numbers*, 13 and nn. 4-5; Gukovitzki, 143; Catane, 55, 273 n. 161; *HR* 3, 453). Also see J.S. Licht, “יד” and “יד אבשלום” in *EB* 3, 463-64. Regarding עֵמֶק הַמֶּלֶךְ, see #46, 10:5.

4 See A. Cohen, “ויקרא למצבת על שמו ויקרא לה יד אבשלום (שמואל ב' י"ח, יח)” in *Beth Mikra* 14 (1968/69), 103.

5 This is mentioned already by Allegro^{PF}. פֶּשֶׁר, a variant of פֶּשֶׁר, occurs in the Scroll (see #60, 12:12).

6 E.g., Absalom, the father of Mattathias and Jonathan (1 Macc. 11:70, 13:11); Absalom, the younger son of John Hyrcanus I (Ant. 14:71; Wars 1:154). See Sh. Yeivin, “Absalom,” *EJ* 2, 174; A. Schalit and C. Roth, “Absalom,” *EJ* 2, 176. In addition, Abisalom was the father of Judge Hanan, חֲנָן בֶּן אֲבִישָׁלוֹם, of the Jerusalem court (m. Ket. 13:1); the Tanna Rabbi Zadok, רַבִּי צָדוֹק (m. ‘Ed. 7:1-5); the Scribe Zadok, צָדוֹק הַסּוֹפֵר (Neh. 13:13); the “children of the Servants of Solomon,” בְּנֵי עֲבָדֵי שְׁלֹמֹה (Ezra 2:55,58; Neh. 7:57,60, 11:3) were among the returnees of Babylon.

Scroll, and always precedes הַמַּעֲרָבִי, “the western”; בְּצִדְ הַמַּעֲרָבִי, “in/at/by the western side” (6:11-12), and בְּצִדּוֹ הַמַּעֲרָבִי, “in/at/by its (masc.) western side” (10:8). BENDAVID claims that מִן הַצִּד, מִן הַצִּפּוֹן, מִן הַמּוֹרָח, and מִן הַמּוֹרָחוּ in the Scroll are Biblical Hebrew forms.⁷

(10:13) חָפוּרִי־חָפּוּר (= חָפּוּרִי־חָפּוּר) אַמּוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה, “are buried twelve cubits (deep),” or “dig twelve cubits (deep)” — The three drawings have גְּמוֹת instead of אַמּוֹת, as they have עָסָר גְּמוֹת for עָסָר אַמּוֹת earlier in this column, i.e., *gimmel* instead of *’alef* (see #46, 10:6).

Both of cases have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{PF}: “the ‘(alms-) scattering’ (?), twelve lots” (i.e., גְּמוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה); and “ten lots” (i.e., גְּמוֹת עָסָר, גְּמוֹת עָסָר, cf. פִּיזוֹר (MH), “scattering,” and the use of the verb in Ps. 112:9 of alms, גְּמוֹת, “collections, lots,” cf. Arabic *jammāt*, “collection of water, people.” ALLEGRO^{PF}: “ten cubits” (i.e., אַמּוֹת עָסָר). ALLEGRO: חָפּוּרִי־חָפּוּר אַמּוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה, “buried at twelve cubits”; and אַמּוֹת עָסָר, “ten cubits”; the second *waw* is either a *nun*, i.e., חָפּוּר, or a dittography, i.e., חָפּוּר like אֲשׁוּחַ (5:6). In both cases the *gimmel* of גְּמוֹת is instead of an *’alef*.⁸ MILIK: חָפּוּר לְגְּמוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה, “dig twelve feet”; and גְּמוֹת עָסָר, “count off ten feet.” In both cases חָפּוּר has a cursive *reš*. גְּמוֹת is the plural of רֶגֶם, a parallel of רֶגֶל, which is related to רֶגֶל, “foot.” Alternately, גְּמוֹת and חָפּוּר (ו)ר.⁹ Milik omits the meaning of גְּמוֹת. GREENFIELD takes “strong exception” to Milik’s interpretation of רֶגֶם גְּמוֹת.¹⁰ LURIE: חָפּוּרִי־חָפּוּר (translated as חָפּוּר), and אַמּוֹת. Lurie neither mentions the presence of the second *waw*, nor the *gimmel* shaped letter for *’alef*.¹¹ THORION: the text has גְּמוֹת and רֶגֶם גְּמוֹת, but they must be read as אַמּוֹת.¹² WOLTERS: חָפּוּרִי־חָפּוּר אַמּוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה, “dig twelve notches”; and גְּמוֹת עָסָר, “ten notches.” גְּמוֹת is the plural of גְּמָא, “indentation, notch.” The context require a measurement, and גְּמָא is in this sense attested so in Mishnaic Hebrew.¹³ BEYER: חָפּוּרִי־חָפּוּר אַמּוֹת שְׁתֵּי עָסָרָה, “dig twelve cubits deep!”; and אַמּוֹת עָסָר, “a distance of ten cubits.”¹⁴ WISE: “dig down twelve cubits”; “dig down ten cubits.”¹⁵ PIXNER and GARCIA MARTINEZ basically agree with Milik, while VERMES follows Wolters.¹⁶

7 Bendavid 1, 99.

8 Allegro, 51, 161 n. 236, 162 n. 243, 163 n. 251.

9 Milik, 295-96, 233 B-18e, 254 C-162; Milik^E, 141-42 (“twelve” is a typographical error for “ten”).

10 Greenfield, 139b.

11 Lurie, 113-16.

12 Thorion, 166-67, 176. (Thorion [166] needs to be corrected: Pixner renders “feet,” i.e., אַמּוֹת רֶגֶם, not רֶגֶם גְּמוֹת.)

13 “Vocabulary,” 491 #42 and n. 58; “Analysis,” 244, 251; Wolters, 50-51.

14 Beyer, 230-31.

15 Wise, 197-97.

16 Pixner, 354; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377.

ITEM 49

10:15 בימ בית המימ של יהו לתחת

10:16 השקת ככ 17

10:15 At the pool of the water closet of Jehu, below

10:16 the sink, (there are) 17 s(silver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(10:15) הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “In/at/by (the) pool of (the) water-closet/laundry/hot-bath/hot-spring/hot-house” — בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים has been interpreted as follows. ALLEGRO¹: “the Toilet House” (i.e., בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים). ALLEGRO: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “the Bathhouse,” alternately “urinary.”¹ MILIK: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “house of the hot water, bath,” rather than בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “house of water.”² There is no need to place a dot above the *het* or *he*, both are possible readings. LURIE: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “toilet” (MH).³ PIXNER: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “water house.”⁴ SHARVIT: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים is a compound Mishnaic term.⁵ WOLTERS: בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “privy,” or “outhouse,” like the modern “water closet,” as Lurie suggests. Milik’s בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים can be rejected, since in the Scroll the plural ending consistently is יִן—not יִם, only מִים retains the יִם- ending.⁶ Wolters did not take note of Allegro’s alternate translation as “urinary.” In addition, six times, including twice שְׁתֵּימָּה (6:13, 7:16), the scribes retained the יִם- ending in dual-type formations. Therefore, it is reasonable to assume that they also used יִם- endings in plurals. WISE: “the water reserve.”⁷ GARCIA MARTINEZ and VERMES agree with Lurie, while BEYER follows Pixner.⁸

יִם, בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים, “in/at/by a/the pool of.” יִם, “sea, pool, basin,” also connotes “ritual bath” (see #47, 10:8).⁹ The *mem* of בֵּית הַיִּמּוֹחַמִּים is suspended (i.e., superlinear), like the *resh* ראש (see #52, 11:5); the small size *lamed* and *yod* above the second *sin* of השלשיל (see #7, 2:4).

1 Allegro, 51, 163 n. 255; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 295-96, 245 C-75; Milik^E, 142.

3 Lurie, 117 and n. 2.

4 Pixner, 354-55.

5 “Iyyunim,” 131 and n. 33.

6 “Vocabulary,” 488 #32; “Analysis,” 251; Wolters, 50-51.

7 Wise, 197.

8 Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377; Beyer, 230-31.

9 Regarding the secondary meaning of יִם, “west,” see #25, 9:7.

Likewise, once דמַע has a sublinear *ayin* (see 11:14, #55). These corrections probably were made by different scribes.

בֵּית is in the construct state, same as בֵּית שֵׁל (masc.), “(the) house of.” Regarding בֵּית, see #7, 2:3.

מֵי, “waters,” is a dual formation and it is always plural. It appears four times in the Scroll (5:1, 7:14, 9:11, 10:15).

The term בֵּית הַמַּיִם, literally “house of the waters,” i.e., “water closet, toilet” occurs in the Talmud. E.g.,

If it is so, why it is written, וְכָתַב לוֹ אֶת מִשְׁנֵה הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת (and he [the king] shall write for himself a second copy of this Torah [Deut. 17:18])? It teaches that two Torah scrolls he must write, one which he always carries with him, and one that lays for him בְּתוֹךְ הַיֵּת (in his palace). That one which he carries always, it shall not enter with him לְבֵית הַמֶּרְחָץ וְלֹא לְבֵית הַמַּיִם (neither into the toilet house, nor into the bath-house)” (t. San. 4:8; cf. t. San. 4:7)¹⁰

One may sell (a Synagogue) forever, except for four purposes: for מֶרְחָץ (a bath-house), or for בּוֹרֶסְקִי (a tannery), or for טְבִילָה (a ritual bath), and for בֵּית הַמַּיִם (m. Meg. 3:2).

Rashi offers two interpretations for בֵּית הַמַּיִם, “water closet” and “laundry” (b. Meg. 27b; see also Bertinoro on this Mishnah).

Alternately one can read חֲמִיִּם with a *het* (as Milik). חֲמִיִּם is the plural of the adjective חָם (masc.), “hot” (from the root חָמַם, “to be hot,” BH, MH, A). חֲמִיִּם is often used as a shortened form of מֵי חֲמִיִּם, “hot water” (e.g., b. Shab. 134b), or “hot spring” (e.g., b. Hul. 8a). Accordingly, בֵּית חֲמִיִּם could mean: (1) “in/at/by a/the pool of a/the hot spring”; (2) “in/at/by a/the pool of a/the hot bath-house (*balneum*)”; or (3) “in/at/by a/the pool of a/the hot room (*caldarium*).” Hot bath-houses were introduced in Palestine in the second century BCE. Apparently, the Rabbis had reservation about using bath-houses as substitute for the Halakhicly mandated *mikves*, immersion pools.¹¹ This reading is very interesting, since the Scroll also mentions הַטְּבִילָה, “cave of the immersion,” i.e., *mikve*, which must have contained natural or cold water (see #4, 1:12).

(10:15-16) שֵׁל יְהוּ (= יהוא) לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, “of Jehu, below the sink” — ALLEGRO: “which has a surrounding wall, under the overflow gutter (i.e., שְׁלֹ חֵיל, תַּחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת). שׁוֹקֵת, “through, gutter, a grooved stone to carry off overflow of a well, sink” (Jastrow 1541b), BH (Gen. 20:24, 30:38). ALLEGRO: שֵׁל הַשֶּׁקֶת וְחֵיל תַּחַת (or וְחֹל), “of running water (?), under the gutter.” Alter-

10 An almost identical baraita uses the terms, לֹא לְבֵית הַמֶּרְחָץ וְלֹא לְבֵית הַכֶּסֶּא, “neither into the bath-house nor into the toilet” (b. San. 21b).

11 Cf. m. Zav. 5:12 (see Bertinoro); b. Shab. 13b-14a (see Rashi). Also see, R. Reich, “The Hot Bath-House (*balneum*), the Mikveh and the Jewish Community in the Second Temple Period,” *JJS* 39 (1988), 102-107.

nately, של אחיל for של החיל, “of the Rampart,” cursive *’alef* instead of a *he*. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “of Black Marble (?), under the gutter.”¹² MILIK: שלוחי, “of Siloah, under the pipe.” שלוחי is an adjectival form of שילוח, Shiloah. Milik refers to the biblical and Targumic usage of שקת.¹³ LURIE: של רחיל תחת השקת, “(of the house or courtyard) of Rachel, below the sink.” רחיל is a *plene* spelling of רחל.¹⁴ BEYER: של רחיל תחת השקות, “of Rachel, under the feed pipe.” Rachel’s grave was 10 km north of Jerusalem.¹⁵ PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES follow Milik, while WOLTERS and WISE agree with Lurie.¹⁶

The third and fifth letters of this phrase can be read as *waw/yod/zayin*–short-legged final *nun* or short-headed *reš*. Regarding the first word in line 10:16, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: *he/ḥet/taw*, *šin/šin*, *qof*, *waw/yod*, and a letter fraction that that may be the top of a *bet/dalet/he/ḥet/kaf/mem/reš/taw*. MILIK^{dr}: *he/ḥet/taw*, *šin/šin*, *qof*, a dotted *waw/yod*, and a letter fraction that may be the upper part of a *he/ḥet/taw*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: *he/ḥet/taw*, *šin/šin*, *qof*, and *he/ḥet/taw*. In addition, there is a large lacuna beneath this word.

יְהוּ, “of Jehu,” will be discussed later. The preposition תַּחַת, “under, below, beneath,” occurs in the Scroll as follows: תַּחַת (fourteen times, plus once is reconstructed, 5:2); תַּחְתּוֹ (defective), “under it (masc.)” (see #25, 6:5); תַּחְתֶּיהָ, “under it (fem.)” (see #34, 8:6-7); וְשֵׁתַחַת, “which is under” (2:1, 2:10, 11:8); מִתַּחַת, “from below” (see #51, 11:2); and in this item לַתַּחַת, “to under.”

תַּחַת is common in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew. It also occurs in various combined preposition: מִתַּחַת (BH, MH), “from under”; e.g., מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם, “from under the heavens” (Gen. 1:9); מִתַּחַת יָדוֹ, “from under his hand” (b. Yev. 2:8). אֶל תַּחַת (BH), literally “to under”; e.g., אֶל תַּחַת הָאֵלֶּה, “toward under the oak tree” (Judg. 6:19); לַתַּחַת (MH), “to under,” e.g., וּשְׁנֵי עֵדִים, “and two Hebrew (signatures of) witnesses running from under this (document) to under that (document)” (m. Giṭ. 9:6); אֲשֶׁר תַּחַת (BH), “which is under,” e.g., אֲשֶׁר תַּחַת כָּל הַשָּׁמַיִם, “which is under all the heavens” (Gen. 7:19). שֶׁתַּחַת (MH), “which is under,” e.g., אֵין טָמֵא, “it is not impure only that which is under the body” (m. Zav. 4:4).¹⁷ The usage of תַּחַת in the Scroll is consistent with Mishnaic Heb-

12 Allegro, 51, 163 nn. 256-57; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

13 Milik, 295-96, 245 C-76, 270-71 D-38; 234 B-19g, 243 C-62; Milik^E, 142, 152.

14 Lurie, 117 and n. 2.

15 Beyer, 230-31.

16 Pixner, 354-55 and n. 43; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377; Wolters, 50-51; Wise, 197.

17 The prepositions אֶל and לְ are interchangeable, and so the relative אֲשֶׁר and שֶׁ. There are several other combinations of תַּחַת; e.g., לְמִתַּחַת, “to from under,” only in לְמִתַּחַת הַמִּסְגְּרוֹת, “below the borders” (1 Kgs 7:32); שֶׁמִּתַּחַת הָרֹבֵב אֲחֶר, “that from under a carob tree” (Gen. Rabbah 18).

rew. Finally, often *תחת*, *אֶל תַּחַת*, *לְתַּחַת*, *מִתַּחַת*, and *לְמִתַּחַת*, have practically the same meaning, “under, below, beneath.”

Allegro's drawing can be read as *הַשֶּׁקֶת*, i.e., the definite article plus *שֶׁקֶת* (defective). *שֶׁקֶת* (fem., pl. *שֶׁקֶתוֹת*, pl. const. *שֶׁקֶתוֹת*; from the root *שקה*, “to give drink”) means “trough.” It occurs only twice in the Masoretic Text: *וַתִּצְרַר בְּדֶהָ אֶל הַשֶּׁקֶת*, “and (Rebeca) emptied her jar into the trough” (Gen. 24:20); and *בְּשֶׁקֶתוֹת הַמַּיִם*, “in the water troughs” (Gen. 30:38). *שֶׁקֶת* is frequently used in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., *שְׁתֵּי שֶׁקֶתוֹת שֶׁבְּאַבֵּן אַחַת*, “two troughs which are in one stone” (m. Parah 5:8).¹⁸ According to Rashi, *שֶׁקֶת* is: (a) a grooved stone from which the camels drink (Gen. 24:20); (b) a grooved stone located next to a spring, with the water flowing into it through a perforation, and it is serving as a cattle trough (b. Yoma 58a); and (c) a grooved stone located below the duct into which the water is flowing down from the mountain (b. Yev 15a). The drawings of Milik and Baker can be read as *הַשִּׁקִּית* (the *yod* may indicate a Tiberian *šere*) or *הַשִּׁקֹּת* as variant spellings of *הַשֶּׁקֶת*; cf. *הַבְּאוֹת* for *הַבְּאוֹת* (see #1, 1:2).

The feminine *שֶׁקֶת* (penultimate stress) has an unique nominal pattern (*מִשְׁקֵל*) from which it is difficult to derive the plural construct state of *שֶׁקֶתוֹת*. Radak suggests that the plural forms of *שֶׁקֶת* are actually *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* (abs.) and *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* (const.). However, the plural *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* (abs.) and *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* (const.) are derived from the unattested singular *שֶׁקֶת* (sg.), like *צִפַּת*, “cover (of a beam)” (2 Chron. 3:15); or possible from *שֶׁקֶה*, like *שִׁפָּה*, “lip, brim, border,” pl. *שִׁפּוֹת*, pl. const. *שִׁפּוֹת*; e.g., *וּשְׁפָתוֹת כְּסִיל*, “and (the) lips of a fool” (Eccl. 10:12).¹⁹ Ibn-Janah considers *שֶׁקֶת* as a variant of *שִׁקֶּה*, and compares it to such double forms as *גְּבִירָה - גְּבִירָה*, *עֲטָרָה - עֲטָרָה*.²⁰

Based on the above, the following are additional possible readings and vocalizations. In many of these suggestions the *waw* may represent a Tiberian *gamaš* or *pataḥ*.

Allegro's drawing: *הַשִּׁקֶּה*, *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), etc.

Baker's and Milik's drawing: *הַשִּׁקֶּה*, *הַשִּׁקֶּה*, *הַשִּׁקֶּה*, *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), *הַשִּׁקֶּה*, *הַשִּׁקֶּה* (= *הַשֶּׁקֶה*), etc. The possible *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, could be variants of *שֶׁקֶת*, while *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, *שִׁקֶּה*, may be unattested plural forms.²¹

18 Ben-Yehuda says (8, 7454 n. 3) that in the Livorno Mishnah MS the vocalization for the absolute plural is *שֶׁקֶתוֹת*. He also notes that Radak and others derive the *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* from the unattested *שֶׁקֶת*, which will be discussed later.

19 *Mikhloḥ* (1842/3), 177b-178a. BDB (1052b) suggests that the singular of *שֶׁקֶתוֹת* is *שֶׁקֶת*.

20 *Sefer haššōrašim*, 531.

21 These possibilities can be compared with such feminine nouns (sg. and pl.) as: *שִׁקֶּה* - *שִׁקֶּה* (BH, MH), “branch (of a tree)”; *שִׁקֶּה* - *שִׁקֶּה* (MH), “short time, hour”; *שִׁקֶּה* - *שִׁקֶּה*.

Finally, Milik's drawing can also be read as שְׂקִיָּה = שְׂקִיָּא or שְׂקִיָּה = שְׂקִיָּא, "irrigated field," an Aramaism; e.g., כְּרוֹב שֶׁל שְׂקִיָּא, "a cabbage of an irrigated field" (m. Ter. 10:11).²² Accordingly, לְתַחַת הַשְׂקִיָּה הַשְּׂקִיָּה means, "below the irrigated field"; cf. שְׁבַל[מִשְׁקָה]שְׁבַל[מִשְׁקָה], "In/at/by the large cistern which is in/at/by a/the irrigated field" (see #15, 4:1, alt.).

The preferred reading is בֵּית הַמַּיִם שֶׁל יְהוּ לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, "By the pool of the water-closet of Jehu, below the trough." יְהוּ is a defective spelling for the personal name יְהוּא, Jehu, where the silent 'alef disappeared (cf. הוּ instead of הוּא; see #47, 10:10).²³ Furthermore, the Mishnah states:

Rabbi Judah ben Beteira said, "It was a precedent בֵּית הַמַּיִם בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם (with the trough of Jehu which was in Jerusalem) ... and everything requiring ritual cleanness in Jerusalem were made upon it (i.e., the trough was used as a ritual bath)" (m. Miq. 4:5; cf. b. Yev. 15a).

Since the Scroll is a cryptic document, בֵּימ may be an abbreviation for בֵּימָא = בֵּימָא, "in Je<rusale>m"; cf. the seven sets of Greek letter abbreviations in the Scroll (see Appendix C). In addition, בֵּית could mean בְּבֵית "in (the) house of" (see #46, 10:5). Accordingly, the phrase in question can be explained as, בֵּירוּשָׁלַיִם בְּבֵית הַמַּיִם שֶׁל יְהוּא לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, "In Jerusalem, in the water-closet/laundry of Jehu below the trough."

The above Mishnah relates a story regarding "the trough of Jehu which was in Jerusalem." This trough, an extension of a ritual bath, was used for purification. There are striking similarities between this Mishnah and this item. Both mention the Pool of Jehu, while the יָם might had been used as a

(BH), "waste"; שׁוּרָה - שׁוּרוֹת (MH), "row"; שְׂדָה - שְׂדוֹת (BH, MH), "carrying chair, box" (see #1, 1:3); שֵׁיבָה - שֵׁיבוֹת (BH, MH), "white hair, old age."

22 שְׂקִי is the masculine form of the feminine שְׂקִיָּא. These terms have been vocalized as follows. Jastrow (1622a): שְׂקִי, שְׂקִיָּא (H), שְׂקִיָּא, שְׂקִיָּא (A); Kohut: שְׂקִי, שְׂקִיָּא, שְׂקִיָּא (H), שְׂקִיָּא (A); Ben-Yehuda (8, 7429b and nn. 1-3): שְׂקִי, שְׂקִיָּא (H), the Mishnah also uses שְׂקִיָּא (A); Krupnik-Silbermann (2, 401b) שְׂקִיָּא (A); Even-Shoshan: שְׂקִי, שְׂקִיָּא (MH, masc.), שְׂקִיָּה (MH, fem., with a *he*), שְׂקִיָּא (A; ESH^{dic} 7, 2779a). Since Mishnaic Hebrew uses both forms, שְׂקִי and שְׂקִיָּא may be considered as Mishnaic Hebrew. Regarding the Aramaic forms, Onkelos renders אֶל הַשֶּׁקֶת as לְבֵית שְׂקִיָּא, "to the trough"; בְּשִׁקְתוֹת as בְּבֵית שְׂקִיָּא, "in the (place of) the trough"; כְּגַנַּת עַלִּי נָהָר as כְּגַנַּת עַלִּי נָהָר, "like an irrigated garden which is by the Euphrates" (Num. 24:6); and מִשְׁקָה as מִשְׁקָה, "irrigated land."

23 Jehu is the name of five persons in the Bible: Jehu ben Jehoshaphat ben Nimshi, King of Israel (e.g., 2 Kgs 9:2), Jehu ben Hanani the prophet (e.g., 1 Kgs 17:1), Jehu ben Josphibiah the Simeonite (1 Chron. 4:35), Jehu the Anathothite the Benjaminite (1 Chron. 12:3), and Jehu ben Obed, a descendant of Egyptian Jarha (1 Chron. 2:38). Regarding the latter, cf. הַקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֵבֶט (= הָעֵבֶר) הַיְרֵחִי, "In the grave of the Clan of Obet (= Obed) the Jerichoite" (see, #54, 11:9).

ritual bath, or as an abbreviation for Jerusalem. In the Mishnah cited in the beginning of this item, the four types of constructions, מְרִחֵץ, “bath-house,” בִּנְרִסְקִי, “tannery,” טְבִילָה, “ritual bath,” and בֵּית הַמַּיִם, “the water-closet/laundry,” all have to do with water. Perhaps, בֵּית הַמַּיִם of this item was attached to טְבִילָה, “a ritual bath” (cf. 1:12). Whether this item refers to the trough of Jehu mentioned in the Mishnah and Babylonian Talmud, it remains unresolved.

The following are additional possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the phrase in question.

שֶׁל יוֹחַי לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, “of Yohai, below the trough” — יוֹחַי is a defective spelling of the Mishnaic personal name יוֹחָאִי - יוֹחָאִי, Yohai,²⁴ a variant of the biblical personal name יוֹחָאָה, Joha (ʾalef-yod interchange).²⁵

שֶׁל יְחִיָּל (יְחִיאֵל) לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, “of Jehiel, below the trough” — יְחִיָּל could be a defective spelling of יְחִיאֵל, Jehiel, name of various Levites (e.g., 2 Chron. 35:8). Perhaps it was pronounced as יְחִיאֵל like דְּנִיאֵל - דְּנִיאֵל, Daniel, which is vocalized as דְּנִיאֵל instead the expected דְּנִיאֵל.²⁶ The name יְחִיָּל may be related to יוֹחָאִי - יוֹחָאִי, and יוֹחָאָה.

שֶׁל רַחֵל (רַחֵל) לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, “of Rachel, below the trough” — this is the reading of Lurie, Wolters, and Wise.

בְּיַם בֵּית הַמַּיִם שֶׁלּוֹ הוּא (הוּא) לְתַחַת הַשֶּׁקֶת, “In/at/by a/the pool of which its water-closet/laundry is below the trough” — הוּא is a defective spelling of הוּא, as mentioned earlier.²⁷

כַּכּ 17 (10:16), “(there are) 17 s(ilver) k(arsh)” — Regarding the abbreviation כַּכּ, see Appendix A.

24 E.g., the name of father of the famous Tanna Rabbi Simeon, רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּר יוֹחָאִי (m. Hag. 1:7).

25 Joha the Benjaminite (1 Chron. 8:16), and Joha, one of King David’s heroes (1 Chron. 11:45).

26 דְּנִיאֵל (defective) occurs three times in Ezekiel. Some editions vocalize it as דְּנִיאֵל, while others have a *ketiv-geri* situation, where the *geri* is דְּנִיאֵל. See Radak and *Minḥat Šay* on Ezek. 14:14; MK 2, 1395c-d; Gordis, 112; 174 n. 131; and H.M. Brecher, “[Masoretic Notes]” attached to *Tanakh im Targum Yehoash* (1957), 9b.

27 The possible reading of שֶׁלּוֹ was subsequently noted in the interpretation of Allegro^{Pr}.

ITEM 50

10:17 [בחצר הפנימי]ת בארבעת
11:1 מקצועותיה בכלי דמע בתכן אצלמ

10:17 [In the inne]r [courtyard], in its four
11:1 corners (the hidden objects) consist of dedicated
vessels with their lists next to them.

COMMENTARY

(10:17-11:1) דמע בכלי דמע [In/at/by the inne]r [courtyard], in/at/by its four corners (the hidden objects) consist of dedicated vessels" — ALLEGRO¹: "[...] in its four corners, in vessels of oil" (i.e., בארבעת מקצועותיה בכלי דמע, בכלי דמע, "In the ...] in its four inner corner buttresses: tithe vessels"; the *bet* before כלי is and error.¹ MILIK: בארבעת מקצועות זהב, "In the pool of Siloa]h", at the four corners: *gold* and vase(s) of aromatic spices." Alternately, באשיח השילו], "In the reservoir of Siloa]h"; בארבעת מקצועותיהם כלי דמע, "at their four corners ...," the third *bet* is read as a medial *mem*.² LURIE: בארבעת מקצועותיה בכלי דמע, "in its four corners (of the court of Rachel ?) in *dema*^c vessels."³ PIXNER: ".....h at the four corners, gold, tithe vessels" (i.e., בארבעת מקצועות זהב כלי, "[...] in the four corners of Waheb: vessels of tribute."⁴ WOLTERS: בארבעת מקצועות זהב דמע כלי, "[...] in the four corners of Waheb: vessels of tribute."⁵ וְהַב is a biblical toponym near Wadi Arnon (Num. 21:14). GARCIA MARTINEZ: "[In its pool,] at its four corners, tithe-vessels."⁶ BEYER: [ובברכת] בארבעת מקצועותיה (כ) בכלי דמע, "[and in] its [pool] in its four corners there are vessels with priestly shares." Beyer considers this and the previous item as one unit.⁷ VERMES: "[At ...] in the

1 Allegro, 52-52, 163 n. 260. Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 295-97, 301-02 "Addenda" D-39; Milik^E, 142. באשיח] and [בברכת], [ב...]. באשיח] are typographical errors for ח[...], ח[...בברכת] and ח[...באשיח].

3 Lurie, 117 and n. 1. In the copy of Allegro's drawing line 10:17 does not indicate a lacuna, starts with and contains only the word בארבעת. This error may have contributed to Lurie's note that "the corners of what" is not identified, and probably it is located in the Court of Rachel mentioned in the previous item.

4 Pixner, 355 ("on its four" seems to be a typographical error for "at the four"; cf. Milik's reading).

5 Wolters, 50-53.

6 Garcia Martinez, 463.

four angles: gold and vessels of offering.”⁸ WISE: “In the [Upp]er [Pool], in its four corners: votive vessels.”⁹

There is a lacuna of about ten letter spaces at the beginning of line 10:17. In MILIK’s drawing this is followed by a letter fragment of the upper left part of a *he/het/taw*. This letter fragment may be detected in the drawings of BAKER and ALLEGRO. Apparently two words are missing; they will be discussed later.

בְּאַרְבַּעַת, “in/at/by four (of),” is a compound of the preposition *bet* and אַרְבַּעַת, “four (of),” the construct state of אַרְבָּעָה (masc.) and אַרְבַּע (fem.).¹⁰

מִקְצוּעוֹת (Milik), “corners,” is the plural absolute form of מִקְצוּעַ, “corner” (usually masculine, but may be feminine). מִקְצוּעַ occurs earlier in the Scroll (see #11, 2:13).

מִקְצוּעוֹתֶיהָ (Allegro, Lurie), “its (fem.) corners,” is a compound of מִקְצוּעוֹת (pl. const.) plus the suffix יָה (third pers. fem. poss.).

מִקְצוּעוֹתֵיהֶם (Milik, alt.), “their four (masc.) corners,” it consists of מִקְצוּעוֹת plus the suffix יָהֶם (third pers. pl. masc. poss.); cf. וּמִשְׁחוֹתֵיהֶם, “and their measurements” (see #60, 12:12).

The first missing word seems to be a noun (common or proper) prefixed with the preposition *bet*, as in most items. Moreover, “four corners,” implies that the missing noun is area or construction that has four corners, such as חֲצִיר (masc., fem.), “courtyard” (see #3, 1:6); בֵּית (masc.), “house” (see #7, 2:3) חוֹמָה (fem.), “city-wall” (see #10, 2:10); בְּרֶכָה (fem.), “pool” (see #11, 2:13). This may be further limited if the word “corners” is read with a possessive suffix. If it is read as “its (fem.) four corners,” then the first noun must be feminine; if it is read as “their (masc.) corners,” then the first noun must be plural masculine.

The second missing word modifies the first noun, and perhaps prefixed with the definite article *he*. If the letter fragment is a part of a *he/taw*, then it seems to be feminine, such as הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה, “the upper” (cf. הַשִּׁיחַ הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה, “the upper pit,” 12:4), הַגְּדוֹלָה, “the large” (cf. בְּבִיכָא הַגְּדוֹלָה, “in the large drain,” 12:8), הַמְּזֻרְחִית, “the eastern” (cf. בְּשִׁית הַמְּזֻרְחִית, “in the eastern deep pit,” 4:11), הַמְּעֻרְבִית, “the western (fem.)” (cf. הַפְּנָא הַמְּעֻרְבִית, “the western corner,” 3:10), הַפְּנִימִית, “the inner.” If the letter fragment is a *het*, then it may be masculine or feminine. In any rate, the following suggested restorations are merely educated guesses.

בְּחֲצִירוֹבְחִיר הַחִיצוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוּעוֹת, “[In/at/by the oute]r [courtyard],

7 Beyer, 230-31.

8 Vermes, 377.

9 Wise, 197.

10 E.g. עַל אַרְבַּע כְּנָפוֹת הָאָרֶץ (*qeri*) vs. עַל אַרְבַּעַת כְּנָפוֹת הָאָרֶץ (*ketiv*), “upon the four corners of the earth” (fem., Ezek. 7:2); בֵּית אַרְבַּעַת קָבִין, “an area of four *qabin* (measurements)” (masc., m. B.B. 6:7).

in/at/by (the) four corners.”

בְּחֶצְרוֹבְחֶצֶר הַחִיצוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In/at/by the oute]r [courtyard], in/at/by its (fem.) four corners” — Cf. הַחֶצֶר הַחִיצוֹנָה, “the outer (Temple) court” (Ezek. 10:5); מֶחֶצֶר הַחִיצוֹנָה, “of the Outer Courtyard” (TS 46:6).

בְּחֹמָאֻבְחֹמָא הַחִיצוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹת, “[In/at/by the oute]r [city-wa]ll, in/at/by (the) four corners.”

בְּחֹמָאֻבְחֹמָא הַחִיצוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In/at/by the oute]r [city-wa]ll, in/at/by its four corners” — Cf. חוֹמָה חִיצוֹנָה לְעִיר דָּוִיד, “an outer wall for the city of David” (2 Chron. 33:14); כּוֹתֵל הַחִיצוֹן הִיא חוֹמָתָהּ, “the outer wall is its city-wall” (Sifra, Behar 57; cf. y. Ma’as. 3:4 [12b]); also בְּגִי הַחִיצוֹנָה, “in the Outer Valley” (see #34, 8:4).

בְּחֶצְרוֹבְחֶצֶר הַפְּנִימִית בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹת, “[In/at/by the inne]r [courtyard], in/at/by (the) four corners.”

בְּחֶצְרוֹבְחֶצֶר הַפְּנִימִית בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In/at/by the inne]r [courtyard], in/at/by its (fem.) four corners” — Cf. הַחֶצֶר הַפְּנִימִית, “the inner (fem.) courtyard” (1 Kgs 6:36; Ezek. 44:17; etc.); בְּחֶצֶר הַפְּנִימִי, “in the inner (masc.) courtyard” (Ezek. 40:44); בְּחֶצֶר בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ הַפְּנִימִית, “in the inner courtyard of the king” (Esth. 5:1).

בְּבִרְכָאֻבְבִּרְכָא הַעֲלִיּוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹת, “[In/at/by the uppe]r [pool], in/at/by (the) four corners.”

בְּבִרְכָאֻבְבִּרְכָא הַעֲלִיּוֹנָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In/at/by the uppe]r [pool], in/at/by its/their/(the) four corners” — These two suggestions can be compared with בְּבִרְכָאֻבְבִּרְכָא שְׁבַמְזוּחַ כְּחֵלֶת בְּמִקְצַעֻבְמִקְצַע הַצְּפוֹנִי, “In a/the pond which is at (the) east of Kahelet, in/at/by the northern corner,” (see #11, 2:13-14).

בְּבִרְכַת הַשִּׁילוֹיָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹת (cf. Milik), “[In/at/by the Pool of Shilo]h, in/at/by the four corners.”

בְּבִרְכַת הַשִּׁילוֹיָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In/at/by the Pool of Shilo]h, in/at/by its four corners” — Cf. אֵת מֵי הַשֶּׁלַח הַהֹלְכִים לְאֵט, “the waters of Shiloah that flow gently” (Isa. 8:6).

בְּבִרְכַת הַשֶּׁלָּח בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹת, “[In the Pool of Shela]h/Dit]ch, in/at/by (the) four corners.”

בְּבִרְכַת הַשֶּׁלָּח בְּאַרְבַּעַת מִקְצוֹעוֹתֶיהָ, “[In the Pool of Shela]h/Dit]ch, in/at/by its four corners” — Cf. הוּא יִבְנֶנּוּ ... וְאֵת חוֹמַת בְּרַכַת הַשֶּׁלַח לְגַן הַמֶּלֶךְ וְעַד, “he rebuilt it ... and the wall of the Pool of Shelah of the king’s garden, as far as the stairs that go down from the City of David” (Neh. 3:15).¹¹ Among others, שְׁלַח (masc., pl. שְׁלַחִין) means “ditch (for irrigation),” and שְׂדֵה בֵּית הַשֶּׁלַח is a “field that needs irrigation” (e.g., m. Mo’ed Q. 1:1; t. Mo’ed Q. 1:1).

11 Some equate שְׁלַח בְּרַכַת הַשֶּׁלַח with מֵי הַשֶּׁלַח (e.g., SB, 845b-846a; BDB, 1019b). שְׁלַח is also a personal name; Selah, the father of Eber, was the son of Arpachshad son of Shem son of Noah (Gen. 10:24; 1 Chron. 1:24, etc.).

בְּבֵתֵי הַחוֹמָה בְּאַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם, “[In the houses of the city-wall], in/at/by their (masc.) four corners” — Cf. בֵּיתָהּ בְּקִיר הַחוֹמָה וּבְחוֹמָהּ הִיא, “for her (Rahab’s) house was on the city wall and she resided within the wall” (Josh. 2:15).

בְּבֵתֵי גִזִּית בְּאַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם, “[In the hewn-stone houses], in/at/by their (masc.) four corners” — Cf. בְּתִי גִזִּית בְּנִיתָם וְלֹא תִשְׁבוּ בָם, “you have built houses of hewn stone, but you shall not live in them” (Amos 5:11).

בְּשְׁתֵּי חֲצוֹת בְּאַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם, “[In the two courtyard]s, in/at/by their (masc.) four corners” — Cf. בְּשְׁתֵּי חֲצוֹת בֵּית ה', “in the two courtyards of the House of the Lord” (2 Kgs 21:5, 23:12; 2 Chron. 33:5).

Obviously, one can add hundreds of similar suggestions. In addition, the first part of this item, ב...[...הַחוֹת בְּאַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹת וּמְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם מְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם] resembles the phrase [... בְּאֶמְאֻבָּאֵמָא שֶׁל [הַמִּימָן שֶׁל] הָאֲשׁוּחָהָא שִׁיחַ הַצְפוֹנִי שֶׁל ...] בְּאַרְבַּע רוֹחוֹת, “At the [water]-canal [of] the north[ern] pool [of ...] consisting of four sid[es]” (see #29, 7:3-5). It also can be compared with the following citations.

וַיּוֹצִיאֵנִי אֶל הַחֲצֵר הַחִיצוֹנָה וַיַּעֲבִירֵנִי אֶל אַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹי הַחֲצֵר וְהִנֵּה חֲצֵר בְּמִקְצַע הַחֲצֵר חֲצֵר בְּמִקְצַע הַחֲצֵר: בְּאַרְבַּעַת מְקוּצוֹת הַחֲצֵר חֲצוֹת קְטָרוֹת אַרְבָּעִים אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁלֹשִׁים רַחֵב מִדָּה אַחַת לְאַרְבַּעַתָּם מִהֶקְצֵעוֹת:

And he brought me out to the outer courtyard, and he led me past the four corners of the courtyard; and behold, there is an enclosure in the corner of the courtyard, there is an enclosure in the corner of the courtyard. In the four corners of the courtyard there are open enclosures, forty cubits long and thirty wide; the four are of the same size situated in the corners (Ezek. 46:21-22).

עֲזֵרֹת הַנָּשִׁים ... וְאַרְבַּע לְשָׁכוֹת הָיוּ בְּאַרְבַּע מְקוּצוֹתֶיהָ שֶׁל אַרְבָּעִים אַרְבָּעִים אָמָּה The Women’s Courtyard (of the Temple) ... and there were four chambers in its four corners of forty (by) forty cubits (m. Mid. 2:5).

The reading of the next two or three words depend on the realization of previous one. The following are the various possibilities.

כָּלִי דָמַע (Milik, alt.), “(there are an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels” (the previous word is read as מְקוּצוֹתֶיהֶם).

בְּכָלִי דָמַע (Allegro, Lurie), “(the hidden objects) consist of (an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels” (the previous word is read as מְקוּצוֹתֶיהָ) — The *bet* is a *bet essentiae*; cf. כְּלָגִין וְאַפּוּרִין, “consisting of flasks and jars” (see #4, 1:9).

בְּכָלִי דָמַע, “(there are an undisclosed number of objects) such as dedicated vessels” (the previous word is read as מְקוּצוֹתֶיהָ) — The *kaf* is a *kaf substantive*; cf. the alternate reading of כְּלָגִין וְאַפּוּרִין, “such as flasks and jars” (see #4, 1:9). Essentially these two suggestions have the same meaning.

זָהָב כָּלִי דָמַע (Milik), “(there are an unspecified amount of) gold (and an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels,” or “(there are) a gold

(piece/shekel and an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels" (the previous word is read as *מְקֻצְעוֹת* וְהָב — *וְהָב* is a valid reading; cf. the first word of line 12:1. In this phrase the connective *waw*, "and," is missing but understood. One would expect *וְהָב וְכֵלֵי דָמַע*, "(there are an unspecified amount of) gold and (an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels," or "(there are) a gold (piece/shekel) and (an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels." There are such cases in the Scroll; e.g., *כֶּכֶּרִינִי שְׁתִּימִי* (=*וְהָב*) *כֶּכֶּרִינִי* 60/80 כֶּכֶּרִינִי, "60/80 s(silver) k(arsh) and two talents of gold" (see #32, 7:16).

Finally, in this item the proper vocalization is *כֵּלֵי דָמַע*, "dedicated vessels," rather than the singular *כֵּל דָמַע*, "a dedicated vessel," since a single vessel cannot be hidden in all four corners of a structure. Regarding *כֵּלֵי דָמַע*, see Appendix D.

(11:1) *בְּתִכְוֹנָתָבְּן אֲצֻלָּם*, "with their lists next to them," or "their notes are with them" — The first word, as in other four cases, can be read either as *בתכן* or *כתבן*. The second word in the text reads *וצלם* or *יצלם*, *waw/yod* instead of an *'alef*, as later in line 11:4. It is either a scribal error, or the *waw* is a cursive *'alef*. For further discussion, see Appendix E.

Finally, based above the above discussion, this item informs the reader that there are hidden an undisclosed number of dedicated vessels and possibly an undisclosed amount of gold with lists (probably for additional information) at each of the four corners of a certain four cornered area or structure. Therefore, this item specifies four deposits.

ITEM 51

11:2 מתחת פנת האסטאן הדרומית
 11:3 בקבר צדוק תחת עמוד האכסדרן
 11:4 כלי דמע סות דמע סנה ותכן אצלם

- 11:2 Below the southern corner of the ossuary
 11:3 in the Grave of Zadok, under the pillar of the exedra
 11:4 are dedicated garments, dedicated pot vessels, and
 their lists are next to them.

COMMENTARY

(11:2) הַאֶסְטָאן הַדְּרוֹמִית (פֶּנֶת = מִתַּחַת פֶּנֶת), “Below the southern corner of the ossuary” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “Under the corner of the pillar, ‘Mysteries (Affliction) of Death’ (?)” (i.e., מות האסטאן רזי מות, מתחת, “beneath,” rarely in BH, usually following a verb; perhaps sc. “Take”; פֶּנֶת, final *nun* in medial position; האסטאן, “pillar, support,” cf. Syriac and Greek. רזי מות, “mysteries of death,” or דוי מות, “affliction of death”; cf. the “Stone which slays” (10:9). The other scholars read as above, and basically translate as, “below the southern corner of the Portico/Stoa,”¹ or “below the corner of the southern Portico/Stoa.”²

Additional comments of the scholars are as follows. ALLEGRO: מתחת implies a place some way off (cf. Ezek. 42:9, 46:23). אסטן for איסטבא, איסטווא (Jastrow, 54a); Syriac אסטוא, Greek *stoa*, “porch, portico. פֶּנֶת, medial *nun* in final position, cf. אכסדרא for אכסדרן in the next line. This “corner” is the “Pinnacle” of the Temple (Mt. 4:5; Lk. 4:9), the present southeast corner of the Haram. The *reš* of הדרומית is written as *yod/waw*.³ MILIK: הדרומית, cursive *reš*. אסטאן (i.e., אסטבוא/אסטבוא) the same as the Greek *stoa*. The colonnade of the eastern wall of the Esplanade was called “the Portico of Solomon” (John 10:23; Act 3:11, 5:12); etc.⁴ LURIE: אסטאן is the same as איסטבא, איסטווא, אצטבא, אצטבא הדרומית. PIXNER: האסטאן הדרומית, “the Southern Portico (of the

1 Allegro^{pr}; Allegro, 53; Allegro^{rev}, 26; Milik, 296-97; Milik^E, 142; Lurie, 118; Wacholder, *The Dawn of Qumran*, 100; Wolters, 52-53 (האסתאן is a typographical error for האסטאן); Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 230-31; Wise, 197.

2 Pixner, 355; Vermes, 377.

3 Allegro, 164 nn. 262-65.

4 Milik, 297; 230 B-14a, b, f; 273 D-54; Milik^E, 152.

5 Lurie, 118 and nn. 1-3 (הדרומית seems to be a printing error).

Temple).⁶ SHARVIT: אסטאן is the Greek "stoa," which occurs in Semahot 13. However, the scholars connect it with אסטבא - אסטבא (MH).⁷ THORION: מתחת means "under," rather than "from under" (cf. m. Pes. 4:7-8); its usages shows its relation to Mishnaic Hebrew.⁸ BEYER: אסטאן is ἡ στοά + n, "colonnade, portico."⁹

מן תחת (BH, MH) is a combined preposition, same as מן תחת, "from below." It actually means "below, beneath" (Allegro, Thorion); cf. מלמעל = מן על, "from upon" (5:8), and מן למעלה = מלמעלה, "from above" (10:2). Regarding תחת, see #49, 10:15.

פנת has a final *nun* in middle position (Allegro); cf. שבצפון = שִׁבְצָפוֹן (see #19, 4:11). It can be vocalized as: (1) פִּנָּת (const. of פִּנָּה), "corner (tower) of" (see #12, 3:1); e.g., עַד פִּנָּת שְׁעַר הַסּוּסִים מִזְרְחָה, "to the corner of the Horse Gate toward the east" (Jer. 31:40). (2) פִּנֹּת (defective of פִּנָּת, plural abs. and const. of פִּנָּה), "corners (of)"; e.g., וְאֵל אַרְבַּע פִּנּוֹת הָעוֹרָה, "and on the four corners of the ledge" (Ezek. 43:20, 45:19).

הָאֶסְטָאן = הָאֶסְטָן has a medial *nun* in final position (Allegro); cf. בְּאֶמְצַעַן (4:7), שְׁבָעִי (4:12), כְּכָרִי (7:16), מִן (9:10), and הָאֶסְטָדָּן (11:3).

Most lexicographers derive אסטן from the Greek στοά, "portico," an open space covered by a roof which is supported by columns (see #3, 1:7); it is connected with אֶסְטָבָא, אֶסְטָוָא, and אֶסְטָבָא. According to Shadal, אֶסְטָוָא, the Targum for עמוד, "pillar, platform,"¹⁰ is like the Syriac אסטווא, and that Eliah Levita erred by explaining אסטווא as a variant of אצטווא.¹¹ The terms אֶסְטָבָא, אֶסְטָוָא, and אֶסְטָוָא (explained as "bench, platform") are used interchangeable in Mishnaic Hebrew.¹² E.g.,

And further Rabbi Judah said, "Two invalidated loaves of bread of a thanks offering were left lying on the roof of the אֶסְטָבָא (of the Temple)" (m. Pes. 1:5).

Indeed it was so taught (in a baraita), "(There was around) the Temple

6 Pixner, 355 n. 45.

7 "Iyyunim," 135.

8 Thorion, 172-73.

9 Beyer, 231.

10 Targum Jonathan renders העמוד as אֶסְטָוָא (2 Kgs 11:14), which according to Radak, means סִטְיָ, i.e., a סִפְסָל, "bench, platform," upon which the princes are sitting. Jastrow (54b) translates אֶסְטָוָא as "a balcony."

11 S.D. Luzzatto (= Shadal), *Ohev Ger*, 106.

12 Rashi says that the merchants used to sit on אֶסְטָוָא in front of their stores (b. Shab. 6b). He explains אֶסְטָבָא in various ways: a colonnade located on the Temple Mountain where people gathered and sat (b. Pes. 11a); a chair made of bricks and lime (b. Bes. 32b); a structure made of stones (b. Mo'ed Q. 10b; b. Zev. 35a); a chair (b. Pes. 13b; b. Ta'an. 14b); a bench (b. Suk. 42b) (see HR 3, 71, 87). According to *Tif'eret Israel*, אֶסְטָוָא (pl. אֶסְטָוָוּת), a variant of אֶסְטָבָא, mean a bench made for ornament in front of a house at the side of its entrance (m. Oh. 18:9). The offered vocalization basically follow Jastrow's dictionary.

Mountain סְטִיּוֹ כְּפּוֹל (a double colonnade).” Rabbi Judah says, “It was called אִיסְטוֹנוּיַת (which was) סְטִיּוֹ לְפָנִים מִסְטִיּוֹ (a colonnade within a colonnade)” (b. Pes. 13b).

אִיסְטוֹנוּיַת is a private domain concerning (carrying on the) Sabbath, while a public domain concerning (ritual) uncleanness (m. Toḥ. 6:9).

אִיסְטוֹנוּיַת are not considered to be dwellings of the idolaters (m. Oh. 18:9).

Since עַמּוּד, “column, pillar, platform” (see #25, 6:1), is mentioned in this item, logically אִיסְטוֹנָא is a variant of אִיסְטוֹנָא. However, אִיסְטוֹן occurs once in Semahot (as mentioned by Sharvit), a minor tractate of the Talmud.

“He who finds bones in a קֶבֶר (grave), he should place them in hidden places,” these are the words of Rabbi Akiba. But the sages say, “he shall not remove from their place.” He who finds (bones) in a כּוֹף־כּוֹף (burial niche) or in an אִיסְטוֹן, he shall not remove them from their place (Semahot 13:6).¹³

Kohut considers אִיסְטוֹן as a Persian word (אִיסְטוֹנָה, אִיסְטוֹן), and translates it as “burial place.” Others connect אִיסְטוֹן with the Persian *astodan*, “bone holder,” where the *dalet* of אִיסְטוֹדָן is assimilated, or they derive אִיסְטוֹן from ὀστοῦν, “bones.”¹⁴ Ben-Yehuda says that אִיסְטוֹן, “ossuary,” a small *kokh* in which people used to deposit human bones, is of unknown origin.¹⁵ Meyers recognized that אִיסְטוֹן of Semahot is identical with ὀστοῶν, *oston*, “ossuaries,” of a Beth She‘arim inscription (#131:3). The plural ὀστοῶν is defined as “vessels in which the bones were deposited,” rather than “bones.” The singular ὀστῶν is rendered as “sarcophagus.”¹⁶

The phrase אִיסְטוֹן אִיסְטוֹן is usually explained as “north side, north wind” (b. Ket. 23a; cf. b. Qid. 12b; b. B.B. 135a).¹⁷ According to Barsilai, אִיסְטוֹן is a variant of אִיסְטוֹן, and in Persian אִיסְטוֹן means “place of the burial.”¹⁸ The let-

13 Some versions have אִיסְטוֹרָן instead of אִיסְטוֹן, which is rendered as “loculus,” see D. Zlotnick, *The Tractate “Mourning”* (1966), 37, 84, 164 n. 6; also E.M. Meyers, *Jewish Ossuaries: Reburial and Rebirth* (1971), 51.

14 AC, 1, 171b; S. Kraus, AAC, 42b-43a; L. Ginzberg, “Notes to Aruch Completum,” AAC, 429a; CTL, 70 and nn. 296-97; S. Kraus, *Griechische und Lateinische Lehnwörter im Talmud, Midrash und Targum* (1899) 2, 81.

15 BY 1, 325b and n. 1.

16 *Beth She‘arim* 2, 116-19, 204; E.M. Meyers, *Jewish Ossuaries: Reburial and Rebirth* (1971), 51-52, 61-62; 65 n. 79, where Milik’s reading of מִדְּרָךְ in the Scroll is mentioned. Apparently Meyers, relying on the readings of Milik and Allegro, overlooked the term אִיסְטוֹן.

17 According to Rashi, אִיסְטוֹן means “north,” as the Targum for מִצְפּוֹן in Job is מִדְּאִיסְטוֹנָא, “from the north” (b. Ket. 23a; cf. Rashi on Job 37:22); and אִיסְטוֹן אִיסְטוֹן means “at north side” (b. Qid. 12b). The latter is explained by Rabbeinu Gershom as, “in the south at the end of the world” (b. B.B. 135a). However, “south” may be a typographical error for “north.” In Job 37:22 מִצְפּוֹן has two Targumim, מִצְפּוֹנָא, “from the north,” and מִן צְפוֹנָא אִיסְטוֹנָא, “from the north the winds.” The latter is similar to Rashi’s version. Ben-Yehuda (1, 334b and n. 2) renders אִיסְטוֹן as “north,” cf. Akkadian *ištanu*, “north,” and Aramaic אִיסְטוֹנָא, “north wind.”

18 A. Marcus, *Barsilai* (Heb., 1983), 336. Accordingly, the phrase אִיסְטוֹן אִיסְטוֹן

ters *tet* and *taw* often interchange, especially in words of non-Semitic origin.

אָסְטָאן can be rendered as "ossuary, platform, bench." אָסְטָאן of the Copper Scroll, אָסְטָן of Semaḥot, and ὀστωῶν of a Beth She'arim inscription, is the same technical burial term. The presence of אָסְטָאן in Copper Scroll may support the view that the tractate Semaḥot is of Tannaic origin.¹⁹

The word הַדְרוּמִית, "the southern (fem.)," is written as הַדְרוּמִית, where the first *waw* could be a short-headed *reš*, i.e., הַדְרוּמִית; or a final short-legged *nun* in medial position, i.e., הַדְרוּמִית = הַדְנוּמִית = הַדְרוּמִית (*nun-reš* interchange). For similar cases, see #37, 8:14. Regarding geographical directions, see #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

The phrase מִתַּחַת פֶּתַח (= פֶּתַת) הָאֶסְטָאן הַדְרוּמִית can be interpreted as follows. מִתַּחַת פֶּתַת דְּרוּמִית שֶׁל הָאֶסְטָן, "Below the southern corner of the ossuary," where פֶּתַת refers to דְּרוּמִית (both fem.), and אֶסְטָאן (sg.) could be masculine or feminine. And מִתַּחַת פֶּתַת וּפְנוֹת הָאֶסְטָן הַדְרוּמִית, "Below the corner(s) of the southern ossuary," where פֶּתַת and פְּנוֹת refer to אֶסְטָאן, while דְּרוּמִית modifies אֶסְטָאן. According to the latter, אֶסְטָאן must be feminine.

בְּקֶבֶר צָדוֹק (11:3), "in the grave of Zadok," is like גִּבְתָּ צָדוֹק, "opposite to the Garden of Zadok." Perhaps Zadok's grave was located in the Garden of Zadok. If so, the garden was a burial site (see #52, 11:6).

Often the name Zadok is associated with the priesthood. E.g., וְהַכֹּהֲנִים וְצָדוֹק, "and the priests the Levites the sons of Zadok" (Ezek. 44:15);²⁰ בְּנֵי צָדוֹק הַכֹּהֲנִים, "the sons of Zadok the priests" (1QS 5:2-9). The Tanna Rabbi Zadok the priest officiated in the Temple, and lived at time of its destruction (e.g., m. 'Ed. 7:1-5). He fasted forty years to prevent the destruction of the Temple (b. Git. 56a). His grandson was Zadok ben Rabbi Eliezer the priest (b. Qid. 40a).

צָדוֹק, Zadok, and בִּיתוֹס, Boethus, two disciples of Antigonos of Sokho, misinterpreted their teacher's maxim. They established the sects of the צָדוֹקִין, Sadducees, after צָדוֹק, and בִּיתוֹסִין, Boethusians, after בִּיתוֹס (*Avot*

וְתֹאמְרָא (b. Ket. 23a) would mean, "the witnesses are in the burial place, therefore, she should be forbidden (to remarry or keep her marriage)?" i.e., the witnesses are dead.

19 Many consider Semaḥot to be of late origin (cf. AAC, 42b-43a), perhaps originating in the eighth century. However, Zlotnick suggests that it is from the third century CE, because the text is Mishnaic Hebrew, and both the style and structure are Tannaic (*The Tractate "Mourning"* [1966], 4-7; "Semaḥot," *EJ* 14, 1138-39).

20 Also, אֶל הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִזֶּרַע צָדוֹק, "to the priests the Levites that are from the descendant of Zadok" (Ezek. 43:19); אֶזְרִיָּהוּ הַכֹּהֵן הָרִאשׁ לְבֵית צָדוֹק, "Azariah the Chief Priest of the House of Zadok" (2 Chron. 31:10). Zadok was the Chief Priest at the time of David and Solomon (e.g., 2 Sam. 19:12; 1 Kgs 1:34); Zadok the father-in-law of King Uzziah (2 Kgs 15:33; 1 Chron. 27:1). Moreover, several persons are named Zadok among the returnees from Babylon to Palestine (e.g., Neh. 3:4, 29).

deRabbi Natan 5:2).²¹

An Old-Hebrew inscription from Silwan near Jerusalem reads, **צדק בן פתה**. Kutscher reads the first name as **צִדְקָה** (e.g., 2 Sam. 8:17), and compares ...**פתה** with **פְּתוּאֵל**, Pethuel, the father of Joel (Joel 1:1), and the spelling with **עֲשָׂהאֵל**, Asahel (e.g., 2 Sam. 2:18), where the *he* was retained.²²

Finally, it is also possible to read the phrase in question as **בְּקֶבֶר צִדִּיק** (with a *yod*), “in/at/by a/the grave of a righteous man,” as well as **בְּגֵד צִדִּיק**, “opposite (the) grave of a righteous man,” in the next item (see #52, 11:6).²³ Both **צִדִּיק** (masc., pl. **צִדִּיקִים**) and the name **צִדּוֹק** are derived from the root **צדק**, “to be righteous.” Cf. **הַקֶּבֶר אִישׁ הָאֱלֹדִים**, “It is the grave of the man of God” (2 Kgs 23:17); **בֵּית צִדִּיק**, “house of a righteous (man)” (Prov. 15:6); **שִׁמְעוֹן הַצִּדִּיק הָיָה מִשְׁנֵי הַכְּנָסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה**, “Simeon the Righteous was from the remnants of the Great Synod” (m. ’Avot 1:2); **אֵין עוֹשִׂים נִפְשׁוֹת לְצִדִּיקִים**, “One does not built tombs for righteous men” (y. Sheq. 2:5 [9b]; see #2, 1:6). Interestingly, a Punic tomb stone reads, **טענא עבן ו לפוליע**, **הַצִּדִּיקָה הַצִּדְקָה** (= **הַצִּדִּיקָה הַצִּדְקָה** in Hebrew), “This stone was erected to Pulia the righteous (fem.).”²⁴

הָאֶכְסֶדְרָא (medial *nun* in final position) is a variant of **הַצִּדְקָה**, “the exedra.” Often silent *’alef/he* in final position interchanges with *mem/nun*, and closes the last open syllable of a word having a *qamaṣ* or *ḥolam*. For further discussion, see #35, 8:8.

אֶכְסֶדְרָא = **אֶכְסֶדְרָא** is from the Greek *ἐξέδρα* and Latin *exedra*,²⁵ as the scholars point out.²⁶ It is a common Mishnaic Hebrew term; e.g., **אֶכְסֶדְרָא**

21 Wacholder discusses who is Zadok mentioned the Temple and Copper Scrolls, Damascus Document, etc. He cites items #50 and #51, and basically follows Milik’s version (*The Dawn of Qumran* [1983], 99-102, 153; see Discussion).

22 E.Y. Kutscher, “כתובות ירושלים מימי הבית הראשון” in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* (1977), 172; also see *KAI* 1, 35; 2 189 (#191A).

23 Allegro reads *šdwq*, renders Zadok, and notes, “More accurately *šaddūq* (cf. *LXX Saddouk*) or *šaddiq*” (Allegro, 53, 164 n. 266).

24 See *KAI* 1, 28; 2, 147 (#154:1-2). In addition, two Phoenician inscriptions read, **בְּ מֶלֶךְ צִדְקָה וּמֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל**, “because (he was a) righteous king and honest king” (*KAI* 1, 1; 2, 6-7 [#4:6-7]), and **בְּ מֶלֶךְ צִדְקָה וּמֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל**, “because he is/was a righteous king” (*KAI* 1, 2; 2, 12 [#10:9]). Since Donner and Röllig list **צדק** and **צדיק** together, their reading seems to be **צִדִּיק** and **צִדִּיקָה** (*KAI* 3, 21a). **צִדִּיק** (masc., BH) means “righteousness” (e.g., Lev. 19:36).

25 See *AC* 1, 79b-80a (where Kohut vocalizes as **אֶכְסֶדְרָא**); Jastrow, 64a (vocalized as **אֶכְסֶדְרָא**).

26 Allegro^{pr} (equates it with **אֶכְסֶדְרָא**, and notes the medial *nun* in final position; cf. 11:2); Allegro, 53, 164 n. 267; Allegro^{rev}, 26; Milik, 296-97, 230 B-14, 246-47 C-84; Milik^E, 142; Lurie, 118-19 and n. 5; Pixner, 355; “lyyunim,” 135. Wolters, 52-53; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 374-78. Beyer (225-26, 230-31) reads **אֶכְסֶדְרָא**, *τὸ ἐξέδριον*, “small vestibule,” and **פֶּרִיסְטִילִין**, *περιστύλιον*, “small peristyle” (1:7). Wise (197) renders “small portico.”

שֶׁנִּסְדָּרָה, “an exedra that is cracked” (m. Oh. 11:2). אֶכְסֵדְרָה is a covered structure in front of a house having three walls and a flat roof, while the fourth one is open to the courtyard, a porch.²⁷ Exedra also occurs in Neo-Punic (with an inserted *nun*), בְּנָה וְהִקְדִּישׁ אֶת (= בָּנָה וְאִיקְדֵּשׁ ת עכסנדרע, “he built and he consecrated the exedra.”²⁸

(11:4) (סִירָה =) סִירָה דְּמַע סוֹת דְּמַע סִירָה (*nun-reš* interchange), “dedicated garments (and) dedicated pot vessels,” or “a dedicated garment (and) a dedicated pot vessel,” is similar to the phrases: סִירָה אוֹ דְּמַע אוֹ סִירָה, “(a) dedicated vessel(s) and/or (a) dedicated garment(s)” (11:10); <דְּמַע> סִירָה, “(a) dedic<ated> liquid vessel(s) (and) (a) dedicated pot(s)” (11:14); and סִירָה וְלְבוּשִׁין, “(a) dedicated vessel(s) and garments” (3:9). For a detailed discussion, see Appendix D.

(11:4) וְתִכְּנֵן אֶצְלָם, “and their lists are next to them,” may mean אֶצְלָם, “with their lists next to them” (*bet-waw* interchange), or it can be amended to וְתִכְּנֵן אֶצְלָם, “and <with> their lists next to them.” However, if the other four cases of this phrase are read as וְתִכְּנֵן אֶצְלָמוֹן, then the text must be amended to וְתִכְּנֵן אֶצְלָמוֹן, “and their <no>tes are next to them.”

The second word here, as well as in line 11:1 in the previous item, has וצלמ or וצלמ, *waw* or *yod* instead of an *alef*. It is either a scribal error, or the *waw* is a cursive *alef*. For other possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations of this difficult phrase, see Appendix E.

Finally, the unusual spellings and/or scribal errors in this item (פֶּתֶן, וְתִכְּנֵן אֶצְלָמוֹן, וצלמ, סִירָה, האכסדרה, הדוומית, האסטאנ, six or seven out of sixteen words, demonstrate the inconsistency of the scribes. These findings suggest the following five possibilities, some being mutually exclusive: (1) The *Vorlage* contained scribal errors which were simply copied by the engravers. (2) The engraving was done by dictation. (3) The engravers were illiterate. (4) The engravers did not comprehend Hebrew. (5) The engravers introduced new errors.

27 Rashi renders אֶכְסֵדְרָה in Old-French as פּוֹרְקָא, “porch,” and פּוֹרְטִיקָא, “portico” (b. Yoma 11b; b. Men. 28b, 33b; b. Suk. 3b, 17a; b. ‘Eruv. 25b; see HR 3, 46; Catane, 48a #746). Some commentators disagree with Rashi. Regarding the Halakhic ramifications of exedra, see “אֶכְסֵדְרָה” *ET*^E 2, 253-57; *ET*^H 1, 822-26. Interestingly, Neusner renders אֶכְסֵדְרָה as “peristyle” (m. Suk. 1:10).

28 *KAI* 1, 25; 2, 133 (#129:1).

ITEM 52

11:5 בתבסת ראש הסלע הצופא מערב

11:6 נגד גנת צדוק תחת המסמא ה-->

11:7 גדולא שבשולו הו חרמ כ 10

- 11:5 In the ruin at the top of the rock which is facing west,
 11:6 in front of the Garden of Zadok below the large
 11:7 stone block which is at its rim, (the deposit) is
 consecrated, (it consists of) 10 (unspecified) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(11:5) בתבסת\בתבסת ראש הסלע "In/at/by a/(the) ruin of/at the top of the rock" or "In/at/by (the) immediate earth surrounding a/the corpse at the top of the rock" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the clearing at the top of the crag" (i.e., הסלע, בהכסה, cf. הכרה, Isa. 3:9), but such form would assume an unattested *Hif'il* form. כיסוח (MH), "clearing" of thorns, cf. Isa. 33:12. Rendering "in it, a clearing ..." is possible, but the reference of the suffix is unclear. ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the exedra of the crag." ALLEGRO: (ל) באכסדרא, הסלע, "In the exedra of the cliff"; the text has בהכסהרא; alternatively שבסלע. ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the treading place (?) at the top of the cliff."¹ MILIK: בהבסה ראש הסלע, "in a family plot (situated) at the top of the rock." הבסה is related to תבוסה, תפוסה, and תפיסה.² GREENFIELD takes "strong exception" to Milik's interpretation of בהבסה.³ LURIE: בחבסה ראש הסלע, "In the breach (or pit) which is at the top of the cliff"; cf. חביסה (b. B.M. 116b).⁴ PIXNER: "on the treading place (בהבסה) at the top of the rock."⁵ WA-

1 Allegro, 53, 164-65 nn. 271-72; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 296-97, 234 B-19c, 247 C-87; Milik^E, 142.

3 Greenfield, 139b.

4 Lurie, 119-20 and n. 1 (שבראש הסלע) is an typographical error for שראש הסלע). Lurie refers to תבוסה נפלו אם בחביסה נפלו ... אם בחביסה נפלו ... "a house and an upper story belonging to two (person) which fell down ... whether it fell through shock, or it fell through pressure," of which the first phrase is the Mishnah (m. B.M. 10:1), while the second is Dimitrovsky's Hebrew translation of the Aramaic text of the Gemara, אַי בְּחִבְסָא נְפֻל אַי בְּחִבְסָא נְפֻל (b. B.M. 116b; *Talmud Bavli im Targum 'Ivri ... Bava' Meši'a'* [1960], 225). Jastrow (420b) renders חִבְסָא as "crush through pressure"; cf. Rashi; *He'Arukh*, 208a, AC 3, 334b. Rashi uses חִבְסָא with the meaning of "pressing" (b. H. 43a; HR 1, 423; 3, 335; cf. ESh^{dic} 2, 707b).

CHOLDER (reads as Milik): "in a garden (situated) on top of the rock."⁶ WOLTERS: בהכסה ראש הסלע, "In the 'Throne', the top of the cliff."⁷ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "in the concession at the top of the rock."⁸ BEYER: בהכסה ראש הסלע, "In the sudden fall of the peak of rock." *Nif'al* infinitive.⁹ VERMES: "at the ... (?) at the top of the rock."¹⁰ WISE agrees with Wolters.¹¹

The first two words consist of *bet/kaf*, *he/het/taw*, *bet/kaf*, *samekh*, *he/het/taw*, *'alef*, and *šin*. Later, perhaps a second scribe, added a superlinear *reš* positioned between the *he/het/taw* and *'alef*. Cf. the superlinear *lamed* and *yod* of השלישי, and *mem* of בימ (see #7, 2:4; #49, 10:15). The superlinear *reš* and the next two letters form the word ראש. The first word can be read as: בהכסה (Milik, Pixner), בהבסת, בהבסת, בהכסה (Wolters), בהכסת (Allegro^{rev}, Beyer), בהכסת, בחכסה (Lurie), בחכסת, בחכסת (Lurie), בחכסת, בחכסת, בתבסה, בתבסת, בתכסה, בתכסת, etc.

As in most items, the first word is a noun with the preposition *bet*. Since the next word, a noun, is neither preceded by של nor prefixed with ש-ב, the first noun must be in the construct state. If the first noun is feminine, then the fifth letter is a *he* or *taw*, rather than *het*. The most accurate reading may be בתבסת, defective spelling of בְּתִבְסֵת or בְּתִבְסֵת, same as בְּתִבְסֵת שְׁלֹשָׁה or בְּתִבְסֵת שְׁלֹשָׁה, "in/at/by a/(the) depression of" or "in/at/by a/(the) ruin of." These feminine nouns are formed by the prefix ת- and the suffix ה-, from the root בוס, "to tread, trample"; cf. תְּרוּמָה (fem.), "elevated gift," from the root רום, "to rise, be high." The term תְּבוּסָה occurs in the phrase תְּבוּסַת אֲחִזְיָה, "downfall of Ahaziah" (2 Chron. 22:7).¹² These suggestions resemble somewhat Milik's reading.

On the other hand, תְּבוּסָה and תְּבִיסָה may be variants of תְּפוּסָה and תְּפִיסָה (*bet-pe* interchange). תְּפוּסָה (MH, *Pe'ulah*, *Qal* pass. part. fem. sg., used as a noun) and תְּפִיסָה (MH, *Pe'ilah*, fem. sg.), both from the root תפס (MH) - תפש (BH), "to seize." Regarding the *Pe'ulah* and *Pe'ilah* forms, see #1, 1:1.

5 Pixner, 356. Cf. Allegro^{rev}. In Modern Hebrew הִבְסָה (fem.) means "rout, heavy defeat," from the root בוס, "to tread down, trample"; cf. כְּגִבְרִים בּוֹסִים בְּטִיט, "like warriors trampling in the mud" (Zech. 10:5).

6 *The Dawn of Qumran*, 100 (שא is a topographical error for ראש).

7 Wolters, 52-53.

8 Garcia Martinez, 463.

9 Beyer, 230, 232.

10 Vermes, 377.

11 Wise, 197.

12 תְּבוּסָה is related to תְּבוּסָה (fem.), "subjugated" (Isa. 18:2,7, 22:5; cf. Radak on 2 Chron. 22:7; also SB, 878a; BDB, 101a), both are from the root בוס, "to crush, tread under." The roots בוס (e.g., Ps. 60:14), בסס (e.g., m. 'Uqs, 1:8), and בסה (Zech. 10:8) are from the bilateral root בס. Also בוס is related to the roots בוש, בוץ, and בוש. The name of בִּיבְס, Jebus (e.g., Judg. 19:10-11), may originate from this root family (cf. SB, 94b-95b; S. Kraus, "Über Siedlungstypen in Palästina in talmudischer Zeit," *MGWJ* 82 [= NF 46] [1938], 175-76).

In the Talmud תְּבוּסָה, תְּפוּסָה, and תְּפוּשָׁה, as well as תְּפוּסָה and תְּפִיסָה are used interchangeably. They mean either “seizure, possession,” or “ruin, depression” (cf. חֲרוּבָה, חֲרִיבָה, also גָּר; see #1, 1:1; 9:15, #43, 9:15).¹³ Often the term תְּבוּסָה is associated with grave sites. E.g.,

(If) one finds the first time (in his field) a corpse (in a grave) lying in a usual manner, he may remove (the body) with its תְּבוּסָה (to rebury it in a graveyard; m. Naz. 9:3).

תְּבוּסָה (in some manuscripts תְּפוּסָה, תְּפוּשָׁה) has been explained as the immediate earth surrounding the corpse in the burial site that legally belongs to the deceased. For reburial the תְּבוּסָה must be taken with the body.¹⁴

רֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע = רֹאשׁ שֶׁל הַסֶּלַע, “the head/top of the rock,” is like שֶׁן הַסֶּלַע = שֶׁן שֶׁל הַסֶּלַע, “the tooth/peak of the rock,” which occurs earlier in the Scroll, as well as in the Masoretic Text (see #10, 2:11).

הוּא הָכָה אֶת אָדוֹם בְּגִיא הַמֶּלֶח (כ, מֶלֶח ק) עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים וַתִּפֹּשׂ אֶת הַסֶּלַע בַּמִּלְחָמָה וַיִּקְרָא אֶת שְׁמָהּ יִקְתָּאֵל עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה:

(King Amaziah) struck Edom in the Valley of Salt, ten thousand (men), and captured the Rock by war. And (King Amaziah) called it Joktheel (which is its name) to this day (2 Kgs 14:7).

וְאַמְצִיָּהוּ הִתְחַזַּק וַיִּנְהַג אֶת עַמּוֹ וַיִּלְךָ גִּיא הַמֶּלֶח וַיֵּךְ אֶת בְּנֵי שְׁעִיר עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים: וַעֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים חַיִּים שָׁבוּ בְנֵי יְהוּדָה וַיָּבִיאוּם לְרֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע וַיִּשְׁלִיכוּם מֵרֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע וְכָלֶם גְּבָקְעוּ:

And (King) Amaziah took courage, and led his people; and he went to the Valley of Salt, and struck ten thousand sons of Seir. That is, the sons of Judah captured ten thousand (men) alive, and they brought them to the top of the Rock, and they threw them off from the top of the Rock, and all of them burst open (2 Chron. 25:11-12).¹⁵

Comparing these two descriptions, one arrives at the following two possibilities. (1) רֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע refers to the top of a certain rock in the Valley of Salt in Edom near its capital city Sela^c, where the killings took place. (2) הַסֶּלַע, the Sela^c (or “the Rock”), is an abbreviated form for רֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע, Rosh-hasSela^c (or “Top of the Rock”). According the latter, רֹאשׁ הַסֶּלַע in the Scroll may be a toponym (see #13, 3:8).¹⁶ In addition, the Hebrew name for

13 See Jastrow, 1643b, 1685a, 1686ab. תְּבוּסָה - תְּפוּסָה refers to a dying person or a dead body; e.g., דָּם תְּבוּסָה, “mixed blood,” or “blood flowing from a dying person” (m. Oh. 2:2). In addition, תְּפוּסַת הַבַּיִת means “a property that belongs to the house” (e.g., b. B.B. 137b); תְּפִיסַת יָד, “grasp of the hand” (e.g., m. ‘Eruv. 8:4).

14 See Bertinoro, *Tosephot Yom-Tov, Tif’eret Israel, Šinuyei Nusha’ot*.

15 The first letter of the last verse is an explanatory *waw* (“that is”), clarifying how the ten thousand men were killed, rather than indicating that an additional ten thousand men were thrown down from the top of the Rock, as is rendered, surprisingly, by most translations (e.g., JPS, Koren, *Tanach*, Yehoash). This barbaric act of Amaziah was later condemned by the Rabbis (see Rashi, who refers to Lam. Rabbati Petiḥa’ 14; also Malbim).

16 The Targum of הַסֶּלַע is כְּרֵכָא, “the fortified city” (2 Kgs 14:7). According to Radak, the fortification was on the rock. Regarding its Mishnaic Hebrew equivalent כְּרֵךְ, see #56,

נַחַל הַכְּפָא, “the Wadi Kefah” or “Wadi of the Rock,” of the Scroll may have been נַחַל הַסֵּלַע (see #24, 5:12).

Based on the above, בְּתִבּוּסָהּ וּבְתִבִּיטָהּ רֹאשׁ הַסֵּלַע means בְּתִבּוּסָהּ וּבְתִבִּיטָהּ שֶׁל רֹאשׁ הַסֵּלַע or בְּתִבּוּסָהּ וּבְתִבִּיטָהּ שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁ הַסֵּלַע, “in/at/by a/the ruin at/on a/the top of the rock,” or “in/at/by a/the grave-earth surrounding the corpse at/on (the) top of the rock.”

(11:5) הַצּוּפָא הַצּוּפָא מֵעֶרֶב, “which is facing west” — If הַצּוּפָא refers to the first word of this item, which seems to be feminine noun, then it should be vocalized as הַצּוּפָה מֵעֶרֶב, “which is facing (fem.) west.” If הַצּוּפָא refers to the masculine הַסֵּלַע רֹאשׁ, it should be vocalized as הַצּוּפָה מֵעֶרֶב, “which is facing (masc.) west” (see #25, 6:2).

(11:6) בְּגִד גִּנֶּת צִדּוֹק, “in the front of the Garden of Zadok” — גִּנֶּת is the construct state for גִּנָּה or גִּנָּה, “garden” (fem., Isa. 1:30), the same as גִּן (masc.), which appears earlier in the Scroll as an alternate reading (see #47, 10:8). גִּן, גִּנָּה, and גִּנָּה are from the root גָּנַן, “to protect.”¹⁷ E.g., בְּחֶצֶר גִּנֶּת, “in the courtyard of the garden of the palace of the king” (Esth. 1:5); אֲשֶׁר עַל גִּן הַמֶּלֶךְ, “which is upon the garden of the king” (2 Kgs 25:4). גִּן, גִּנָּה, and גִּנָּה are synonyms of כֶּרֶם, “vineyard” (cf. 1 Kgs 21:2; see #46, 10:5). Since family gardens were often used as burial sites, perhaps קֶבֶר צִדּוֹק, “tomb of Zadok” of the previous item (11:3) was located in גִּנֶּת צִדּוֹק, the “Garden of Zadok.”¹⁸ Cf.

וַיִּשְׁכַּב מְנַשֶּׁה עִם אֲבֹתָיו וַיִּקְבֹּר בְּגִן בֵּיתוֹ בְּגִן עֲזָא וַיִּמְלֹךְ אֲמֹן בְּנוֹ תַּחְתָּיו: ... וַיִּקְשְׁרוּ עֲבָדֵי אֲמֹן עָלָיו וַיִּמְתּוּ אֶת הַמֶּלֶךְ בְּבֵיתוֹ: ... וַיִּקְבֹּר אֹתוֹ בַּקְּבָרָתוֹ בְּגִן עֲזָא וַיִּמְלֹךְ יֹאשִׁיָּהּ בְּנוֹ תַּחְתָּיו:

And (King) Manasseh lay with his forefathers and was buried in (the) garden of his palace, in (the) Garden of Uzza; and his son Amon reigned in his place.... And the servants of Amon conspired against him, and they killed the king in his palace.... And (the people) buried him in his grave in (the) Garden of Uzza, and his son Josiah reigned in his place (2 Kgs 21:18,23,26).¹⁹

The Romans called the Jewish cemetery *hortus Judaeorum*, i.e., גִּן הַיְּהוּדִים or גִּנֶּת הַיְּהוּדִים, “garden of the Jews.”²⁰ Milik likewise suggests that גִּנֶּת צִדּוֹק

12:1.

17 גִּן once is feminine (Gen. 2:15; see Ibn-Ezra, also on Eccl. 2:5). גִּנֶּת (const.) occurs four times in the Masoretic Text, and גִּנָּה (abs.) twice (Isa. 1:30, 61:11).

18 Wacholder discusses who is Zadok mentioned the Temple and Copper Scrolls, Damascus Document, etc. He cites items #50 and #51, and basically follows Milik's version (*The Dawn of Qumran* [1983], 99-102, 153; see Discussion).

19 The Targum renders the first case as בְּגִן עֲזָא, while the second as בְּגִנֶּת עֲזָא.

20 According to I. Abrahams, it was called *hortus Judaeorum*, because it was surrounded by trees (*Jewish Life in the Middle Ages* [1986], 77; also K. Kohler, “Cemetery,” *JE* 3, 637b-38a; J.D. Eisenstein, “בֵּית הַקְּבָרוֹת” in *OY* 3, 72b; Z.H. Bernstein, “גִּן” in *OY* 3,

means קְבוֹרָה צִדּוֹק, “courtyard of the tomb of Sadoq”; and that חָצֵר could be an abbreviated form for חָצֵר הַקְּבָר, “courtyard of the grave,” i.e., cemetery (see #3, 1:6).²¹ Accordingly, גֶּן, גֶּנֶה, and חָצֵר may be synonyms of קְבוֹרָה, “grave site.”

Finally, it is possible to read and vocalize as נִגְדָּה גֶּנֶת צְדִיק, “opposite a/(the) grave of a/(the) righteous man,” as well as בְּקִבְרֵ צְדִיק, “in/at/by a/(the) grave of a/(the) righteous man,” in the previous item (both with a *yod*; see #51, 11:3).²² Regarding the preposition נִגַּד, see #3, 1:8.

(11:6-7) תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא הַגְּדוֹלָא, “below the large stone block” — ALLEGRO: תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא גְּדוֹלָא, “under the great sealing-stone.” The missing definite article in front of גְּדוֹלָא is a scribal error or an idiomatic form.²³ Allegro did not recognize that תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא is an interrupted word. MILIK: תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא, “under a large flat stone.”²⁴ LURIE reads like Milik, renders אֲבֵן תַּחַת הַגְּדוֹלָא, “under a large covering stone.” He notes the various spellings, vocalizations, and the Talmudic explanation of מַסְמָא.²⁵ YADIN: הַמַּסְמָא (הַמַּסְמָא הַגְּדוֹלָא), “the large staircase.”²⁶ Since often *bet* and *mem* cannot be distinguished in the Scroll, הַמַּסְמָא is a valid reading (see #5, 1:13). PIXNER, WACHOLDER, WOLTERS, and BEYER agree with Milik, while GARCIA MARTINEZ, VERMES, and WISE concur with Allegro.²⁷

In the Talmudim, מַסְמָא (or מַסְמָא, מַסְמָא, מַסְמָה, מַשְׁמָה, מוֹסְמָא, מוֹסְמָה) occurs only in the term אֲבֵן מַסְמָא. E.g., תַּחַת אֲבֵן מַסְמָא, “under a stone block” (m. Kel. 1:3; so vocalized in the Kaufmann Manuscript); עַל גִּבִּי הָאֲבֵן, “upon the stone block” (t. Kel. B.Q. 6:2). The Mishnah states that persons who died while being in certain impurities, they make others impure בְּמִשָּׂא, “by carrying” them (m. Nid. 10:4).²⁸ The Gemara asks what does it mean “by carrying them,” this is obvious? Rather בְּמִשָּׂא refers to אֲבֵן מַסְמָא,

301a). The significance of the term גֶּן is evident from the Rabbinic literature, “Paradise” is called גֶּן עֵדֶן, “Garden of Eden” (cf. Gen. 3:8), while “Hell,” גֵּיהֶנוֹם/גֵּיהֶנֶם, “Gehenna” (a contracted form of הַנֵּם, “Valley of Hinnom”; cf. Josh. 8:16). E.g., “that (the teacher) shall not be in the גֵּיהֶנוֹם (Paradise) while his students are in the גֶּן עֵדֶן (Gehenna)” (b. Yoma 87a).

²¹ Milik, 296-97, 246 C-83; Milik^E, 142.

²² Often the construct state, even without the definite article, indicate definitiveness.

²³ Allegro^{Pr}; Allegro, 53, 165 n. 274; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

²⁴ Milik, 296-97, 243 C-63; Milik^E, 142.

²⁵ Lurie, 119-20 and n. 2. (In the transcription מַסְמָא instead of הַגְּדוֹלָא, and in n. 2 מַסְמָא instead of מַסְמָא are typographical errors.)

²⁶ *The Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 1, 163-68.

²⁷ Pixner, 356; *The Dawn of Qumran*, 100; Wolters, 52-53; Beyer, 231-32; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377; Wise, 197.

²⁸ A parallel Tosephta uses the same term בְּמִשָּׂא (t. Nid. 9:14).

"by a stone block"; as it is written **וְהִיָּתִית אֶבֶן חֲדָה וְשָׁמַת עַל פֶּם גָּבֵא**, "and a stone was brought and it was placed upon the mouth of the pit" (Dan. 6:18; BA; b. Nid. 69b).²⁹ Rashi defines **מִסְמָא** as "a heavy/large stone resting on something."³⁰ **מִסְמָא** is the same as **מְשָׁמָה** (*samekh-shin* and *'alef-he* interchanges), from the Hebrew - Aramaic root **שָׁם - שִׁים**, "to put, set."

Furthermore, the term **עֲזָרָה** occurs in the Masoretic Text nine times, six of them in Ezekiel (43:14, 17, 20, 45:19) and three in Chronicles 2 (4:9, 6:13). In these cases basically the Targum of Chronicles renders **דְּרִתָּא**, "courtyard," while the Targum of Ezekiel **מִסְמָתָא** (or **מִסְמִתָּא**, Ezek. 45:19). E.g.,

וּמַחֲזִיק הָאָרֶץ עַד הָעֲזָרָה הַתְּחִתוֹנָה שְׁתֵּים אַמּוֹת וְרֹחַב אֶמָּה אַחַת וּמִהָעֲזָרָה הַקְּטָנָה עַד
הָעֲזָרָה הַגְּדוֹלָה אַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת וְרֹחַב הָאֶמָּה:
וּמִתְשׁוּיִת אֶרְעָא עַד מִסְמָתָא אֶרְעִיתָא תַּרְתִּין אַמִּין וּפּוּתִיָּא אֶמָּתָא חֲדָא וּמִמִּסְמָתָא זַעֲרָתָא
עַד מִסְמָתָא רִבְתָּא אַרְבַּע אַמִּין וּפּוּתִיָּא אֶמָּתָא:

And from the base of the ground to the *'azarah/mesamta'*, two cubits, with a width of one cubit; and from the smaller *'azarah/mesamta'* to the larger *'azarah/mesamta'*, four cubits, with a width of one cubit (Ezek. 43:14).

The term **עֲזָרָה** (fem., from the root **עָזַר**, "to help") in Chronicles, as well as in in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g. m. San. 1:5) means "(Temple) courtyard." Therefore, the Targum of Chronicles renders **עֲזָרָה** as **דְּרִתָּא**, "courtyard." However, in Ezekiel, **עֲזָרָה** has a different meaning. It is rendered as: "ledge surrounding Ezekiel's altar" (BDB, 741b); "settle" (JPSⁱ); "ledge" (Koren; JPSⁱⁱ); "shelf" (*Tanach*); "a place surrounding the altar" (SB, 630b); "projection, ledge" (Harkavy, 515b); "hall" (BY 5, 4416 and n. 1); etc. On the other hand, Rashi (on the above verse) explains **עֲזָרָה** as "rectangular mold," and **מִסְמָתָא** is like a **רִצְפָּה**, "floor," that fills the **מִלְבָּן**, "rectangular mold" around the altar with smooth stones like a **רִצְפָּה**, "floor." Perhaps **עֲזָרָה** and its Targum **מִסְמָתָא** means the lowest and largest support stone block on the ground below the altar.

According to the above discussion, **מִסְמָא** (**אֶבֶן**) is the same as **מִסְמִתָּא** (probably **מִסְמָתָא** plus the suffixed Aramaic definite article).³¹ The feminine noun

²⁹ This is quoted by Lurie.

³⁰ Also Rashi in b. Nid. 55a; b. Shab. 82b; b. Naz. 53a. Basically the commentators agree with Rashi; e.g., Tosaphot b. Nid. 55a; Bertinoro, *Tosephot Yom-Tov, Tif'eret Israel, Mišnah Aḥaronah*, Kehati, on this Mishnah; Maimonides on m. Kel. 1:3; etc. Similarly Rav Hai Ga'on says, **אֶבֶן שֶׁהִיא שוּמָה** means **מִסְמָא אֶבֶן**, "a stone that is placed," etc. (m. Kel. 1:3); perhaps he would vocalize as **אֶבֶן מִסְמָא**, i.e., **אֶבֶן מְשוּמָה**. Regarding the Halakhic ramifications of **אֶבֶן מִסְמָא**, see "אֶבֶן מִסְמָא" in *ET*^H 1, 77-81; "אֶבֶן מִסְמָא, An Interposing Stone," *ET*^E 1, 103-104. **מִסְמָא** is explained by Ben-Yehuda as being "a heavy stone without a crack or hole in it"; and discusses its various spellings and vocalizations (BY 4, 3124a-25a and n. 1). Brand defines this term as "a (piece) of (dark or transparent) glass." He also mentions Rashi's explanations (*Kelei Zekhukhit beSifrut hatTalmud* [1978], 135-41).

³¹ Cf. *HR* 3, 655-56; Jastrow, 809b.

מַסְמָא or מַשְׁמָה is formed with a prefixed *mem*, the feminine 'alef/he suffix, plus the root שׁוּם/שִׁים, "to place." Regarding the many possible vocalizations of מַסְמָא, similar nouns with the same patterns (מַשְׁקָלִים) are added. The examples are feminine nouns, most of them derived from roots having one weak (פ"נ, פ"ל, ע"י, ע"י), or duplicated (ע"ע) radicals. In the Aramaic forms the definite article is included. These numerous possibilities demonstrate the difficulty to vocalize a text that has no tradition.³² This compounds the already existing problems associated with interpretations.

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה (A) — cf. מַעְרָה - הַמַּעְרָה - מַעְרָתָא (A), "(the) cave" (e.g., Gen. 49:29-30), from the root עוּר, "to dig," or עָרָה, "be bare" (see #7, 2:3).

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מַגְלָה - הַמַּגְלָה - מַגְלָתָא, "(the) scroll" (Jer. 36:28-29), from the root גַּלַּל, "to roll"; מַסְבָּה, "circle" (Job. 37:12); also מַסְבָּא (CS), מַסְבָּה, מַסִּיבָה (MH, A), means "staircase," both from the root סָבַב, "to surround" (see #5, 1:13).

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מְדִינָה - הַמְדִינָה - מְדִינָתָא, "(the) province" (e.g., Esth. 3:12; Ezra 5:8, BA), from the root דִּין, "to judge"; מְרִיבָה, "strife" (e.g., Gen. 13:8), from the root רִיב, "to strive," also מַסָּה וּמְרִיבָה, "Massah and Meribah" or "Test and Strife," a place named after certain unpleasant event in the Wilderness (Exod. 17:7; Ps. 98:8).

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מְגֻמָּה, "eagerness" in מְגֻמַת פְּנֵיהֶם, "eagerness (or assembling) of their faces" (Hab. 1:9), from the root גָּמַח, "to long for," or גָּמַם, "to become abundant"; מַשְׁמָה, "devastation" (e.g., Ezek. 5:15), from the root שָׁמַם, "to be desolated."

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מְצֻדָּה - הַמְצֻדָּה - מְצֻדָתָא, "(the) fort" (e.g., 2 Sam. 5:9, 24:22; Job 39:28), from the root צוּד, "to hunt"; see #44, 9:17); מְזוּזָה - הַמְזוּזָה - מְזוּזָתָא (A), "(the) doorpost" (e.g., Exod. 21:6), from the root זָוַה, "to move" (MH).

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מְצֻדָּה - הַמְצֻדָּה - מְצֻדָתָא, "(the) fort" (Isa. 29:7), "(the) net" (Eccl. 9:12), from the root צוּד/צִיד, "to hunt" (see #44, 9:17); מְנוֹרָה - הַמְנוֹרָה - מְנוֹרָתָא, "candelabra, menorah" (e.g., Exod. 28:31-35), from the root נִרְגַּח, "to light."

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מַעְלָה - הַמַּעְלָה, "(the) step, upper flight, ascent" (e.g., 1 Kgs 10:19), from the root עָלָה, "to go up, ascend"; מַחְתָּה - הַמַּחְתָּה - מַחְתָתָא, "(the) fire-holder, fire-pans" (e.g., Lev. 16:12), from the root חָתַח, "to snatch up (fire)."

מַסְמָא = מַשְׁמָה - הַמַּסְמָא = הַמַּשְׁמָה — cf. מַפְלָה, "ruin" (Isa. 17:1), from the root נָפַל, "to fall," its Targum מַחְמָרָא, "pile of debris, ruin," from the root חָמַר, "to pile up"; מַטְרָה - הַמַּטְרָה - מַטְרָתָא, "(the) guard, prison, target,"

32 Regarding the various traditional pronunciations of מַסְמָא, and its 'proper' vocalization, see Ch. Yalon, "לשיטת הגיקור של המשנה" in Ch. Albeck, *Šiššah Sidrei Mišnah ... — Seder Zera'im ...* (1957), xx n. 36, xxiii.

(e.g., Jer. 32:2,8), from the root נטר, “to keep, protect”; מִצְבָּה - מִצְבָּה, “the garrison” (1 Sam. 14:12), from the root נצב, “to stand,” its Targum is מִטְרָתָא, “the garrison,” from the root נטר, “to protect.”

מִסְמָא = מִשְׁמָה - הַמְסָמָא = הַמְשָׁמָה — cf. מִפְּלָה, “ruin” (Isa. 23:13, 25:2), from the root נפל, “to fall,” its Targum is מִחְמָרָא (mentioned above); מִצְבָּה, “pillar” (e.g., Gen. 35:20), from the root נצב, “to stand.”

מִסְמָא = מִשְׁמָה - הַמְסָמָא = הַמְשָׁמָה — cf. מִצְוָה - הַמְצְוָה, “(the) command” (e.g., Prov. 6:23; Deut. 6:1), from the root צוה, “to command”; מִחְיָה, “food” (e.g., Judg. 6:4), from the root חיה, “to live”; מִכְלָא - מְכָלָא, “enclosure (for animals)” (Ps. 50:9, 78:70; Hab. 3:17), from the root כלא, “to restrain.”

מִסְמָא = מִשְׁמָה - הַמְסָמָא = הַמְשָׁמָה — cf. מִצְבָּה, “guard,” from the root נצב (it is equated with the above mentioned מִצְבָּה).

מִסְמָא = מִשְׁמָה - הַמְסָמָא = הַמְשָׁמָה — cf. מוֹעֵקָה, “distress” (Ps. 66:11), from the root עוק, “to press”; מוֹצָקָה - מִצְקָה, “form for casting, tube” (2 Chron. 4:3; Zech. 4:2), from the root יצק, “to pour.” Finally,

וְהָיָה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא אֲשֵׁים אֶת יְרוּשָׁלַם אֲבֵן מַעֲמָסָה לְכָל הָעַמִּים כֹּל עַמֵּיהָ שָׂרוּט יִשְׂרָאוֹ
And it shall be on that day, I (God) will make Jerusalem a stone of burden for
all the peoples; all those that burden with it shall be surely sore wounded
(Zech. 12:3).

The *hapax legomenon* מַעֲמָסָה is derived from the root עמס, “to burden” (as עֲמִסָּה later in the verse) with a prefixed *mem*, and the feminine *he* ending. Thus, מַעֲמָסָה אֲבֵן means “burdensome stone” or “heavy stone.”³³ Perhaps מַסְמָא is a variant of מַעֲמָסָה, where the *ayin* disappeared due to the weakening of the gutturals, plus a metathesis of the letters *mem* and *samekh* (cf. כָּבֵשׁ vs. כָּשֵׁב, “lamb”; the roots פרש vs. פשר; see #60, 12:12).

The appearance of מַסְמָא, a rare and problematic Mishnaic term, in the Scroll is very interesting. It indicates that מַסְמָא alone was used without אֲבֵן. Perhaps this was the case originally in Mishnaic Hebrew (as מַסְמָתָא in the Targum), and that later אֲבֵן was added for clarification, thereby creating the compound term מַסְמָא אֲבֵן in the Talmudic literature.

תַּחַת הָאֲבֵן הַשְּׁחֹרָא is like the phrase תַּחַת הַמַּסָּמָא הַגְּדוֹלָא, “below the black stone” (see #56, 12:2). Both מַסָּמָא and אֲבֵן are feminine, as the feminine adjective גְּדוֹלָא indicates. גְּדוֹלָא is interrupted, the *he* is at the end of the line, and the rest is at the beginning of the next one. Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1-2; for תַּחַת, #25, 6:5; #30, 7:8; #49, 10:15-16.

(11:7) 10 שְׁבִשְׁוִלֵי הוּ הָרִמ כ, “which is at its rim, it is consecrated, (it consists of) 10 (unspecified) k(arsh)” — ALLEGROPPE: “which is in the irrigation ditch

33 Cf. Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*; also HR 3, 663. The Targum renders מַעֲמָסָה אֲבֵן as אֲבֵן תְּקֵלָא, “stumbling stone.”

(?) (or base), 'Herem offerings.' In -" (i.e., שְׁבִילֹחוֹ חֶרֶם ב, or better שִׁילֹחַ (1), the name of Siloam's pool; cf. שְׁלַח or שְׁלֹחַ, "irrigation ditch." The suffix presumably refers to the "clearing." Alternately, שְׁוִלִיָּה, "in its (fem.) rim." שְׁוִלִין means "bottom" of a vessel, but the next *waw* is difficult. ALLEGRO^{TP}: "which is in the base, there are 'Herem offerings'. In -" (i.e., שְׁבִשְׁוִלִין הִי חֶרֶם ב, means "there are." ALLEGRO: שְׁבִשְׁוִלִיָּה חֶרֶם ב, "that is in its bottom; consecrated offerings. In." שְׁוִלִיָּה or שְׁוִלִיָּה (masc.) are Aramaic or dialectal Hebrew forms, but שְׁוִלִיָּה (fem.) would fit better. The last *bet* is a dittography.³⁴ ALLEGRO^{rev}: "that it in its outlet: consecrated offerings (*herem*)." MILIK: (ב) שְׁבִשְׁוִלֹחוֹ חֶרֶם, "found near the water canal: anathema."³⁵ LURIE: ...ב חֶרֶם הוּא שְׁבִשְׁוִלֹ, "which is at the bottom (of the cistern) there is *herem* ..." ³⁶ BEYER: (בֶּק) שְׁבִשְׁוִלֹ הוּא חֶרֶם, "which is on its bottom, it is anathema."³⁷ WISE: "that is at the edge: gold coins and consecrated offerings."³⁸ PIXNER and WACHOLDER follow Milik, while WOLTERS, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES agree with Milik, but they render *herem* as Allegro.³⁹

The last clear letter is a *bet*, *kaf*, or *mem*. This is followed by a sign or signs that differ in the drawings. BAKER^{dr}: an almost horizontal line is followed by a vertical line having a dot above it. MILIK^{dr}: only an almost horizontal line. ALLEGRO^{dr}: only a strait horizontal line. If these signs are disregarded, the last clear letter may be considered as a dittography, since the first word of the next line starts with a *bet* (cf. Allegro, Milik), like the extra *samekh* found once in the drawings of Baker and Allegro (see #40, 9:7). This does not necessarily mean that something was left out by the scribe, rather that this item does not mention its content and weight. On the other hand, several possible suggestions regarding this problem can be offered.

The last clear letter may be a *kaf*. The horizontal line following it could be the upper part of an unfinished second *kaf*, i.e., כַּכ = כֶּרֶשׁ וְכֶרֶשִׁין, "silver karsh"; or the horizontal line may be the upper part of an unfinished numeral 10 (cf. numeral "10" in "71" of line 12:9), while in Baker's drawing there is an additional vertical line, i.e., 10 + 1 (= 11). In the latter, the single *kaf* before the numeral(s) may be an abbreviation for כֶּרֶשׁ - כֶּרֶשִׁין, like in the Aramaic Elephantine documents and possibly in a Murabba'at inscription, etc. (see Appendix A).

It should be added that Hebrew expresses singularity in two ways: a

34 Allegro, 53, 137-38 n. 27, 158 n. 210, 165 nn. 274-76; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

35 Milik, 296-97, 228 B-5b, 243 C-62, 249 C-117; Milik^E, 142, 152.

36 Lurie, 119-20 (הוּא is missing in the transcription, it is a typographical error).

37 Beyer, 231-32.

38 Wise, 197.

39 Pixner, 256; *The Dawn of Qumran*, 100; Wolters, 52-53; 29; Garcia Martinez, 463 (the parenthesis around "a" is a typographical error); Vermes, 377.

singular noun (without the definite article) alone, or a singular noun is followed by "one," אֶחָד (masc.) or אַחַת (fem.). E.g., שָׁמ קָלָל בּוֹ סֵפֶר אֶחָד means "three (is) one *qalal* (vessel), in it (there is) one document" (see #25, 6:4-5; #1, 1:3; #20, 4:13-14). Therefore, when כַּכ is not followed by a numeral or number, it means כֶּסֶף כָּרֶשׁ אֶחָד, "one silver karsh." Regarding the suggested vocalization of כָּרֶשׁ and כָּרֶשִׁין, see Appendix A.

Based on the above discussion, the words of this difficult phrase can be separated, read, vocalized, and interpreted as follows.

שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלָיו = שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלִי (defective), "which is in its (masc.) edge/bottom/base," where שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלִי must refer to the masculine רֹאשׁ הַפֶּלֶע, "the top of the rock," rather than to the feminine תְּבִסָּה וְתִבְסָה, "ruin, etc.," or הַמִּסְמָא הַגָּדוֹלָא, "the large stone." Accordingly, the cache is below the large stone which is located at the edge or bottom of the top of the rock. Regarding the term שְׁוֹלִים, see #38, 9:1.

שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלִיָּה, "which is in its (fem.) edge/bottom/base," where שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלִיָּה must refer to the feminine תְּבִסָּה וְתִבְסָה, "ruin, etc.," rather than הַמִּסְמָא הַגָּדוֹלָא, "the large stone." Accordingly, the cache is below the large stone which is located at the edge or bottom of the ruin, etc.

שְׁבֻשְׁוֹלֵיהֶן, "which is in their (masc./fem.) edge/bottom/base" — This is a possible reading, however, "their" must refer to a plural noun, which cannot be found in this item.

חֶרֶם (masc., pl. חֲרָמִים), which appears in two additional cases in the Scroll (9:10, 9:16), has several meanings, such as "segregated, consecrated, devoted, banned" things. However, regarding the Scroll, only two Mishnaic usages appear to be relevant: (1) חֶרֶם שֶׁל כֹּהֲנִים, "dedicated (object) to the priests" for private use, which the donor cannot redeem (m. 'Arak. 8:6), but the priests may sell it (b. 'Arak. 29a). (2) חֶרֶם לְבִדּוֹק הַבֵּית, "dedicated (object) for repair of the Temple," also known as חֶרֶם שֶׁל שָׁמַיִם and חֲרָמֵי גְבוּהָ, "dedicated (object) to the Lord," which the donor may redeem by adding one fifth to its value (m. 'Arak. 8:1-3). Moreover, according to Rabbi Judah ben Beteira, סֶתֶם חֶרֶם, unspecified חֶרֶם donation belongs to the Temple, while according to the Sages, it belongs to the priests (m. 'Arak. 8:6; cf. Sifre on Num. 18:14). If one makes a vow that he donates a חֶרֶם to the priests, it belongs the מְשָׁמֶר, "watch of priests," which serves at that time in the Temple (y. Hal. 4:4 [18a]). The denominative forms of חֶרֶם are, חָרַם (*Qal*), which basically means "to swear (by *herem*)" (e.g., Pirquei deRabbi Eliezer, 38); הִחָרַם (*Hifil*, BH, MH), "to make consecrated, banned"; and (Hofal, BH, MH), "became consecrated, banned." E.g.,

אֵךְ כָּל חֶרֶם אֲשֶׁר יִחָרַם אִישׁ לֵה' מִכָּל אֲשֶׁר לוֹ מֵאֲדָם וּבִהֶמָּה וּמִשְׁדָּה אֲחֻזָּתוֹ לֹא יִמְכֹּר
וְלֹא יִגְאֹל כָּל חֶרֶם קֹדֶשׁ קְדָשִׁים הוּא לֵה': כָּל חֶרֶם אֲשֶׁר יִחָרַם מִן הָאָדָם לֹא יִפְדֶּה מוֹת
יִנָּמֹת:

However, any segregated thing that a man will devote for the Lord, of all that he has, of a man, and an animal, or inherited land, may not be sold and may not be redeemed; any devoted thing is most holy to the Lord. Any banishment which shall be banned among man, he shall not be redeemed; he shall be put to death (Lev. 27:28-29).

Accordingly, among others, חֶרֶם is a gift given to the priests or to the Temple, and it is a synonym of דָּמַע.

חֶרֶם = הוּא חֶרֶם, “it (masc.) is consecrated,” where the defective spelling of הוּא is like הַפֶּתַח = הוּא הַפֶּתַח, “that (is) the entrance” (see #47, 10:10); and the name יְהוּא = יְהוּא (see #49, 10:15).

וְחֶרֶם = וְחֶרֶם, “and (it is) consecrated” (with an explanatory waw), i.e., the object(s) is/are consecrated.

וְחֶרֶם = וְחֶרֶם, “and (they are) consecrated” (with an explanatory waw), i.e., the objects are consecrated.

חֶרֶם = הֵן חֶרֶם (defective), “they are consecrated,” i.e., the objects are consecrated. The waw is read as a short-legged final nun.

הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם = הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם, “(it) became consecrated,” the six characters are read as a single word (*Hof'al/Huf'al* form).

יְחֶרֶם = יְחֶרֶם, “it shall be made consecrated,” i.e., the deposit at the time of the recovery shall be made consecrated (*Hof'al/Huf'al* form).

Based on the aforementioned discussion, the following possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations are offered.

1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוּא חֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ = 1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוּא חֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ, “which is in/at/by its (masc.) bottom/edge, it (masc.) is consecrated, (it consists of) one/1 s(silver) k(arsh).”

10\11 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוּא חֶרֶם כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ = 10\11 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוּא חֶרֶם כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ, “which is in/at/by its (masc.) bottom/edge, it (masc.) is consecrated, (it consists of) 10/11 k(arsh).”

1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ = 1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ, “which is in/at/by its (masc.) bottom/edge, it is consecrated, (it consists of) one/1 s(silver) k(arsh).”

10\11 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ = 10\11 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הוֹחֶרֶם־הוֹחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ, “which is in/at/by its (masc.) bottom/edge, it is consecrated, (it consists of) 10/11 k(arsh).”

חֶרֶם = שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הֵן חֶרֶם, “which is in/at/by its (masc.) bottom/edge, they are consecrated,” i.e., the unspecified objects are consecrated.

חֶרֶם = שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי וְחֶרֶם, “which is in/at/by its (fem.) bottom/edge, and (they are) consecrated,” i.e., the unspecified objects are consecrated. In the last two suggestions the last fragment is disregarded.

1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי וְחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ = 1 שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי וְחֶרֶם כֶּסֶף כְּרִשְׁוֹכְרֶשׁ, “which is in/at/-

by its (fem.) bottom/edge, and (there are) consecrated one/1 k(arsh)."

$10\backslash 11$ $\text{כ} \text{שְׁבִשׁוּלֶיהָ וְחֶרֶם כְּכֹסֶף כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$ = $10\backslash 11$ $\text{כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$, "which is in/at/by its (fem.) bottom/edge, and (there are) consecrated <...> /1 s(ilver) k(arsh)."

1 $\text{כְּכֹסֶף כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$ = 1 $\text{כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$, "which is in/at/by its (fem.) bottom/edge, it shall be made consecrated one/1 s(ilver) k(arsh)," i.e., there is hidden one silver karsh that at the time of the recovery must be made consecrated.

$10\backslash 11$ $\text{כ} \text{שְׁבִשׁוּלֶיהָ וְחֶרֶם כְּכֹסֶף כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$ = $10\backslash 11$ $\text{כְּרֶשֶׁתְּכֶרֶשִׁים}$, "which is in/at/by its (fem.) bottom/edge, it shall be made consecrated, 10/11 k(arsh)," i.e., there is hidden 10/11 karsh that at the time of the recovery must be made consecrated.

Finally, following the alternate reading of ככ numerals may be missing due to scribal errors. If so, the alternate reading should be <...> ככ , "<...> s(ilver) k(arsh)." Also, one can assume that כ is an abbreviation for כְּרֶשֶׁת , "karsh." However, כ may be an abbreviation for כֶּסֶף , "silver." If so, in the cases where כ is rendered as "karsh," it should be substituted to "silver" (see Appendix A).

ITEM 53

11:8 בקבר שתחת הסבין ככ 40

11:8 In the grave which is below the thresholds, (there are)
40 s(ilver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(11:8) *בְּקִבְרוֹ בְּקֶבֶר שֶׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין (= הַסְּפִים)*, “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the thresholds”; cf. *בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח שֶׁתַּחַת הַמַּעְלֹת*, “In the salt pit which is below the steps” (2:1); and *בְּבוֹרֵי בְּבוֹר שֶׁתַּחַת הַחוֹמָא*, “In/at/by a/the pit/cistern/grave which is below the city-wall” (2:10). Regarding *קבר*, see #14, 3:11; for *תחת*, #25, 6:5; #30, 7:8; #49, 10:15-16.

The third word has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{PF}: “thorn bushes” (i.e., *סכין*). ALLEGRO: *סבין* is a variant of *ספין* (MH, A), “paving blocks”; a *bet-pe* interchange; cf. *הפנה* for *הבנא* (6:7), *בשובר* for *בשופך* (9:1). ALLEGRO^{rev}: “paving stones?”¹ MILIK: *סכין*, “Galleries”; cf. *סבב*, “a sort of gallery around the altar” (m. Mid. 3:1), and *סובין* (t. Kel. B.M. 2:8).² LURIE: *סבין* is *ספִים*, “paving blocks.”³ PIXNER: *סבין*, “Colonnades.”⁴ WOLTERS: *סכין*, “Knife.”⁵ BEYER: *סכין*, “peak (of the rock)” or “knife (of the rock).”⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ agrees with Pixner, VERMES follows Milik, and WISE concurs with Wolters.⁷

The word in question can be read as: *הסכון, הסבין, הסכון, הסכין*, etc. In addition, the *bet* may be interchanged with *pe*, i.e., *הספון, הספין*. The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this difficult word.

(*הספון* =) *בְּקִבְרוֹ בְּקֶבֶר שֶׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין*, “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the ceiling/covering” — Perhaps it refers to a ceiling of a mausoleum. *סבון* may be a variant of *ספון*, “ceiling, covering,” which occurs only once in the Masoretic Text.

1 Allegro, 53, 150 n. 130, 156-57 n. 187, 165 n. 277; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 297-97, 271 D-42, 273 D-62; Milik^E, 142, 153.

3 Lurie, 120 (*הספין* instead of *הסבין*, and the missing translation must be typographical errors).

4 Pixner, 356.

5 Wolters, 52-53.

6 Beyer, 230, 231.

7 Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377; Wise, 197.

וַיִּבֶן אֶת קִירוֹת הַבַּיִת מִבֵּיתָהּ בְּצִלְעוֹת אֲרָזִים מִקֶּרְקַע הַבַּיִת עַד קִירוֹת-הַסָּפֶן צִפָּה עֵץ מִבֵּית וַיִּצַּף אֶת קֶרְקַע הַבַּיִת בְּצִלְעוֹת בְּרוֹשִׁים:

And (King Solomon) built the walls of the Temple on the inside with cedar boards; from the floor of the Temple to the ceiling beams, he covered them on the inside with wood; and he covered the floor of the house with cypress board (1 Kgs 6:15).⁸

וּסְפֹן בְּאֶרְזוֹ מִהֶקְרַקַּע עַד, "to hide, cover." E.g., הֶקְרַקַּע, "and covered with cedar from floor to floor" (1 Kgs 7:7); and וּסְפֹן, "and covered with cedar" (Jer. 22:14);⁹ סְפֹן is related to צִפֹּן (from the root צִפֵּן, "to hide," *samekh-šade* interchange). צִפֹּן occurs in the Scroll (see #60, 12:10).

בְּקֶרְבִּיבֶקֶבֶר שְׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין (= הַסָּפִים), "In/at/by a/the grave which is below the thresholds (or vestibules, door-sills, paving blocks of stones, borders, rows of stones)" — Perhaps the location of this grave was in a mausoleum. סְבִין could be a variant of סְפִים (pl. of סֵף, masc.; cf. Allegro, Lurie). E.g., הַסָּפִים וְהַחֲלוֹנִים הָאֲטֻמּוֹת, "the thresholds and the sealed windows" (Ezek. 41:16); also תַּחַת סֵף הַכּוֹף־וְהַכּוֹף, "below the threshold of the burial niche" (12:2-3); תַּחַת הַסֵּף הַגָּדוֹל, "below the large threshold/vestibule" (2:12); [בְּ]סֵף[וֹ] [בְּ]סֵף אַרְבָּעִין כֶּכָר, "in/at/by a/the threshold/vestibule (there are) forty talents" (see #5, 1:14-15; alt.). Both סֵף and its Aramaic cognate סְפִיאָא mean "threshold, vestibule, door sill, bowl, paving stone block, rows of stone, border" (see #10, 2:12). Moreover, if סְבִין is a variant of סְפִין, "rows of stones," then it is a synonym for נִדְבָּכִין, "rows of stones."¹⁰ Accordingly, בְּנִפְשׁוֹ בְּנִדְבָּכִין בְּקֶרְבִּיבֶקֶר שְׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין, "In/at/by a/the tomb, in the third row of stones" (see #2, 1:5-6).

בְּקֶרְבִּיבֶקֶבֶר שְׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין, "In/at/by a/the grave which is below the knife (i.e., peak of the rock)" — סְבִין (fem.; pl. סְבִינִין, "knife" (cf. Wolters, Beyer, Wise), is commonly used in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. Beṣ. 3:7); it appears once in the Masoretic Text as שְׁכִין (*samekh-šin* interchange) where its Targum is סְכִינָא (Prov. 23:2). Cf. "and Isaac said, 'Lord of the Universe ... I stretched out my neck תַּחַת הַסְּכִין (under the knife)'" (Lam. Rabbati Petiḥa').¹¹ Perhaps סְבִין here means "knife of the rock," i.e., peak of the rock; cf. שֵׁן הַסֵּלַע, "tooth of the rock," i.e., peak of the rock, which occurs earlier in the Scroll (see #10, 2:11).

בְּקֶרְבִּיבֶקֶבֶר שְׁתַּחַת הַסְּכִין, "In/at/by a/the grave which is below the shelters" — סְכִין (= סְכִים) could be an unattested plural of סֵךְ (masc.), which appears four times in the Masoretic Text. E.g., עָזַב כְּכִפִּיר סֵכוֹ, "He left like a young

⁸ Cf. Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat Zion*, and Malbim.

⁹ Cf. the Targum of the first and *Mešudat David* on the second verse.

¹⁰ *He'Aruch*, 388b; *AC* 6, 98a; Jastrow, 1011a.

¹¹ This Midrash refers to the first part of Gen. Ch. 22. In addition, in verse 10 the Targum for הַמֶּלֶכֶת is סְכִינָא (TO, PsJ, Frag., TN).

lion its (masc.) hiding" (Jer. 25:38); **רָצָה יִסְתָּרֵנִי בְּסֵתֶר**, "For He will hide me in His shelter in the day of trouble; He will conceal me under the cover of His tent" (Ps. 27:5). Its feminine form is **סֵכָה** (const. **סִכַּת**, pl. **סִכּוֹת**; 31 times in the Masoretic Text).¹² Basically **סֵךְ** and **סֵכָה** mean "covered (area)," such as "tent, shelter, Abode of the Lord"; both are from the root **סָכַךְ**, "to cover."

בְּקִבְרֵיבְקָר שְׁתַּחַת הַסִּבִּין, "In/at/by a/the grave which is below the pillars/nails (of the rock)" — **סִבִּין** (cf. Allegro¹³; emph. **סִכְיָא**) is the plural of **סִכְיָא** (masc.), "nail, thorn, shovel"; an Aramaism.¹³ The Targumim render **וְיִתֵּד תְּהִיָּה לָךְ** as **וְסִכְיָא תְּהִי לָךְ** (TO), "and you shall have a shovel," **וְסִכְיָא תְּהִי קְבִיעָא לְכוֹן** (PsJ), "and a shovel you shall fasten," **וְסִכְיָא תְּהִי קְבִיעָא לְכוֹן** (TN), "and shovels shall be fastened" (Deut. 23:14); also **וְכָל הַיִּתְדוֹת** as **וְכָל הַסִּבִּין** (Trg. 1 Esth. 5:14); Onkelos translates **וְכָל הַיִּתְדוֹת** as **וְכָל הַסִּבִּין** (Exod. 18:20). Perhaps **סִבִּין** means "pillars" or "nails of the rock" (see the above possible meaning of **סִבִּין**).

Finally, **סִבִּין** (MH, pl. of **סִבָּ**; e.g., m. Ḥal. 2:6) means "bran." However, regarding this item, **תַּחַת הַסִּבִּין**, "under the bran," is meaningless.

(11:8) 40 **ככ**, "40 s(ilver) k(arsh)" — Regarding the abbreviation **ככ**, see Appendix A.

12 In addition, **סִכּוֹת**, Sukkoth (Tents), is the name of a city in Transjordan (e.g., Gen. 33:17; Judg. 8:5, etc.), a place in the Plain of Jordan (1 Kgs 7:46; 2 Chron. 4:17), and a resting place for the Israelites after leaving the Egyptian boundary (Exod. 12:37, etc.). A similar toponym, **סִכְכָּה**, Secacah, occurs earlier in the Scroll (see #20, 4:13).

13 Probably from the root **סָךְ** which has several meanings; see AC 6, 50a-51a; also Jastrow, 988b.

ITEM 54

11:9 בקבר בני העבט הירחי
11:10 בו כלי דמע או דמע סות
11:11 בתכן אצלן

11:9 In the grave of the sons of Obed the Jerichoite,
11:10 in it (are an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels
and dedicated garments;
11:11 with their lists next to them.

COMMENTARY

(11:9) הִירְחִי (הַעֲבֹדָה־הַעֲבֹדָה) = הַעֲבֹדָה־הַעֲבֹדָה, "In the grave of the sons of (the) Obed/Ebed the Jerichoite" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the tomb of the People of the Pure Life" (i.e., בַּקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טָהוֹר חִי, בַּקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם). ALLEGRO: הָעָם בְּנֵי הָעָם, "In the grave of the common people who (died) absolved from their purity regulations." טָהוֹר חֻבּוֹ, "In the grave of the common people who (died) absolved from their purity regulations." טָהוֹר חֻבּוֹ being split between the lines; חֻבּ (MH), "obligation, debt, sin"; מִחֻבּוֹ, "from his obligation," might have been a better reading. Allegro discusses the biblical "grave of the common people." Alternately, חִי טָהוֹר, "pure life." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the grave of the common people of pure life (?)" ; cf. ALLEGRO^{pr}.¹ MILIK: בַּקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם הִירְחִי, "In the tomb of the Sons of *Fuller* of Yerah"; alternately הָעָם הִירְחִי, possible the gentilic of Bet Yerah of the Talmud, modern Khirbet Kerak at the southern end of the sea of Galilee.² GREENFIELD takes "strong exception" to Milik's interpretation of עֲבֹט.³ LURIE: בַּקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טָהוֹר הוּ בּוֹ, "In the grave of the common people, in it are buried pure men." Lurie also discusses the biblical "grave(s) of the common people." Since "pure" cannot refer to a grave, it must refer to "pure men," perhaps martyrs of the revolt against the Romans.⁴ PIXNER: ? הָעָם טָהוֹרָה ? or בַּקֶּבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טָהוֹרָה ?, "At the tomb of the sons of the People of Purity," or "His —God's— purity?"; cf. the strict purity regulations of the Essenes. "The Kedron valley around Gethsemane was the traditional burial ground of the common people. ... That the tomb of the mother of Jesus is shown there in 'an ancient Judeo-Christian necropolis' might point

¹ Allegro, 53, 165 nn. 279-80; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

² Milik translate עֲבֹט only in his notes, but not in the text (which may be an omission). Milik, 296-97, 259 C-208, 291 D-43, 274 D-70; Milik^E, 142, 153.

³ Greenfield, 139b.

⁴ Lurie, 121

to some revealing connections.”⁵ WOLTERS: **בַּקְבֵּר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹרֹתֵי בּו**, “In the tomb of the common people: my pure things are in it.”⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the grave of the sons of Ha’amata of Jericho (?).”⁷ BEYER: **בַּקְבֵּר בְּנִיָּה** **עֵבֶט חוֹר הוּ**, “In the grave of Banaja there is a white container”; **חוֹר** is an Aramaism.⁸ WISE: “At the grave of the common people—it is ritually pure.”⁹ VERMES follows Milik.¹⁰

Some letters of this difficult line can be read in more than one way: the first, third, and fifth being *bet/kaf*; the eight, twelfth, and fifteenth being *he/-het/taw*; the seventh, thirteenth, and sixteenth being *waw/zayin/yod*; the tenth being *mem*, that can be read as *bet*; the eleventh being *tet*, may actually be a *pe* plus a *waw/yod/zayin*. The letters can be grouped into four, five, or even possibly six words.

The words can be read as follows. The first: **בַּקְבֵּר**, “in/at/by a/the grave of” (const.). The second: **בְּנֵי**, “sons of” or “clan of” (const.; cf. Allegro, Milik, Lurie); **בְּנִיָּה** (cf. Beyer), same as **בְּנִיָּהוּ**, Benaiah (e.g., Ezek. 11:1; 2 Sam. 23:22); **בְּנִיָּה**, a variant of **בְּנִיָּהוּ** (King of Judah, Jer. 22:24, 22:28, 37:1), Coniah. The third: **עֵבֶט**, “(the) thick/cloud”; **עֵבֶט**, **עֵבֶט**, **עֵבֶט**, **עֵבֶט**, “(the) base/pillar”; **עֵבֶט**, “with”; **עֵבֶט**, “(the) ‘people’”; **עֵבֶט**, **עֵבֶט**, **עֵבֶט**, assumed personal names. The fourth: **טְהוֹר**, “pure”; **טְהוֹר**, “(image of) hemorrhoid”;¹¹ **הֶזְרָחִי**, “the Zerahite”; **הֶזְרָחִי**, “the Jerichoite” (cf. Milik); **חוֹרָחוֹר**, “hole, pit” (see #33, 8:2); **חָוֵר**, “white” (Dan. 7:9, BA; cf. Beyer); **חוֹר**, “to become white” (e.g., Isa. 29:22); **חוֹר**, Hur (personal name; e.g., Exod. 31:2); **חוֹר**, “dove,” also “row, order”; **חוֹרָתוֹ**, “its (masc.) law.” The fifth (if the line is divided so): **הוּ**, “he/it (is)”; **הִי**, “she/it (is)”; **הֵן**, “they (are)”; **תּוֹ**, “mark.” A sixth (if the *tet* is read as two letters): **פּוֹ** (= **פּוֹה**), “this side/here”; **פִּי**, “mouth, opening”; **פִּיָּה**, “its (fem.) mouth/opening”; **פִּזָּו**, “refined gold,”¹² e.g., **כֶּלִי פִזָּו**, “a vessel of refined gold” (Job 28:17).

The fourth word is a gentilic name that further identifies the previous personal name, that is discussed below; cf. the modern first and family names. The gentilic form usually consists of the prefixed definite article *he*, name of a place, father, forefather, or clan, plus a suffix of *yod* (masc.) or *yod-he/-taw* (fem.).

5 Pixner, 356 and n. 46 (the first question mark appears to be a typographical error; and so **טְהוֹרֹת** for **טְהוֹרֹת** in the alternate reading).

6 “Analysis,” 251; “History,” 292-93; Wolters, 52-53.

7 Garcia Martinez, 463.

8 Beyer, 230-31.

9 Wise, 197.

10 Vermes, 377.

11 This term occurs in the Masoretic Text only once (1 Sam. 6:11), but as *qeri* seven times (e.g., 1 Sam. 5:6, 6:4), and always in the plural form **טְהוֹרִים**.

12 **פִּזָּא** and **פִּזְזָא** in Judeo-Aramaic, *pā* in Ugaritic (see *UT*, 467a [#2023]).

הַיִּרְחִי, “the one of Jerah” or “the Jerahite,” is a gentilic form of: (1) יֶרַח, Jerah (= Moon); cf. Jerah the son of Joktan (Gen. 10:26; 1 Chron. 1:20). (2) בֵּית יֶרַח, Beth Jerah (House of the Moon), a Canaanite city named after the Moon god (e.g., y. Meg. 1:1 [2a]), the modern Khirbet Kerak at the southern end of the Sea of Galilee (cf. Milik).¹³

הַיִּרְחִי, “the one of Jericho” or “the Jerichoite,” is a gentile form of: (1) יֶרִיחוֹ, Jericho, also occurs in the Scroll (see #24, 5:13). (2) בֵּית יֶרִיחוֹ, Beth Jericho, a variant of Beth Jerah (e.g., t. Bek. 7:4).

הַזֶּרְחִי (gentile of זֶרַח, from the root זָרַח, “to shine”), “the one of Zerah” or “the Zerahite.” E.g., לְזֶרַח מִשְׁפַּחַת הַזֶּרְחִי, “for Zerah the family of the Zerahites” (Num. 26:13,20).¹⁴

The third word, הַעֲמַט or הַעֲבַט, appears to be a personal name prefixed with the definite article. Although it is unusual, there are such cases; e.g., בֶּן הַקּוֹז, “son of Hakkoz” or “son of the Koz” (Neh. 3:4, 21), vs. קוֹז, “Koz” (1 Chron. 4:8; see #30, 7:9). הַעֲמַט (with a *mem*) can be a variant of הַעֲמַד (*dalet-ṭet* interchange), הַעֲמֶט (*ṭet-samekh* interchange), הַחֲמַט (*ḥet-ʿayin* interchange). The following are possible suggestions.

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֲבָט הַיִּרְחִי, “In a/the grave of the sons of (the) ‘Avot/-Pledge the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite” — The verbal form of the root עָבַט means “to take or give a pledge, extend credit” Its nominal form, עֲבֹט - עָבֹט (prob. masc.), means “pledge, security.” E.g., Scripture mandates:

When you make any kind of loan to your fellow, do not go into his house לְעָבֹט עֲבֹט (to take his pledge). You shall stand outside, and the man to whom you loan shall bring to you אֶת הָעֲבֹט (the pledge) outside (Deut. 24:10-11).

הָעֲבָט in the Scroll can be a personal name, “the ‘Avot” or “the Pledge.” The name may indicate that at birth the child was pledged to God; cf. וַתֵּהָרֵם חַנָּה, “and Hannah conceived and bore a son, and she named him Samuel, because “I have asked him from the Lord” (1 Sam. 1:20).¹⁵

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֲבָטִי הַיִּרְחִי (= הָעֲבָדִי הָעֲבָדִי) הַיִּרְחִי, “In a/the grave of the sons of (the) Abed/Obed the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite” — הָעֲבָט can be a variant of הָעֲבָד, a *dalet-ṭet* interchange.¹⁶ The root עָבַד means “to work, ser-

13 M. Avi-Yonah, “בית-ירח” in *EH* 8, 609-11; M. Avi-Yonah and E. Orni, “Bet Yerahh,” *EJ* 4, 778-81. בית ירח may be a variant of בית ירח (cf. b. Bek. 55a). Also T. Kahane, “מקומות ישוב בארץ ישראל בתלמודים ובמדרשים” in *Sinai* 39 (1974/75), 135-38; L. Sukenik, “The Ancient City of Philoteria (*Beth Yerah*),” *JPOS* 1 (1920/21), 102-03; Jastrow, 595b-96a.

14 Two Zerahites families existed, the descendants of Zerah ben Judah and of Zerah ben Simeon. Four additional persons are named Zerah in the Bible.

15 Regarding the meaning of the name Samuel, see the commentaries by Rashi, Rid, Radak, Ralbag, and Malbim on this verse.

16 E.g., זָבַח - טָבַח (A), “to slaughter”; יָרַד - יָרַט, “to descend”; פָּרַד - פָּרַט, “to divide, separate” (see #60, 12:12); טָבַע - דָּמַע (see Appendix D).

ve" (e.g., Gen. 2:5; Exod. 10:26); its nominal formation is עֶבֶד, "servant, slave." העֶבֶט = העֶבֶד can be interpreted as: (a) הָעֶבֶד, "the servant," e.g., וַיֹּאמֶר הָעֶבֶד, "and the servant (Eliezer) said" (Gen. 24:65); or as a personal name, "the Ebed/Servant," e.g., גָּעַל בֶּן עֶבֶד, "Gaal the son of Ebed/-Servant" (Judg. 9:26.). (b) הָעֶבֶד, "the server, worker"; e.g., מְתוֹקָה שְׁנַת הָעֶבֶד, "sweet is the sleep of the worker" (Eccl. 5:11); or as a personal name, "the Obed/Server," e.g., וַיְבַעַז הוֹלִיד אֶת עוֹבֵד וְעֶבֶד הוֹלִיד אֶת יֵשׁוּעַ, "and Boaz begot Obed/Server, and Obed/Server begot Jesse, and Jesse begot David" (Ruth 4:21-22); בְּנֵי עֶבֶד אֱדוֹם, "the sons of Obed Edom (Server of Edom)" (1 Chron. 26:8).¹⁷

הַיְרֵחִי הַנֶּחֱבֵט (= הָעֶבֶט) בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֶבֶט, "In a/the grave of the sons of (the) 'Aveṭ/'Aveṣ the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite" — הָעֶבֶט may be a variant of הָעֶבֶץ, "the 'Aveṣ," a *ṭet-šade* interchange;¹⁸ cf. the Ugaritic personal name *bn bš*, i.e., בֶּן עֶבֶץ, "son of 'Aveṣ" (2117:40); also עֶבֶץ, Jabez, a descendant of Judah (1 Chron. 4:9-10), and a toponym in Judah (1 Chron. 2:55).¹⁹

הַיְרֵחִי הַנֶּחֱמוֹד (= הָעֶמּוּד) בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֶמּוּט, "In a/the grave of the sons of (the) 'Ammud/Pillar the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite" — הָעֶמּוּד, "the pillar," may be a personal name, "the 'Ammud/Pillar," a *dalet-ṭet* interchange; cf. the students of Rabbi Johanan ben Zakkai called him "Light of Israel, עֶמּוּד הַיְמִינִי (the Right-side Pillar), the Strong Hammer" (b. Ber. 28b); also, the name תָּמָר, Tamar, Palm (see #43, 9:15); and the Aramaic toponym עֶמּוּדָא (= הָעֶמּוּד in Hebrew), 'Ammuda or "the Pillar" (see #25, 6:1).

הַיְרֵחִי הַנֶּחֱמוֹד (= הָעֶמּוּד) בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֶמּוּט, "In a/the grave of the sons of the 'Ammud (division of representatives) of Jericho" — עֶמּוּד also means מַעְמָד, "division of representatives" for Kohanim (priests), Levites, and Israelites when one of the twenty-four priestly watches served in the Temple. Cf.

It was taught (in a baraita), "Twenty-four thousand (men belonged to the) עֶמּוּד מִירושָׁלַם (division of representatives from Jerusalem) וְחֶצִי עֶמּוּד מִיְרֵחוֹ (and one half division of representatives [i.e., twelve thousand men] from Jericho)" (y. Ta'an. 4:2 [17b]; y. Pes. 4:1 [22b]; see *Penei Mošeh*, *Qorban ha'Edah*).

הַיְרֵחִי הַנֶּחֱמוֹס (= הָעֶמוּס) בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעֶמּוּט, "In a/the grave of the sons of (the)

¹⁷ Also cf. עֶבֶד מֶלֶךְ הַכּוּשִׁי, Ebed Melech the Cushite, i.e., "Servant of the King, the Ethiopian" (Jer. 38:7, etc.); וְלְעֶזְרִיָּה עֶבֶד נְבֹ, "and for Azariah (God shall Help)" he called Abednego (Servant of Nebo)" (Dan. 1:7, etc; cf. Sa'adiah Ga'on); אֲדוֹנִירָם בֶּן עֲבָדָא, "Adoniram son of Abda (the Servant [in Aramaic])" (1 Kgs 4:6); עֲבָדָא בֶּן שְׁמוּעַ, "Abda son of Shammua" (Neh. 11:17); שְׁלֵמִיָּהוּ בֶּן עֲבְדָּאֵל, "Shelemiah son of Abdeel (Servant of the God)" (Jer. 36:26); עֲבַדְיָהוּ וְעֲבַדְיָה, Obadiah, i.e., "Servant of the Lord" (e.g., Obad. 1:1; 1 Kgs 18:3).

¹⁸ E.g., קוֹץ - קוֹט, "to abhor, disgust"; נֹצַר - נֹצַר, "to protect"; etc.

¹⁹ UT, 453 (#1805). The *yod* of יַעֲבֹץ may be theophoric as in יַעֲקֹב, Jacob; cf. the Palmyrene personal names בַּלְעֻקָּב and עַתְעֻקָּב (BDB, 785a).

Amos the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite" — העמט may be variant of העמס, a *ṣet-samekh* interchange.²⁰ The root עמס means "to load, carry"; from it is derived the name of the prophet עמוס, Amos, i.e., "who carries a load" (e.g., Amos 1:1).

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָמֶט (= הַחֶמֶט) הַיִּרְחִי הַיְּהוֹמֶט, "In a/the grave of the sons of (the) Homet/Lizard the Jerahite/Jerichoite/Zerahite" — העמט may be a variant of הַחֶמֶט, "the lizard," a *ḥet-ayin* interchange;²¹ e.g., וְהַחֶמֶט, "and the lizard" (Lev. 11:30); it may be a personal name, "the Homet" or "the Lizard," cf. the toponym הַחֶמֶט, Humtah (Josh. 15:54).

All of these suggestions can be compared to the verse, הָרֹאשׁ אֲחִיעֶזֶר וְיֹאֲשׁ, בְּנֵי הַשְּׁמַעְיָה הַגִּבְעָתִי, "The chief (was) Ahiezer, then Joash, sons of the Shemaah the Gibeathite" (1 Chron. 12:3; cf. Trg.). In this citation after "sons of," the father's name is prefixed with the definite article, and it is followed by a gentilic that indicates his place of origin.

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָמֶט טָהוֹר הוּא (= הוּא) בּוֹ (cf. Lurie), "In a/the grave of the sons of people, it is pure, in it (i.e., in the grave)," i.e., "In an/the impure grave of the common people, in it (i.e., in the grave)" — טָהוֹר הוּא, "it (masc.) is pure," points to the masculine קָדָשׁ; cf. טָהוֹר הוּא, "he/it is (ritually) pure" (e.g., Lev. 11:37).²² Since a grave cannot be "(ritually) pure," בְּנֵי הָעָמֶט must be a euphemism for טָמֵא (masc), "(ritually) impure." בְּנֵי הָעָמֶט, "sons of the people," means "the common people."²³ Cf. גִּיא נָךְ, Pure Valley, which may be a euphemism for "Impure Valley," i.e., גִּיא הַנֶּם, "Valley of Hinnom"²⁴ (see #47, 10:8). Cf.

20 E.g., the roots טמן (H, A) - ספן (H, A) - צפן (H) - שפן (H) - סמר (A) - סמר (A) - צפר (H, A) - שמר (H), all connote the meaning, "to keep, hide, protect" (within this group there is also a *nun-reš* interchange); פרס and פָּרַס, "to divide, break off, separate."

21 E.g., חוּג, "to form a circle" (Job 26:10), and עוּג, "to form a circle" (e.g., m. Ta'an. 3:8); הָצַר, "to enclose" (the root of הֶצֶר, "enclosure, courtyard," e.g., Exod. 40:8; see #3, 1:6), and עָצַר, "to close up" (e.g., Gen. 20:18).

22 The feminine form is וְטָהוֹרָה הִיא (*qeri*, the *ketiv* is וְטָהוֹרָה הִיא, "and she is (ritually) pure" (Num. 5:28). In this suggestion הִיא, "it (fem.)," or הֵן, (masc., fem.) "they," neither can refer to קָדָשׁ, nor to בְּנֵי הָעָמֶט, because it is followed by בּוֹ, "in it (masc.)." Even if the latter is read as בָּן, i.e., בָּן (fem.) or בָּם (masc.), "in them," still makes no sense.

23 This is like the Yiddish expression אַינעם, literally (in Hebrew) "your (second pers. masc.) people," which means "common people," or better "common Jews" (cf. b. Ber. 3b).

24 Euphemisms occur in the Masoretic Text, some being *ketiv-qeri* cases, e.g., וְבִטְחָדִים (*ketiv*), vs. וְבִטְחָדִים (*qeri*), "hemorrhoids" (Deut. 28:27, etc.). Likewise they appear in the Talmud, e.g., לְסִמְיָא אָזְחִין לְסִמְיָא נְהוּרָא, "for the blind one calls excessive light" (y. Pe'ah 5:5 [19a]); רַב שֶׁשֶׁת סָגִי נְהוּרָא הוּא, "Rav Sheshet was (a person) of excessive light," i.e., he was blind (b. Ber. 58a). אֲמַרְי אִיבָא צוּרְבָא מִדְּבָנִן הָבָא וּמֵאֹרֻר עֵינָיו, "(People of the town) said, 'There is here (a person) who has been ignited by our masters, and (he is) a light for eyes'," i.e., a young Rabbinical scholar who is blind (b. Hag. 5b). The minor Talmud tractate אֲבֻל רַבְתִּי, "Great Mourning," is named euphemistically as שְׂמֵחוֹת, "Rejoicings." See J.D. Eisenstein, "לְשׁוֹן (לְשׁוֹן יְפֵה)" in *OY* 6, 66a; A. Marmorstein, "לְשׁוֹן (לְשׁוֹן נְקִייה)" in *OY* 6, 65b-66a; S.M. Paul and L.I. Rabinowitz, "Euphemism and Dysphemism," *EJ* 6, 959-62.

And (King Josiah) brought out the Asherah from the house of the Lord, outside of Jerusalem **נָחַל קִדְרוֹן** **אֶל** (to Wadi Kidron), and he burned it **בְּנָחַל קִדְרוֹן** (in Wadi Kidron), and he stamped it small to powder, and he cast the powder **עַל הָעַם קֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעַם** (upon the grave of the sons of the people) (2 Kgs 23:6).

And they took Uriah out of Egypt, and brought him to king Jehoiakim, and he slew him with a sword, and cast his corpse **הָעַם בְּנֵי קֶבֶר** **אֶל** (to the graves of the sons of people) (Jer. 26:23).²⁵

טָהוֹר may refer to **הָעַם**, i.e., “pure people.” Although **בְּנֵי הָעַם טָהוֹר** is an unusual form, the expected being **הָעַם הַטָּהוֹר** or **בְּנֵי הָעַם הַטָּהוֹר**, “sons of the pure people,” **בְּנֵי עַם טָהוֹר**, “sons of a pure people,” or **בְּנֵי עַם אֲשֶׁר טָהוֹר**, “sons of people which (are) pure”;²⁶ yet these forms are grammatically correct. The singular forms of **עַם** (masc.), “people,” are: **עַם** (abs.); **עַם** (pausal); **עַם** (const.); **הָעַם** (with definite article). A verb or an adjective following **עַם** can be singular or plural; e.g., **וְהָעַם נָסוּ** vs. **וְהָעַם נָסוּ**, “and the people fled” (2 Sam. 23:11 and 1 Chron. 11:13, respectively); **הִנֵּה עַם יוֹרֵד** vs. **הִנֵּה עַם יוֹרְדִים**, “behold, people are descending” (Judg. 9:36 and 9:37, respectively); **עַם קְדוֹשׁ**, “holy people” (Deut 7:6, 14:2,21), vs. **וְעַם קְדוֹשִׁים**, “and holy people” (Dan. 8:24). Moreover, **הָעַם** occurs in the construct state, **הָעַם יִשְׂרָאֵל**, “the people of Israel” (1 Kgs 16:21, see Radak; Ezra 9:1, see Ibn-Ezra), the same as the Aramaic **עַמָּא יִשְׂרָאֵל**, “the people of Israel” (Ezra 7:13; Trg. 1 Kgs 16:21). Also, **וְכָל הָעַם הַמִּלְחָמָה**, “and all the fighting men” (Josh. 8:11).²⁷

It is possible to read the fourth and fifth word as **טָהוֹרָה וּבו**, where **וּבו**, “and in it (masc.),” is interrupted, **waw** is at the end of line 11:9, and **בו** is at the beginning of 11:10. Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1–2. The following are some suggestions.

וּבו הָעַם טָהוֹרָה וּבו, **בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעַם טָהוֹרָה וּבו**, “In a/the pure (euphemism for impure) grave of the common people, and in it (i.e., in the grave)” — This suggestion has a problem; there is no singular feminine noun to which the feminine adjective **טָהוֹרָה**, “pure,” may refer, unless **קֶבֶר** is a dual gender noun. The second

25 These are mentioned by Allegro and Lurie. Comparing these verses, one may conclude that **קֶבֶר** (masc., BH, MH, pl. **קִבְרוֹת** and **קִבְרִים**) in the first verse is a collective noun (i.e., “graves”). Also, **קִבְרָה** - **קְבוּרָה** (fem., BH, MH) has two meanings, “burial” and “grave.” The latter is a synonym of **קֶבֶר**. Regarding **קֶבֶר**, see #14, 3:11–12.

26 Cf. **וְהָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא טָהוֹר**, “and the man who is pure” (Num. 9:13).

27 These are additional construct forms and relevant phrases: **עַם קְדוֹשׁ**, “holy people” (Dan. 12:7); **עַם הַקְּדוֹשׁ**, “the holy people” (Isa. 62:12); **עַם הָאָרֶץ**, “people of the land” (e.g., Gen. 23:13); **הַשְּׁלֵהֵן הַטָּהוֹר**, “the pure table” (Lev. 24:6; 2 Chron. 13:11); **הַעוֹף הַטָּהוֹר**, “the kosher bird” (Gen. 8:20); **וְזָהָב טָהוֹר**, “pure gold” (e.g., Exod. 28:31); **וַיְכִיּוֹם הַטָּהוֹר**, “and in the clean day,” Lev. 14:57; **אֶבֶן גְּדֹלָה**, “the large stone” (1 Sam. 14:33); **וְהָאֶבֶן גְּדֹלָה**, “and the large stone” (Gen. 29:2); **הָאֶבֶן הַגְּדֹלָה**, “the large stone” (1 Sam. 6:15); etc.

plural formation of קְבֻרֹת, may support this possibility.

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹרָה (= טְהָרָה) ובו, "In a/the grave of the common people, it is cleansed, and in it"; or better, "In a/the grave of the sons of the people (responsible) for purification, and in it (i.e., in the grave)." In טְהוֹרָה the waw may represent a Tiberian *ḥattaf qamaš*, as in several *ketiv-queri* cases in the Masoretic Text,²⁸ and often in Mishnaic Hebrew.²⁹ Certain Levite families were responsible for the טְהָרָה (fem.), "purifying, cleansing, purification," process in the Temple; e.g., וְעַל טְהָרֶת לְכָל קֹדֶשׁ, "and in purifying of all holy things" (1 Chron. 23:28). וּמִשְׁמֶרֶת הַטְהָרָה, "and the service of purification" (Neh. 12:45). Perhaps this was a burial site for Levites responsible for purification processes.

There are many other possible suggestions, some being unlikely. The last two words of this line can be read as טְהוֹר תו. The term תו (masc.) means "sign," its root is תוה, "to mark"; e.g., וְהִתִּייתָ תו עַל מִצְחוֹת הָאֲנָשִׁים, "and you shall mark a sign on the forehead of the men" (Ezek. 9:4). Also, תו may be a variant of תָּא (תוֹא in Aramaic), "cell" (*ʾalef-waw* interchange); e.g., מִמֵּגַע הַתָּא לְגִגּוֹ and its Targum, מֵאִגֵּר תוֹא לְאִיגְרִיה, "from the roof of the cell to the roof of the other one" (Ezek. 40:13; cf. Rashi).

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹר תו, "In a/the grave of the sons of the pure people, (there is) a mark, in it (i.e., in the grave)."

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹר תו (= תָּא) בו, "In/at/by a/the grave of the sons of the pure people, (there is) a cell, in it (i.e., in the cell)."

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹר תו, "In/at/by a/the grave of the sons of the people, (there is) a purification mark, in it (i.e., the grave)." The "pure mark" may indicate how close a priest may go to the grave site.

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵי הָעָם טְהוֹר תו (= תָּא) בו, "In/at/by a/the grave of the sons of the people, (there is) a purified cell, in it (i.e., in the cell)."

בְּקֶבֶר בְּנֵיהֶ/בְּנֵיהֶ עֵם פִּז תוֹרָתוֹ, "In/at/by the grave of Baniah/Coniah with his fine golden Torah (scroll)" — The *tet*-shaped character is read as פִּז. Cf.

It was a precedent: בְּתוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל אֶלְכְּסַנְדְּרוֹס כָּל אֲזֻכְתוֹתֶיהָ כְּתוּבוֹת בְּזָהָב (In the Torah [scroll] of Alexander every Divine Name was written with gold). And the case came before the Sages, and they ruled: "תִּגְנֶזָּה (It shall be committed to *genizah*)" (Sof. 1:9; cf. b. Shab. 103b).

Perhaps the Torah scroll of Baniah or Coniah contained golden script. Thus, it was buried with him, i.e., committed into *genizah*. Later this grave was used to hide the objects mentioned in this item. Regarding *genizah*, see #2,

28 E.g., אֲזֻכְתוֹת (ketiv) - אֲזֻכְתוֹת (queri, 2 Chron. 8:18); אֲזֻכְתוֹת (ketiv) - אֲזֻכְתוֹת (queri, Isa. 18:4); וְאֲזֻכְתוֹת (ketiv) - וְאֲזֻכְתוֹת (queri, Ezra 8:25); בְּמוֹתֵי (ketiv) - בְּמוֹתֵי (queri, Deut. 32:13; Isa. 58:14; Micah 1:3); קְסוּמֵי (ketiv) - קְסוּמֵי (queri, 1 Sam. 28:8).

29 E.g., עֲוִיּוֹת (MH) - עֲוִיּוֹת (BH), "sheaves"; צִיּוּרִין and צִיּוּרִים (MH) - צִיּוּרִים (BH), "birds."

1:5; #25, 6:4; #33, 8:3; and “The Copper Scroll and the Dead Sea Scrolls” in the Discussion.

(11:9-10) ... בּוֹ בּוֹ כְּלִי דְמַע ... בְּקֶבֶר, “In a/the grave of ..., in it (there are) dedicated vessels ...,” is like the phrases בּוֹר בּוֹ כְּלִין וְכֶסֶף כְּכָרִין שְׁבַעֲעִין, “(there is) a pit, in [it] (there are) vessels and seventy talents of silver” (see #8, 2:5-6); בּוֹ בּוֹ כְּלִין ... בְּבּוֹרִיבּוֹר, “In a/the pit (masc.) ... in it (there are) vessels” (see #9, 2:7-8). In these cases בּוֹ, “in it (masc.),” refers to the masculine קֶבֶר, “grave,” and בּוֹר, “pit/cistern,” respectively. Therefore, בְּקֶבֶר should be rendered as, “in a/the grave of,” rather than “at/by a/the grave of.” The form בּוֹ(שׁ)בּוֹ(שׁ) ... בּוֹ means, “in (a/the) ... (which is) in it(s ...)” (see #3, 1:6:7; #11, 2:13-14; #37, 8:14; #43, 9:14-16; #45, 10:4).

(11:10-11) אֶצְלָן סוֹת בְּתִכּוֹנִיבְתָּן דְּמַע אוֹ דְּמַע, “(there are an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels or dedicated garments/covers, with their lists next to them,” or “(there are an undisclosed number of) dedicated vessels or dedicated garments/covers, their notes are next to them” — For further discussion of the term דְּמַע, see Appendix D, and for the phrase בְּתִכּוֹנִיבְתָּן אֶצְלָמוֹן, Appendix E.

ITEM 55

בבית האשוחין באשוח	11:12
בבואתך לימ אמות	11:13
שלו>ש< כלי דמ>ע< לאח דמע סירא	11:14
בתכן אצלן	11:15

- 11:12 In the House of the Pools, in the pool
 11:13 as you (sg.) come toward the basin thr <ee>
 11:14 cubits, (there are) dedic <ated> liquid vessels (and)
 dedicated pots,
 11:15 with their lists next to them.

COMMENTARY

(11:12) בבית האשוחין והאשוחין, “In the House of the Pools” — This phrase is discussed with or without the proposition *bet*. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the House of Gamma Aleph (?), where the mill stones are” (i.e., בבית גא שרחין); ΓΑ sic! It is possible that the *’alef* belongs to the *šin* as in Phoenician (i.e., אשרחין Γ בבית). ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the House of Pits (ditches).” ALLEGRO: בבית אשיחין, “In the House of the (Two?) Pools”; referring to Bethesda; *reš/dalet* instead of *waw/yod*. The *gamma* may be an erroneous *samekh*, and may be the beginning of an alternate name, cf. Syriac בית סחוא, “swimming bath,” from סחי (שחה in BH), “to swim.” Alternately, בית אשדתין, “(Two) Slopes,” pl. of אשדה; cf. אשדות (Josh. 10:40), אשד (Num. 21:15), of the root אשד (A), “to pour out,” etc. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the House of the Twin Pools (Bethesda?).”¹ MILIK: בית (א)אשדתין, Beth Eshdatain. בית is followed by a cur-sive *’alef*, a dittography, the questionable *dalet* could be a *reš*, and the *taw* a *het*. It is the same as as Βηθεσδα, בית אשדה, Bethesda of John (5:2); Βεζδα of Josephus (*BJ* II, 325, 530, etc.); Βεζεδα and Βηζεδα of Eusebius (*Onomasticon*, p. 58, 21-6); and variants of John’s Βηθσαιθα, Bethzet(h)a, בית אשד; etc. אשדתין, “twin slope,” is related to the the Aramaic root אשד, “to pour out water/blood.”² LURIE: בבית האשוחין; the *gamma* is a *he* with a missing right leg. Lurie argues against Allegro’s translation, “two pools,” and its possible identification with the Strouthion Pool of Josephus.³ WISE:

1 Allegro, 53 (אשוחין may be a typographical error for אשיחין), 148 n. 107, 165-66 nn. 281-82; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 297-98, 271-72 D-44; Milik^E, 142, 153-54.

“reservoir precinct.”⁴ BEYER follows Lurie, while the other scholars agree with Milik.⁵

JEREMIAS identifies **בֵּית אֶשְׁדָּתִין** as Bethesda in Jerusalem (John 5:2).⁶ This is accepted by Milik, etc. Yet according to GREENFIELD, “The proposal to see in Bethesda/Bethzatha of John 5:2 a transcription of this name is not likely to receive approbation. The root *ʾšd* is ‘to pour’ and one would need not a double reservoir of water to satisfactorily locate the site but a lake—or pool—fed by two sources. The textual problems of John 5:2 are too complex for such offhand solution. It is also unlikely that one and the same name would receive such conflicting transcriptions.”⁷

בְּבֵית ה־, “in/at/by the house of” — Frequently when the first element of a compound toponym is **בֵּית**, the second one is prefixed with the definite article; e.g., **בֵּית הַכֶּרֶם**, Beth-cherem, “House of the Vineyard” (Jer. 6:1; Neh. 3:14; also in the Scroll, 10:5). **בֵּית** also connotes “City/Place of,” and may be interchangeable with **עִיר**, Ir, “city of,” **בָּעַל**, Baal, “deity/possessor of,” and **כְּפָר**, Kefar, “village of.” For further discussion, see #7, 2:3.

The second word consists of the letters *gamma*, *ʾalef*, *šin/śin*, *reš/dalet* (possibly in place of *waw/yod*; cf. **רמחצא** for **ומחצא**, 9:6), *he/ħet/taw* (in MILIK drawing the left foot is of a dotted line), *waw/yod*, and a final *nun*. The *gamma* is an unfinished *he* with a missing right leg (cf. Lurie), rather than an *ʾalef* (as in some inscriptions;⁸ cf. Milik) or it is a scribal error (cf. Allegro, Milik). It should be noted that this item contains several scribal er-

3 Lurie, 121-22 and n. 1.

4 Wise, 197.

5 Beyer, 230, 232; Pixner, 356 and n. 47; Wolters, 52-53; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377.

6 J. Jeremias, “The Copper Scroll from Qumran,” *The Expository Times*, 71 (1959/60), 227-28; Abba — *Studien zur neutestamentlichen Theologie und Zeitgeschichte* (1966), 361-64; *The Rediscovery of Bethesda — John 5:2* (1966), 34-38. J.H. Charlesworth discusses the Pool of Bethsaida of John. He says, “The famous Copper Scroll found in Qumran Cave 3 adds another dimension to this fascinating research ... the Copper Scroll describes 64 places where the Temple treasure was hidden to prevent its falling into the hands of the Romans when, in 70 CE, they besieged Jerusalem and destroyed the Temple. The Copper Scroll describes in frustrating detail some of the topography in around Jerusalem. In one column it apparently refers to the Pool of Bethsaida mentioned by the author of John, although this reading is far from certain” (“Reinterpreting John. How the Dead Sea Scrolls Revolutionized Our Understanding of the Gospel of John,” *BR* 9 [1993], 20b, 54 nn. 4-5; see also *Jesus and the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1992], 213-14, 230-31).

7 Greenfield, 140. Greenfield also refers to the article by D.J. Wieand, “John V. 2 and the Pool of Bethesda,” *New Testament Studies* 12 (1965/66), 392-404.

8 Discussing the paleography of the funeral inscription of the Goliath Family in Jericho, Hachlili says, “The *ʾalep* is usually written with the left leg omitted. There is a slight difference between the medial and final *ʾalep*.... There is one *gamma*-shaped *ʾalep* in inscription 13c” (“The Goliath Family in Jericho: Funeral Inscriptions from the First-Century A.D. Jewish Monumental Tomb,” *BASOR* 235 [1979], 58a, 59 fig. 47).

rors and one correction.

אֲשׁוּחִים - אֲשׁוּחִין are either plural or dual formations, i.e., אֲשׁוּחִים - אֲשׁוּחִים, "pools," or אֲשׁוּחִים - אֲשׁוּחִים, "two pools." The next word happens to be the singular אֲשׁוּחִה - אֲשׁוּחִה or אֲשׁוּחִה - אֲשׁוּחִה (masc.), "pool, cistern," with the preposition *bet*. The singular occurs in lines 7:4 and 10:5, as well as in 5:6, where it is spelled as אֲשׁוּחִה, with double *waw* or *yod* that may reflect a consonantal value.

The term in question appears in various sources as: הָאֲשׁוּחִה (= הָאֲשׁוּחִה or הָאֲשׁוּחִה, sg. masc., in Hebrew), "the cistern" (Moabite Mesha Inscription);⁹ הָאֲשׁוּחִה or אֲשׁוּחִה in ואֲשׁוּחִה (= הָאֲשׁוּחִה, sg. fem., or הָאֲשׁוּחִה, archaic sg. fem., in Hebrew), "and a cistern," or ואֲשׁוּחִה (= הָאֲשׁוּחִה, pl. fem., in Hebrew), "and cisterns" (Ammonite Siran Inscription, line 5);¹⁰ and בְּדוֹרוֹ נִכְרָה מְקוֹה, אֲשׁוּחִה בָּם בְּהִמּוֹנוֹ אֲשׁוּחִה, "In his generation a ritual bath was dug, a cistern with abundance (of water)" (Ben-Sira 3:3).¹¹ In the these inscriptions the *waw* may have a consonantal value.

The first letter of אֲשׁוּחִה is a prosthetic *ʾalef*, thus they are variants of שִׁיחַ (MH, masc., pl. שִׁיחִים) or שִׁיחַ (MH, prob. masc), "pit, cistern, grave." In the Scroll שִׁיחַ is feminine. These are the same as שִׁיחַ and שִׁיחַ (BH, fem.), "pit" (see #18, 4:9).

בֵּית הָאֲשׁוּחִין (cf. Allegro), Beth ^ʾAšihin or "House of the Pools" — אֲשׁוּחִין may be a variant of שִׁיחִין (with a prosthetic *ʾalef*), Šihin (t. Shab. 13:9), a city near Sepphoris in the Galilee,¹² also spelled שִׁיחִים (Sifre Deut. 3:17). כְּפָר שִׁיחָא, Kefar Šihaya (t. B.M. 6:3), כְּפָר שִׁיחָא (A), Kefar Šihaya, כְּפָר שִׁיחִין, Kefar Šihon, and כְּפָר סִיחִין, Kefar Sihon, may be the same as Šihin.¹³ According to Kohut, Klein, and Neaman, שִׁיחִין is Ασωχίς, Asochis near Sepphoris mentioned by Josephus.¹⁴ שִׁיחִין was the dwelling place of the four-

9 KAI 1, 33; 2, 174 (#181:9,23). Also, H. Reviv, *A Commentary on Selected Inscriptions from the Period of the Monarchy in Israel* (Heb., 1975), 19.

10 From c. 600 BCE, discovered at Tell Siran in Amman, Jordan in 1972. See J. Blau, "שְׁמִיחִית, לְשׁוֹנוֹת" in *EH* 32, 78-79; Ch. Krahmalkov, "An Ammonite Lyric Poem," *BASOR* 223 (1976), 55; W.H. Shea, "The Siran Inscription: Amminadab's Drinking Song," *PEQ* 110 (1978), 107.

11 Some emend כִּים to כִּים (= כִּים), "like a/the sea/pool" (see BY 1, 411b-12a n. 5).

12 Both Talmudim refer to שִׁיחִין near Sepphoris (y. Ta'an. 4:5 [21b]; b. Giṭ. 68a). The craftsmen of Šihin produced שִׁיחִין, "carrying carts" or "boxes"; see #1, 1:3.

13 "Johanan the son of (Rabbi) Jonathan, the Lion of שִׁיחָא (a baraita, b. Yev. 122b). E.g., "Rabbi Judah said, Nehemiah אִישׁ שִׁיחִין (a native of Šihin) testified in the name of Rabbi Akiva" (y. Soṭ. 2:5 [11b]). The *Qorban ha'Edah* says that Nehemiah was nicknamed אִישׁ שִׁיחִין, "man of cisterns," because he used to dig cisterns on the sides of the high-ways and fields for the pilgrims of Jerusalem. The same name appears as "Nehemiah אִישׁ שִׁיחִין (a native of the Village of Sihon/Šihon)" (Gen. Rabbah 12). The spelling of שִׁיחִין may indicate a relation to the biblical קִרְיַת סִיחִין and עִיר סִיחִין, "city of Sihon" (Num. 21:28 and 21:26-27, respectively).

14 *AC* 8, 48a; *SY*, 154b; *ETG* 2, 65b-70a; T. Kahane, *מקומות ישוב בארץ ישראל*

teenth Priestly Course of יֵשֶׁבֶבֶב, Yeshevav. Klein says that the original name of שׁוּחִים was אֲשׁוּחִים.¹⁵ The Greek Asochis support this suggestion.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן (cf. Allegro), Beth 'Ašihain or "House of the Two Pools," is like the previous reading in the dual form.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן, Beth 'Ašuhin or "House of the Pools," is a variant of the above discussed בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן, Beth 'Ašuhain or "House of the Two Pools," is like the previous reading in the dual form.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן, Beth 'Ašihon same as בֵּית הַשִּׁיחֹן, Beth Šihon, with a prosthetic 'alef. It may be identical with כְּפַר שִׁיחֹן, Kefar Šihon (see above).

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן, Beth 'Ašihon = בֵּית הַשִּׁיחֹן = בֵּית הַסִּיחֹן, Beth Sihon, with a prosthetic 'alef. Cf. the above mentioned כְּפַר סִיחֹן, Kefar Sihon.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן = בֵּית הַשׁוּחִים or בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן = בֵּית הַשׁוּחִיִּים, Beth 'Ašuhin, Beth Šuhiyyim, or House of the Šuhite — אֲשִׁיחַיִן may be the same as שׁוּחִים (with a prosthetic 'alef), the plural of שׁוּחַ. One of the sons of Abraham by Keturah was שׁוּחַ, Shuah (Gen. 25:2; 1 Chron. 1:32). בִּלְדָּד, Bildad the Shuhite, probably a descendent of Shuah, was one of the three friends of Job (Job 2:11, 8:1, 18:1, 25:1, 42:9). שׁוּחִים or שׁוּחִיִּים, Shuhites, could be the plural of שׁוּחִי (gentilic).

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן = בֵּית הַשִּׁיחִים, Beth Sihin, "House of the Bushes" — אֲשִׁיחַיִן (with a *šin*) may be the same as שִׁיחִים (with a prosthetic 'alef), the plural of שִׁיחַ (masc.), "bush"; e.g., בֵּין שִׁיחִים יִנְהָקוּ, "among the bushes they bray" (Job 30:7).

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן = בֵּית הַשִּׁיחִיִּים, Beth Sihayim/n or "House of the Two Bushes," is like the previous reading in the dual form.

בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחַיִן, Beth 'Ašuhon = בֵּית הַשׁוּחָם, Beth Shuham, "House of Shuham" — אֲשִׁיחַיִן may be a variant of שׁוּחָם, Shuham, the 'alef may be prosthetic, while the waw may represent a Tiberian *qamas*; cf. הַבָּאוֹת instead of הַבָּאוֹת (see #1, 1:2). Shuham was the only son of Dan, the ancestor of the Tribe of Dan.¹⁶

These are the sons of Dan according to their families: לְשׁוּחָם (of Shuham), מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (the Shuhamite family) ... כָּל מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (all the Shuhamite families) (Num. 26:43)

Perhaps Beth 'Ašuhon or Beth Shuham was the dwelling place of one of the Shuhamite families.

¹⁵ These are the sons of Dan according to their families: לְשׁוּחָם (of Shuham), מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (the Shuhamite family) ... כָּל מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (all the Shuhamite families) (Num. 26:43)

¹⁶ Perhaps Beth 'Ašuhon or Beth Shuham was the dwelling place of one of the Shuhamite families.

¹⁷ These are the sons of Dan according to their families: לְשׁוּחָם (of Shuham), מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (the Shuhamite family) ... כָּל מִשְׁפַּחַת הַשׁוּחָמִי (all the Shuhamite families) (Num. 26:43)

בֵּית הָאֶשְׁדָּתִין, “House of the Two Waterfalls,” “House of the Two Slopes,” Beth ‘Ašdataim/n, or Bethesda (cf. Jeremias, Milik) — אֶשְׁדָּתִים may be an unattested dual formation of אֶשְׁדָּה (fem.), “water fall, slope.” In the Masoretic Text אֶשְׁדָּת (pl.) and אֶשְׁדָּה (pl. const.), “slopes (of), waterlands (of),” occur six times. הָהָר וְהַנֶּגֶב וְהַשְּׁפֵלָה וְהָאֶשְׁדָּת, “the mountain, and the Negeb, and the lowland and the waterfalls/slopes” (Josh. 10:40); בְּהָר וּבְשְׁפֵלָה וּבְעֶרְבָה וּבְאֶשְׁדָּת וּבַמִּדְבָּר וּבְנֶגֶב, “in the mountains, and in the lowland, and in the Arabah, and in the waterfalls/slopes, and in the wilderness, and in the Negeb” (Josh. 12:8); and four times הַפִּסְגָּה אֶשְׁדָּת, “the waterfalls/slopes of the Pisgah/cliff” (Deut. 3:17, 4:49; Josh. 12:3, 13:20).¹⁷ The usual Targum for הַפִּסְגָּה אֶשְׁדָּת is מִשְׁפָּךְ מִרְמָתָא, “torrent from the height.”¹⁸ The masculine אֶשְׁדָּה occurs once in the Masoretic Text, וְהַנְּחָלִים, “and the waterfalls/slopes of the rivers” (Num. 21:15).¹⁹ It is rendered by the Targumim as: וְשִׁפּוֹךְ נְחָלִיא (TO), “and the torrent of the rivers”; וְשִׁפְכוֹת נְחָלִיא (PsJ), “and the gushing of the rivers,” i.e., waterfalls; and וְשִׁטְפוֹ נְחָלִיא (TN), “and the rivers floated.” אֶשְׁדָּה and אֶשְׁדָּה are from the root אֶשַׁד (A), “to pour, sprinkle” (see #1, 1:3; #38, 9:1).²⁰

17 This phrase is rendered as: “the slopes of Pisgah” (JPS); “the rapids (or waterfall) on the cliffs” and “the rapids flowing from the cliffs” (*The Living Torah*, 882, 895 [Deut. 3:17; 4:49]); “waterfalls of the mountaintop” (*Tanach*, Deut. 3:17); “the waterfalls of the cliffs” (*Tanach*, Deut. 4:49); “the falls of Pisgah” (*Tanach*, Josh. 12:3, 13:20); etc.

18 TO Deut. 3:17, 4:49; PsJ Deut. 4:49; Trg. Josh. 10:40, 12:3, 8, 13:20. The usual vocalization is מִשְׁפָּךְ מִרְמָתָא, however, מִרְמָתָא is the plural of רִמְתָּא (from the root רוּם, “to lift”; e.g., רִמְתָּא, “the height,” is the Targum for הַפִּסְגָּה (Num. 21:2, etc.), הַגִּבְעָה (Exod. 17:9, 10), and הַפְּעוֹר (Num. 23:28), while מִרְמָתָא, “the heights,” is for הַגִּבְעוֹת (Deut. 12:2) and בְּמֹת (Num. 21:28). Other Targumic renderings are, שִׁפְכוֹת מֵא מִרְמָתָא, “water outpouring of the heights” (PsJ), בֵּית שְׁפִיכוֹת קִיטְמָא, “place of the pouring ashes,” i.e., volcano (Frag.), שְׁפֹעַ בֵּית רְמָתָה, “slope of the height” (TN; all other Targumim on Deut. 3:17), and רִישׁ רְמָתָה, “top of the height” (TN, Deut. 4:49). The latter seems to be a scribal error, since רִישׁ רְמָתָא is the Targum (TO, PsJ, TN) for רִאשׁ הַפִּסְגָּה (Num. 23:14). מִשְׁפָּךְ (from the root שָׁפַךְ, “to pour,” plus a locative *mem*) is a “place of the discharge” (AC 5, 81a) or “torrent” (KS 2, 76a). מִשְׁפָּךְ מִרְמָתָא means “outpouring (of torrents) from the heights, ravines; slopes” (Jastrow, 857b).

19 This phrase is translated as: “and the slope of the valleys” (JPSⁱ); “with its tributary wadis” (JPSⁱⁱ); “and the descent of the valleys” (Yehoash); “the outpouring of the rivers” (*Tanach*); “as well as the valley’s rapids” (*The Living Torah*, 772-73), etc.. The latter sums up the various interpretations of אֶשְׁדָּה as: “waterfall” (Trg., Rashi, Sa’adiah); “spilling” (Rashi, b. Ber. 54b); “projections” (Tanhuma’ 20); “appointed” (Septuagint).

20 These are some explanations. אֶשַׁד and אֶשְׁדָּה (ketiv, Deut. 33:2) are derived from the Targumic אֶשְׁדָּה, “water fall at a slope,” its secondary meaning is “mountain slope.” Radak renders אֶשְׁדָּה הַנְּחָלִים as “slope of the valleys” (MK 1, 157a). אֶשְׁדָּה (related to אֶשַׁד, A, “to pour out”) means “pouring out water in the slope”; אֶשְׁדָּה, “slope of the hill from which the water pours out” (SB, 77a). אֶשְׁדָּה הַנְּחָלִים, “the descent of the brook”; אֶשְׁדָּה, “the declivities of Pisgah” (Harkavy, 42b). אֶשְׁדָּה, “waterfall” (like the Aramaic שָׁפַךְ, “to pour out”); it is related to אֶשְׁדָּה, “slope” (ESH^{dic} 1, 167b; ESH^{con} 1, 227b). The Targum of the verb שָׁפַךְ is usually אֶשַׁד (e.g., TO, PsJ, Gen. 9:5-6, 37:22). שָׁפַךְ הָרִשֶׁן is rendered as אֶתֶר